CHENNAI - TUESDAY - JUNE 16, 2026
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Regd. TN/ARD/14/2012-2014, RNI No. 55320/94

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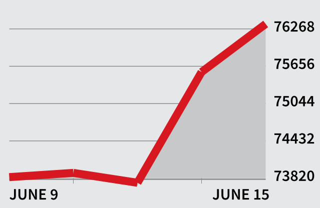

IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	23853.90	+231.00
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	20.61	+0.20
US Dollar (in ₹)	94.71	-0.40
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	150043.00	+2835
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	251488.00	+8906

AIMING HIGH. **Each of the 5 listed** Vedanta firms can turn into a $100 b entity due to the demand-supply gap, says Anil Agarwal **p2**

CONNECTIVITY BOOST. **Noida airport** opens for business, becoming an economic hub for western Uttar Pradesh **p12**

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QUICKLY.

EYEING $600 MILLION

Razorpay files confidential IPO papers with SEBI

Bengaluru: Digital payments unicorn Razorpay has taken a major step towards its stock market debut, filing a pre-filed draft red herring prospectus (DRHP) with the Securities and Exchange Board of India and stock exchanges under the regulator's confidential filing route. The Bengaluru-based fintech expects to raise between $500 million and $600 million through the proposed IPO, according to people familiar with the matter. **p6**

TRADE TALKS PUSH

USTR Jamieson Greer to visit India this month

New Delhi: India and the US are taking forward their trade talks with a key visit by US Trade Representative Jamieson Greer, scheduled next week to finalise the interim trade deal. Greer is scheduled to hold talks with the Commerce Minister on June 23-24 to give "final touches" to the framework deal, Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agrawal said. **p7**

Markets surge on W. Asia ceasefire hope, oil slide

ADDING WEALTH. Investors richer by ₹18-lakh cr in 2 days; FPIs turn net buyers in 11 sessions

Akshata Gorde
Amiti Sen
Mumbai/New Delhi

Markets gained sharply on Monday after early signs of easing geopolitical tensions in West Asia lifted investor sentiment, though analysts cautioned that the upside may remain measured.

A preliminary understanding between the US and Iran to reopen the Strait of Hormuz and extend a fragile ceasefire triggered a broad-based rally. Benchmark indices surged nearly 1 per cent, with the BSE Sensex rising 736 points to close at 76,264.33 and the Nifty 50 advancing 231 points to 23,853, though resistance near the 24,000-mark limited gains.

The market rally translated into a sharp increase in investor wealth, as the total market capitalisation of BSE-listed firms jumped by ₹8.5 lakh crore to ₹470.5 lakh crore. Investor wealth has jumped over ₹18 lakh crore in the last two sessions.

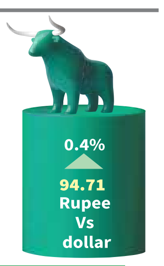
"Ships of the world, start your engines. Let the oil flow!" US President Donald Trump wrote on 'X'.

Oil prices fell on the US-Iran deal news. Brent crude futures fell over 5 per cent to around $83 per barrel, its lowest in nearly two months.

All-round gains

	Close	% change
Sensex	76,264.33	0.97
Nifty	23,853.9	0.98
Dow	51,828.15#	1.2
Nasdaq	26,505.77#	2.4
S&P 500	7,561#	1.74
Germany (Dax)	24,927.21#	1.1
France (CAC)	8,411.84#	0.7
Japan (Nikkei)	69,317.5	5
Korea (Kospi)	8,545.98	5.2
Taiwan (TWSE)	45,397	2.8

#at 8.30 pm IST



RUPEE UP

For India, a major oil importer, this decline is particularly beneficial as it reduces inflationary pressures, supports the rupee and improves fiscal stability. Reflecting this, the rupee appreciated 40 paise to 94.71 against the US dollar.

Global safe-haven assets gained ground, with gold rising over 3 per cent and silver climbing over 5 per cent.

India VIX, the market's volatility gauge, came back close to pre-conflict levels of around 14, reflecting easing investor anxiety as the geopolitical risk premium receded. Trump made the announcement on Sunday evening, with the peace agreement to be signed on June 19 in Switzerland.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi welcomed the development, posting on social media platform 'X': "I welcome the understanding reached between the US and Iran on ending the conflict in West Asia, which has caused serious economic disruption across the world and led to loss of life in many countries."

Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agrawal, however, added a note of caution: "Many of our problems will be alleviated, in case it is a sustainable deal... If peace lasts and there is free movement in Strait of Hormuz, it will have a positive impact on trade. But let us wait and see."

For India, the Gulf conflict is predominantly an "energy crisis," said Trideep Bhattacharya, President and CIO – Equities, Edelweiss Mutual Fund. "We're optimistic that a US-Iran deal could remove a fiscal drag of 0.5-0.8 per cent of India's GDP by lowering oil prices."

FII INFLOWS

This could also bring in a sustained revival in foreign institutional investor inflows, which could act as the next catalyst for the market, said Rajesh Palviya, Head of Research at Axis Direct. On Monday, FPIs, for the first time in 11 sessions, were net buyers for ₹200 crore.

May goods exports up 18% to $45 billion; import surge widens trade deficit to $28 b

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

Goods exports increased 18 per cent year-on-year in May to $45.20 billion, spurred by sectors such as petroleum products, engineering goods and electronics, marking a steady start for the 2026-27 fiscal year despite persistent global headwinds.

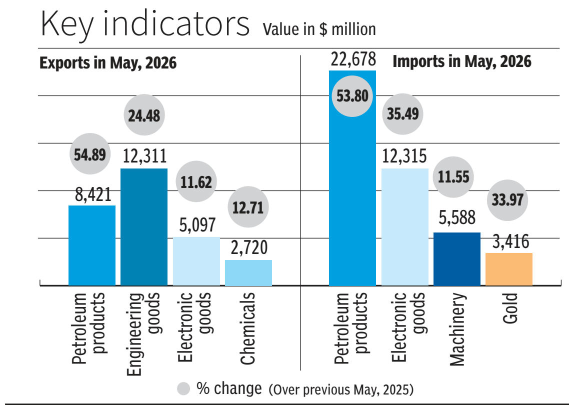
Quick estimates by the Commerce Department show that imports during the month also surged, rising 20.62 per cent (year-on-year) to $73.41 billion, driven by sectors such as petroleum, gold and electronics.

Consequently, the trade deficit in May widened to $28.21 billion from $22.56 billion in May 2025, but it was slightly lower than April's $28.38 billion.

GAINING MOMENTUM

"The export numbers in May are one of the highest monthly trade performances despite the geopolitical uncertainties. Going by the current trend, if we carry on this momentum with continued vigour, this fiscal year will be a good one for trade," Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agrawal said, adding that a peace deal in West Asia would positively impact trade. Top markets for Indian exports in May included the US, the UAE, China, Singapore, the Netherlands and the UK.

Key indicators Value in $ million



While petroleum products were the key driver of export growth in May — rising 54.89 per cent to $8.42 billion — several other sectors, too, performed well, such as engineering goods ($12.31 billion), electronics ($5.09 billion), chemicals ($2.71 billion), pharmaceuticals ($2.62 billion), and gems and jewellery ($2.53 billion).

THE LAGGARDS

However, exports of certain labour-intensive items, such as textiles, leather, ceramic products, jute products and carpets, declined during the month. During April-May, exports rose 16.09 per cent to $ 88.91 billion, while imports jumped 15.14 per cent to $145.35 billion, leaving a trade deficit of $ 56.44 billion compared to $49.65 billion in April-May 2025-26.

A strong export performance in April-May, despite the global uncertainties, demonstrates the resilience, adaptability and competitiveness of Indian exporters, said exporters' body FIEO.

"The continued strong demand from traditional and emerging markets reflects increasing global confidence in Indian products and services," FIEO President SC Ralhan said. Export growth in FY26 was nearly flat with shipments posting a 0.93 per cent (year-on-year) growth to $441.78 billion.

INSIDE.

FM hints at more steps to attract foreign capital

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman has indicated that more measures are coming to attract foreign capital. She also said the government is ready for any kind of exigency.

"The withholding tax treatment we have offered will be the first step towards drawing foreign capital back, although at the moment it's confined to the bond market. But, certainly, that is not the end of story, there will be more. We recognise we need more foreign capital," she said.

Also read **p3**

WPI rises to 9.68% in May on pricey fuel

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

With food and fuel prices on a high, inflation based on the Wholesale Price Index surged to 9.68 per cent in May, the government reported on Monday. This is the first data based on the base year of 2022-23. The WPI was 8.26 per cent in April.

According to a Commerce Ministry statement, across major groups, yearly inflation for primary articles, fuel and power, and manufactured products was 4.99 per cent, 30.33 per cent, and 7.48 per cent, respectively, in May.

Details **p3**

Monsoon deficient by 32% during June 1-15: IMD

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

India received 42.4 mm rainfall in the first fortnight of the monsoon season that began on June 1, against the normal 62.1 mm, registering a deficit of 32 per cent.

Three of the four meteorological regions reported below-normal rain. Only North-West India reported 8 per cent surplus rain, and in terms of geographical areas, 65 per cent of India was rainfall deficient during June 1-15. According to IMD data, the south peninsular region received 68.2 mm rainfall until June 15.

Read more **p10**

HCLTech invests $150 m for 10.46% in Sarvam AI

Our Bureau
New Delhi

HCLTech on Monday said that it will invest $150 million (around ₹1,427 crore) as a lead strategic investor in Sarvam AI to pick up 10.46 per cent stake, with the aim of strengthening the artificial intelligence ecosystem in the country and beyond.

"By bringing together Sarvam's research in AI models with HCLTech's global presence, we are creating a full-stack AI platform for enterprises and governments," said C Vijayakumar, Chief Executive Officer and MD, HCLTech.

Also read **p2**

How urban slums have become new talent pipeline

Recruiters tap local communities to man retail, healthcare, gig economy in India, abroad

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

For Rajesh Chettiar and seven of his friends from Mumbai's Kandarpada slum in Dahisar, who left for Japan recently, it's a dramatic change in fortunes. Selected by a visiting delegation from Japan's Ehime Prefecture — seven for maintenance roles and one for welding — the young men underwent four-six months of Japanese language and vocational training at the Confederation of Indian Industry's Atal Bihari Vajpayee Kaushal Vikas Kendra in Kandivali.

EARNINGS JUMP

The skilling could result in their monthly earnings jumping from the ₹12,000-₹25,000 typically earned by high-school graduates or ITI-certified workers in India to between ₹80,000 and ₹1.6 lakh.

Their journey reflects a broader shift unfolding across India's cities as companies, hospitals, gig-economy platforms such as Urban Company and Snabbit, and even recruiters from abroad are taking young men and women from urban slums, upskilling them to power the retail, logistics, hospitality, healthcare and gig economy.

CHANGING FORTUNES. Students from Nihon Edutech, who left for Japan after studying at the Kandivali centre

"For decades, our cities have fed the slums; today, the slums are feeding the city's economy," points out a senior official at the Vajpayee Kaushal Vikas Kendra.

Organisations such as the CII and Nihon Edutech increasingly function as labour-market intermediaries, preparing candidates and matching them with employers in India and abroad. Beyond manufacturing and maintenance, workers are also being prepared for agricultural roles involving seeding, irrigation, harvesting, packaging and farm machinery operations under programmes such as Japan's Technical Intern Training Programme and Specified Skilled Worker scheme.

SOCIAL IMPACT

The transformation is being driven as much by employer necessity as social impact. Retailers, restaurant chains, logistics companies, hospitals and gig platforms are grappling with labour shortages, high attrition and rising recruitment costs. Increasingly, they are discovering that some of India's largest untapped labour pools lie inside low-income urban communities.

CII's Mumbai-based Vajpayee Kaushal Vikas Kendra has mapped 50 slum clusters across north Mumbai for direct recruitment drives and plans more than 100 job fairs under its Mission 2026 programme. The Kaushal Kendra initiative has facilitated more than 65,000 training and placement outcomes.

A similar trend is playing out in Bengaluru, where NGO Hasiru Dala is formalising waste pickers into contractors and micro-entrepreneurs through identity cards, insurance and direct contracts with apartment complexes and technology parks, helping workers move from dependence on middlemen to recognised service providers within the city's recycling economy.

Pune's Lighthouse Communities Foundation runs skilling centres inside low-income communities, targeting first-generation earners entering formal employment in sectors such as retail, healthcare assistance and customer support.

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QUICKLY.

SEPC secures ₹673 crore SAIL expansion project

Chennai: SEPC, formerly known as Shriram EPC, on Monday said it has secured an order worth ₹673 crore from public sector enterprise Steel Authority of India Ltd's IISCO Steel Plant. The industrial infrastructure engineering, procurement and construction company is set to work on a 4.08 mtpa crude steel expansion project for IISCO Steel Plant in Burnpur comprising two key packages under the expansion project. OUR BUREAU

AutoVRse raises $2.4 m in funding round

Mumbai: AutoVRse on Monday said it has raised $2.4 million in a funding round and will utilise the funds to deepen its presence in the global automotive supply chain and expand its smart-glasses-based real-time guidance product. The round was co-led by Singularity AMC's Large Value Fund III and Early Opportunities Fund and existing investor Lumikai. PTI

HCLTech invests ₹1,427 crore as lead investor in Sarvam AI

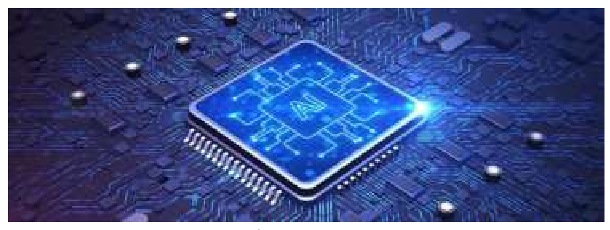
GOOD SHOW. The AI platform has raised around ₹2,218.61 cr in the first close of Series B

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Noida-based HCLTech on Monday said it will invest $150 million (around ₹1,427 crore) as a lead strategic investor in Sarvam AI to pick up 10.46 per cent stake, with an aim to strengthen the artificial intelligence ecosystem in the country, and beyond.

"Total investment of ₹1,427.25 crore...41,421 equity shares for a 10.46 per cent stake in Sarvam AI will be acquired," HCLTech said in a filing adding that investment will be through 100 per cent cash consideration. In total, the AI company has raised $234 million (around ₹2,218.61 crore) in the first close of its $300 million Series B at a post-money valuation of $1.5 billion.

The rest of the investment has been made by Bessemer Venture Partners, with continued support from existing investors Khosla Ventures and Peak XV Partners, the companies said. "By bringing together Sarvam's research in AI models with HCLTech's global presence, we are creating a differentiated full-stack AI platform for enterprises and governments, strengthening our ability to deliver secure, scalable, and responsible AI solutions," C Vijayakumar, MD & CEO, HCLTech, said.



LOCAL PUSH. In the last few months, Sarvam has released foundational models, all trained from scratch in India

Sarvam builds across the AI stack — training and inference infrastructure, frontier model research, and a go-to-market motion spanning enterprises, developers, and government.

SPEND ON R&D

The investment will fund Sarvam's continued research on training its next frontier model for agentic, coding, and cybersecurity use-cases, as well as access to compute at scale to expand its forward-deployed motion across key verticals, the companies said. "We are clear that research-led innovation to create AI that works at India's scale is a very large opportunity. That means models that understand our voices, read our documents, and serve intelligence at a cost every enterprise and government can afford," Pratyush Kumar, Co-Founder at Sarvam, said.

In the last few months, Sarvam has released foundational models, all trained from scratch in India. Sarvam 105B matches or outperforms larger reasoning models on knowledge, reasoning, and agentic benchmarks, while Sarvam 30B is optimised for the edge, running on consumer hardware, he said. Sarvam Vision, built for handwriting and Indian language records, is being used to digitise over 35 million pages from insurance forms to legacy land records.

Sarvam's speech models also work in India's complex settings, transcribing over half a million hours of audio each month.

'Funding is a good start but more needs to be done for India to own its AI stack'

Sindhu Hariharan
Chennai

As India's sovereign Artificial Intelligence (AI) model maker Sarvam turns unicorn with a funding round led by HCL Tech, the start-up believes that along with much-needed capital, the partnership will also help them hone their go-to-market skills for Enterprise AI use cases.

"AI has changed the way software is going to be written; so there is no doubt about the synergies between an IT services company and an AI company. HCL's investment in Sarvam helps to create a new generation company out of India," Sarvam Co-founder Vivek Raghavan told *businessline*. He clarified that there is no exclusivity agreement with HCL Tech regarding the use of Sarvam's models.

With HCL Tech's $150 million investment in return for a 10.46 per cent stake, Sarvam will use the money for training models, for inference at large scale, for agentic use cases, and more.

Raghavan noted that monetisation is important, but Sarvam will also continue to innovate in building larger models and deeper use cases. Sarvam is also ramping up hiring and focus will be to get more exceptional people in, he said.

"Predominantly everything will continue to be in India, but we will also get exceptional people who want to help India in this mission but are in the US," he added, speaking about the recent outreach in the US.

> Predominantly everything will continue to be in India. We will also get... people who want to help... but are in the US
>
> VIVEK RAGHAVAN
> Sarvam Co-founder

MORE CAPITAL NEEDED

"This is a good start, but as we look to build bigger models, the capital we have raised now is not sufficient, and we have to look at more avenues of capital surely," Raghavan said. "We have the opportunity to move faster towards the goals; we have lots of more work to do there," he said. Market traction has seen a boost after the momentum created by the India AI Summit.

"Since the Summit, both our voice AI capabilities and API uses have gone up by three-fold in 3 months. That's a significant increase in adoption, and we see that will continue," he added.

As for the impact of the Anthropic-US government fallout on India's sovereign AI ambitions, Raghavan said it is a sign of "what might happen" if we do not have sovereign AI stack. Given the rate at which models are increasing in capability every few weeks and months, more models will start falling into the advanced nature sooner, he noted.

"From a long-term perspective, we need to have the strength to do this [build our own models] ourselves. As a country, we need to have our own capability in the entire AI stack sovereign — from compute to models to agentic infrastructure and more."

As for the team's expectations from the policymakers, Sarvam flags the benefits that AI can bring to governance. One way the government can help is by being a large procurer of the sovereign AI models, and it will also lead to efficiency of services, Raghavan said.

Sarvam is confident of closing the remaining portion of the investment round within the next few weeks, but did not disclose the names of the investors.

Newly listed Vedanta firms slip below debut price

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Vedanta Group company stocks faced selling pressure after the fresh listing of four demerged business on the stock exchanges.

The shares ended below their opening price, with Vedanta Aluminium Metal, Vedanta Oil and Gas and Vedanta Iron and Steel plunging 5 per cent each to ₹501, ₹37 and ₹21, respectively, while Vedanta Power was down one per cent at ₹41.

The parent holding company Vedanta dipped two per cent to ₹303.

Netra Deshpande, Research Analyst, Mirae Asset ShareKhan, said all four stocks will be transacted in the trade-to-trade segment which requires compulsory delivery on every order during the initial 10 sessions. Vedanta and Vedanta Aluminium are expected to retain their large-cap status as a result of their higher DII participation post-listing, whereas Vedanta Power, Vedanta Oil & Gas, and Vedanta Iron & Steel are likely to be classified as small-caps, she added. Earlier on the occasion of listing ceremony of demerged entities, Anil Agarwal, Chairman, Vedanta, said the company is conscious about its dividend payments and aims to remain a dividend-paying company while simultaneously creating long-term value.

Ashishkumar Chauhan, CEO of NSE, along with Anil Agarwal, Chairman, Vedanta Group, during the NSE closing bell ceremony in Mumbai on Monday, marking the listing of four newly demerged companies on the stock exchanges PTI

COMPANY PROFILE

Vedanta Aluminium will be third-largest aluminium producer globally outside China. It has an aluminium smelter at Jharsuguda, Odisha, with a production capacity of 30 lakh tonne per annum. It plans to double its capacity over the next three years, with a clear ambition to become the world's largest and low-cost, fully integrated aluminium producer.

With a debt-free balance sheet, Vedanta Oil & Gas plans to invest about $5 billion over the next three to five years to scale production to 5 lakh barrels per day at globally competitive costs. Its growth portfolio spans tight oil, shale gas, shallow-water and deep-water assets, satellite fields as well as significant acreage in Assam and the North-East — the region where Asia's first oil well was drilled.

Vedanta Iron & Steel plans to increase its capacity to 15 mtpa from about 4 mtpa. It enjoys a unique competitive advantage through security of three critical inputs: nearly 4 billion tonnes of iron ore resources in Goa, Odisha and Karnataka.

Vedanta Power is the fifth-largest thermal power producer with 4.2 GW of operational capacity supported by long-term power purchase agreements and secure coal mines.

Airtel secures shareholder approval to consolidate stake in Airtel Africa

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

Bharti Airtel (Airtel) on Monday informed that nearly 100 per cent of its shareholders have approved the ongoing transaction to consolidate its stake in key strategic subsidiary Airtel Africa for around ₹28,220 crore. The transaction, upon consummation and subject to receipt of all requisite regulatory approvals, will increase Airtel's effective stake in Airtel Africa to around 79 per cent from the current 62.73 per cent. "The company has always operated at the highest standards... and this overwhelming support reinforces the confidence that the investors have in the organisation," Sunil Bharti Mittal, Founder and Chairman, Bharti Enterprises, said.

DEAL DETAILS

The transaction involves Airtel issuing equity shares to Indian Continent Investment Ltd, a promoter group entity, on a preferential basis, in exchange for its 16.31 per cent stake in Airtel Africa.

In business you win some, you lose some, says Vedanta Group Chairman

bl.interview

Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai

The much-awaited demerger of the Vedanta Group has been completed, with four businesses — oil and gas, power, aluminium, and iron and steel — now listed separately on the stock exchanges.

Chairman Anil Agarwal says each of the five listed companies could grow into a $100 billion business. He downplays missing out on Jaiprakash Associates, saying in business, you win some and lose some.

Edited excerpts:

What are your growth plans for the newly listed companies?

Vedanta Resources was initially listed in London. The company name was changed to Vedanta before listing in India. All our businesses — oil and gas, copper, zinc and aluminium — were under one company. So it was like a big banyan tree.

Now, all the companies have grown well and ready to create substantial shareholder value.

We always look for businesses which are import substitute. We enjoy establishing ourselves in difficult business because only then we can be import substitute. We are the only producer of nickel in India.

There is huge requirement for nickel. We are focusing on that. We have other critical metals, including magnesium which is in short supply.

Each of the listed five companies can become a $100 billion separately because there is a huge demand and supply gap.

Most of your business are also facing headwinds?

Challenges will always be there in business. We will overcome it. We have created so many jobs.

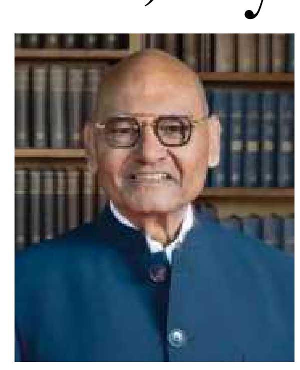
We have 2 lakh people working directly and another 10 lakh people indirectly for us. The biggest beneficiary of all our companies is the government.

We pay tax of about ₹60,000 crore every year. And we are very conscious of anything we do. People talk about charity. Setting up a factory and creating sustainable jobs is bigger than charity.

We also create jobs in downstream markets. There can be about 150 products developed from the primary metals we produce.

We will handhold about 400 downstream companies to develop products from zinc, oil and gas and power. I told the BSE Managing Director (Sundararaman Ramamurthy) people who develop downstream business with Vedanta will come and list to raise money.

> Each of the listed five companies can become a $100 billion separately because there is a huge demand and supply gap
>
> ANIL AGARWAL
> Chairman, Vedanta Group



Can investors expect a liberal dividend policy since the newly listed companies are in growth stage?

We have always paid dividend and it will continue going forward. It will be decided by the board of each company. We will create tremendous value for shareholder.

This is possible because cost-wise we are internationally competent.

We are not looking for any external support.

Our aluminium production cost is the lowest. The same is true with steel, oil and gas, zinc and silver we produce.

Are you looking at reviving the copper plant in Thoothukudi, with a new government in Tamil Nadu?

The people of Thoothukudi are very favourable for the project. I know a progressive government has come to power in the State.

Whatever decision they take we are ready to work with them. As a Group, copper is a very small part of the business, but it is the heart and soul, since we started with that.

Do you consider losing Jaiprakash Associates a missed opportunity?

We tried our best. In business you gain something and lose something. There are no big heart breaks as being projected. We are ready to move on.

Do you think lack of captive bauxite ore as a challenge for the aluminium business?

In aluminium, we want to become integrated company. There is a case with OMC (Odisha Mining Corporation).

There was one mine that we wanted to start but were not able to due to delays.

However, we have two big mines and we have already started working on it. We will become 100 per cent self-sufficient in few months.

It is very unfortunate that we have a larger deposit of bauxite, but still importing. We all are working with the government.

Wherever a bauxite mine is opened up, the whole area becomes like *Ram Rajya*. So much of development happens.

It is unfortunate that I am the front-runners and take all the heat. The people who come behind us get all the benefits.

Will the oil and gas business sustain capex plans without inter-corporate dependability?

The oil and gas business has great potential. We have announced a capex of $5 billion to increase exploration.

The demerged oil and gas company will have annual EBITDA expectation is about $900 million. We have no debt in that company.

It is probably the only oil and gas company in the world with no debt but has huge value of the asset. Its value can be $100 billion. It has $1 billion EBITDA.

People are keen to give us equipment and technology. We are absolutely comfortable to spend $5 billion with our internal resource and completing this project.

It should not be any hindrance to invest in oil and gas.

What are your plans for iron and steel?

We want to have 15 million tonne capacity in next three years all through brownfield expansion in Bokaro (Jharkhand) and Bellary (Karnataka). In fact, we can go beyond 15 mtpa in future. Steel is an attractive sector and India will require about 300 million tonnes by 2030. My long-term vision is to build a 50-million-tonne especially steel business.

Lower base effect, GST rate cut fuel automobile sales growth in May

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

Driven by the lower base effect of previous year and demand created by the reduction in Goods and Services Tax (GST), domestic automobile wholesales across categories grew 17.3 per cent year-on-year (y-o-y) to 24,11,783 units in May against 20,55,714 units in the same month last year.

The total domestic passenger vehicle wholesales grew 27.3 per cent y-o-y to 4,38,854 units in May, up from 3,44,656 units in May 2025, according to the monthly sales data released by the Society of Indian Automobile Manufacturers (SIAM) on Monday. The two-wheeler dispatches also grew 14.8 per cent y-o-y to 19,02,209 units during last month. In the motorcycles segment, the dispatches grew 7.2 per cent to 11,13,973 units in May. The total scooters sales grew 27.4 per cent y-o-y to 7,39,667 units (5,80,696 units), the SIAM data showed. The total three-wheelers dispatches also grew 31 per cent y-o-y to 70,720 units during last month compared with 53,942 units in May 2025.

Domestic sales

Segment/ sub-segment	May 2025	May 2026	y-o-y % change
Total PVs	3,44,656	4,38,854	27.3
Total three-wheelers	53,942	70,720	31.0
Scooters	5,80,696	7,39,667	27.4
Motorcycles	10,39,156	11,13,973	7.2
Total two-wheelers	16,57,116	19,02,209	14.8
Grand total of all categories	**20,55,714**	**24,11,783**	**17.3**

Source: SIAM

EXPORT MARKET

"Passenger vehicles, three-wheelers and two-wheelers recorded highest ever sales of May in 2026, with high double-digit growth in each segment," Rajesh Menon, Director General, SIAM, said.

In terms of exports, May was one of the best months with a growth of 30.6 per cent y-o-y to 6,25,731 units against 4,79,538 units in May 2025. The two-wheeler exports grew 31.3 per cent y-o-y to 5,00,075 units. Companies such as Bajaj Auto, TVS Motor Company and Hero MotoCorp had reported good set of export numbers during the month.

The exports of passenger vehicles grew 13.2 per cent y-o-y to 76,051 units. Total three-wheeler exports also recorded growth of 56 per cent y-o-y to 48,513 units last month against 31,084 units in May 2025.

MM Forgings to install new hot forging press

T E Raja Simhan
Chennai

Chennai-based automotive component manufacturer MM Forgings Ltd is investing in capacity addition and is installing a new forging press, targeting revenue of nearly ₹2,000 crore in FY27.

"We are installing the world's largest 16,500 tonne hot forging press in an investment of ₹230crore to enhance its ability to manufacture heavy forged components for global commercial vehicle manufacturers," MM Forgings CMD Vidyashankar Krishnan told *businessline*. "The largest forging press currently operating in the world is a 16,000 tonne unit at Bharat Forge. Our new press will be larger," he said.

Vidyashankar Krishnan, CMD, MM Forgings Ltd BIJOY GHOSH

The new forging press, manufactured in Russia and scheduled for commissioning by the end of the year, will enable MM Forgings to manufacture heavier front axle beams used in large commercial vehicles, as also crankshafts up to 300 kg in weight. Current facilities can forge components weighing up to about 120 kg, while the new press will be capable of handling axle beams weighing 170+ kg, opening opportunities in global heavy-truck markets, he said..

CAPACITY EXPANSION

MM Forgings currently has an overall installed capacity of 1.2 lakh tonnes, which will rise to more than 1.5 lakh tonnes after the expansion, he said. For FY27, the company targets one lakh tonnes of sales, supported by improved domestic demand and an expected recovery in the US commercial vehicle market. It expects to cross 90,000 tonnes in FY27, he said. Domestic business contributed about 65 per cent of FY26 revenue, while exports accounted for the balance.

"We expect revenue to rise to ₹1,800-₹1,900 crore this fiscal and could touch ₹2,000 crore if market conditions remain favourable," he said.

Alongside capacity expansion, MM Forgings is accelerating factory automation to address labour shortages.

The company plans to deploy more than 150 industrial robots in a couple of years and eventually increase the number to 600-800 robots across its manufacturing operations over the next three to four years, Krishnan said.

FM hints at more steps to boost foreign inflows

CRISIS-READY. Sitharaman highlights RBI-backed measures to reduce hedging risks, assures preparedness to handle monsoon and import pressures

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Monday indicated more measures are on the way to attract foreign capital. She also assured that the government is ready for any kind of exigencies.

"The withholding tax treatment which we have offered will be the first step towards drawing foreign capital back, although at the moment it is confined to bond market. But certainly, that is not the end of story, there will be more. We recognise we need more foreign capital to come in," Sitharaman said while addressing the 'Mindmine Summit', organised by Hero Enterprises.

RBI SUPPORT

"But the fact [is] that the RBI has now allowed public sector undertakings and banks to go out and pick money from outside, giving them a framework in which they can do it. And in that framework, a very important aspect is the hedging is at the RBI's expense," the Finance Minister said.

Further, they don't have to hedge for risks, particularly currency-related risks, volatility and exchange rate risk. That will be on RBI. As a result, the banks can now raise their own returns unfettered.

GEARING UP. Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman and Chairman of Hero Enterprise Sunil Kant Munjal during the Mindmine Summit 2026 in New Delhi on Monday ANI

"We have taken a very calibrated approach to make sure that the markets do see the value," she said.

On June 5, the government promulgated an ordinance to exempt foreign portfolio investors, overseas investors and the Bank for International Settlements from capital gains tax on interest and trading gains from government bonds.

Effective April 1, the move replaces the previous regime, under which short-term capital gains were taxed at 30 per cent and long-term capital gains on sovereign securities at 12.5 per cent.

BOND MARKET

In addition to the ordinance, the Finance Ministry said all new 15-year, 30-year and 40-year government bonds will be part of a fully accessible route.

Also, caps on short-term foreign investment in bonds, concentration limits and the buying of individual bonds have been removed.

On its part, the Reserve Bank of India endeavoured to boost dollar inflows by rolling out discounted forex swaps and statutory exemptions for banks on NRI deposits through September while expanding non-resident equity investment limits and extending the export realisation window to nine months.

On June 12, the Finance Ministry notified an amendment in the Foreign Exchange Management (Non-debt Instruments) Rules that removes a long-standing restriction that limited portfolio investment under the scheme to non-resident Indians and Overseas Citizens of India, potentially bringing foreign retail and institutional investors into a market that has so far remained largely out of their direct reach.

Meanwhile, on the challenges, Sitharaman said imports were under stress, and there is also the monsoon issue.

"We are preparing for a not so good monsoon. Though buffer stock of foodgrains is good but farmer's income will be under stress," she said. At the same time, there are issues with fertilizers. Between the date of the Budget presentation and now, there have been various challenges with fertilizers.

"First, some countries, who were suppliers, held their supply to meet their own. Then the news arrived of China coming back in the market," she said. "We are ready for any exigencies," she assured.

India records $4.7 b current account surplus in April

Press Trust of India
Mumbai

India recorded a current account surplus of $4.7 billion in April as against a deficit of $4.8 billion in the year-ago month, on the back of higher services exports and net transfer receipts, according to an RBI release on Monday.

The import bill was at $72.5 billion, up from $65.8 billion, while exports stood at $44.6 billion compared to $38.7 billion, according to preliminary data on India's Balance of Payments. The merchandise trade deficit stood at $27.9 billion against $27.1 billion. Services exports stood at $37 billion, while imports were $18.4 billion. Net transfers rose to $16 billion from $9.4 billion.

WPI rises to 9.68% in May on pricey fuel; Producer Price Index debuts

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

With food and fuel prices high, wholesale inflation based on Wholesale Price Index (WPI) surged to 9.68 per cent in May, the government reported on Monday. This is the first data based on the new base year of 2022-23.

Wholesale inflation was 8.26 per cent in April.

According to a statement by the Commerce Ministry, across major groups, yearly inflation for primary articles, fuel and power, and manufactured products is 4.99 per cent, 30.33 per cent and 7.48 per cent, respectively, in May whereas it was 3.78 per cent, 24.89 per cent and 6.68 per cent earlier. The sharp rise in WPI inflation reflects the impact of the West Asia crisis and the effective blockade of the Strait of Hormuz through which the majority of the crude oil is imported to India, and its spillover effect on food prices.

WPI inflation rate

(All rates in %)

Groups/ Major groups	Dec-25 (F)	Jan-26 (F)	Feb-26 (F)	Mar-26 (F)	Apr-26 (P)	May-26 (P)
All commodities	0.3	1.19	2.18	3.98	8.26	9.68
I. Primary articles	-2.78	-0.09	1.64	2.58	3.78	4.99
II. Fuel and power	-2.63	-3.83	-3.37	3.2	24.89	30.33
III. Mfrs products	2.22	2.82	3.61	4.8	6.68	7.48
Food index	-2.53	-0.36	1.27	1.92	3.11	4.49

Source: EA Industry; (F)-Final, (P)-Provisional

Across groups, 'mineral oils (containing petroleum products)', 'crude petroleum and natural gas', 'manufacture of chemicals and chemical products' and 'manufacture of basic metals' have been major drivers of WPI inflation in April and May.

The Food Index consists of 'food articles' from primary articles major group and 'manufacture of food products' from manufactured products major group. It observed a y-o-y inflation of 4.49 per cent in May compared to 3.11 per cent in April.

KEY FEATURES

The statement added that the total number of items under the new series had increased from 697 to 957. New sources of energy, such as solar and wind, had been added under the 'electricity' group. In addition, nuclear electricity had been included in the basket. Crude petroleum and natural gas had been shifted from 'primary articles' to the 'fuel and power' major group. This reorganisation had been done to ensure better alignment, as this group already houses other major fuels such as coal, electricity and petroleum products.

Gross value of output (GVO) has been used for preparing weights for WPI 2022-23 series, compared to net traded value, that is, GVO + Imports – Exports, used in WPI 2011-12 series.

The Ministry also released the All India Output Producer Price Index for all commodities, which recorded 109.6 in May as against 108.6 in April. Across major groups, indices for agriculture, forestry and fishing, mining and quarrying, manufactured products, and electricity are 111.9, 122.3, 109.5, and 90.2, respectively, in May, whereas they were 111.2, 122.5, 108.3 and 90.6, respectively, in April.

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Tentative peace

Promise of US Iran deal, a big relief

For the first time in nearly four months of the US-Iran-Israel war, there are strong signs that at least US and Iran are inclined to end it. In his usual bombastic manner, US President Donald Trump said on Sunday that the 'deal' was done, and 'oil would flow' through the Straits of Hormuz very soon. The details of the agreement that will likely be signed by US and Iran in Geneva on Friday are not accurately known as no written statement has been issued from either side.

However, it is the first time in these months that Iran has, through its top officials, confirmed that a 'memorandum of understanding' has been firmed up. So, the world is faced with a realistic chance of returning to a semblance of peace, normal trade and economic activity, even if it takes a year or so to get there. Yet, there is the dark chance of Israel sabotaging any pact before the ink runs dry. On balance, there are enough reasons for the US to end the war. It has promised and sought a 60- day ceasefire as part of the 'deal' to work out 'technical details'. US inflation at 4.2 per cent in May was the highest in three years. Trump is up against a restive electorate in the upcoming mid-terms in November. A war that appears to have begun on Israel's prodding has visibly lost all direction and purpose. Regime change has not been accomplished and Iran's so-called nuclear stockpile (if at all it exists) has not been unearthed. Instead, the US ended up handing control of the Strait of Hormuz to Iran, and with it, control of oil supplies to the world.

Iran might have been devastated, but it has inflicted huge damage on infrastructure and oil facilities in its neighbourhood. US and Israel never looked like winning, and at least Trump needed a respectable exit. Iran too would like to recover its huge losses, but it seems to have had the upper hand in the 'deal' that is in the making. Meanwhile, the markets bounced back in wild relief on Monday, with the Sensex rising 1 per cent and the rupee gaining 47 paise to the dollar, while Brent crude fell over 5 per cent.

For the world, including India, the most important issue is the status of movement on the Strait of Hormuz. About half of India's oil supplies and 70 per cent of LNG is sourced from the Gulf region. However, the statements so far do not clearly state whether movement will be levy-free. After Trump said in a social media post that movement shall be toll-free, he seems to have corrected himself later to say that the Straits will be open for demining. Iran's state news agency has reported that the Straits will be open, subject to "Iranian arrangements". The 60-day ceasefire is meant to work out details regarding Iran's nuclear programme. A promise to lift sanctions on Iran, including its frozen assets, would lift world trade prospects. India would perhaps be able to curtail oil and fertilizer imports, and with it the current account deficit over the next few months. Hopefully, this may not turn out to be as bad a year for India as most expected.

POCKET

RAVIKANTH

CKG NAIR
V SHUNMUGHAM

India needs a supply chain resilience fund

CRITICAL SUPPLIES. India is import dependent on oil, critical minerals and gold. To counter supply disruptions a cohesive set of laws is the need of the hour

The classic Mundell-Fleming trilemma — the idea that an open economy cannot simultaneously fix its exchange rate, control monetary policy, and allow free capital flows — is well known. Less discussed is the impossible growth trinity India faces: three key import dependencies that do not diminish as the economy grows but instead become more entrenched with each percentage point increase in GDP.

Donald Trump's shifting policies have heightened this vulnerability. It is a structural issue with three main components.

The first is energy. India relies on imports for over 90 per cent of its crude oil, and the IEA forecasts demand will increase by one million barrels per day by 2030, surpassing other nations. A less recognised aspect is the cumulative impact: each new industrial corridor, IT hub, or data centre further adds to India's inelastic import bill. Without the buffers, diversification, and routing options that other advanced economies established years earlier, India cannot simply grow its way out of energy dependence.

The second component, gold, presents a paradox. Indian households are estimated to possess around 32,000 tonnes of gold, valued at roughly $4.7 trillion at current rates — more than India's GDP for FY25. Additionally, temples, trusts, and the RBI hold another 5,000 tonnes. India is both the world's largest private gold holder and one of its top importers, with FY26 imports reaching a record $72 billion. These imports continue not because India lacks gold, but because much of its gold is kept outside the financial system. During periods of global uncertainty — of which FY26 had several — there's a tendency to shift from bank deposits to bullion, which worsens the current account deficit precisely when external conditions are most challenging.

The third component gets the least focus and poses the greatest future risk. India imported electronics and components worth over $120 billion in FY 2025-26, with semiconductors as the fastest-growing category. Electric vehicles require lithium, cobalt, and nickel — none of which India produces at scale. Defence modernisation relies heavily on advanced electronics sourced mostly from abroad.

Building a manufacturing export strategy around semiconductor-heavy industries — electronics, EVs, defence — without strategic stockpiles of chips or minerals exposes a structural vulnerability similar to that long existing in energy.

Energy, gold, and critical minerals constitute the so-called impossible growth trinity. In FY26, total imports reached $979 billion, while exports were $860 billion. Under pressure, this gap widens: imports remain inelastic, and exports are hit hard by disruptions, including increased freight costs, uncertain inputs, and buyers shifting their orders elsewhere. Rather than easing with growth, this trinity becomes more strained.

WHAT PEERS BUILT

Japan and South Korea share India's energy dependency but not its vulnerability. Japan's Economic Security Promotion Act designates critical goods, including semiconductors and crude oil, and requires supply plans for each, deeming industrial continuity a national security issue. Japan's industry ministry approved eight semiconductor supply plans supported by ¥100 billion in subsidies, with another ¥100 billion allocated to domestic chip manufacturing.

South Korea's Framework Act on Supply Chain extends further: it establishes a Supply Chain Committee, implements a three-year rolling resilience plan, designates critical items, and introduces an early warning system. Additionally, it has a KRW 50 billion annual Stabilisation Fund for key minerals and a KRW 50 trillion fund for semiconductors, batteries, and biopharma. Even as the 2026 Hormuz disruption peaked, South Korea's current-account surplus reached a record $37.33 billion in March 2026 alone, with exports surging 57 per cent year-on- year — the direct dividend of a supply-chain architecture enshrined in law before it was needed. In Korea's approach, the law, the fund, and the export strategy serve as integrated instruments.

India should establish a statutory Supply Chain Resilience Fund modelled after Korea's, with official designation of critical goods, co-investment requirements for semiconductors, critical minerals, EV battery inputs, and defence components

China has spent 20 years responding by developing its domestic chip industry, building strategic petroleum stocks totalling 1.5 billion barrels, and physically bypassing the Strait of Hormuz via the ESPO overland oil pipeline and the Power of Siberia gas pipeline. The April 2026 State Council regulations on supply-chain security formalised a long-standing practice: maintaining critical input supplies is a government responsibility, not solely a market-driven outcome.

WHAT INDIA MUST DO

India's semiconductor ambitions, including the India Semiconductor Mission and approved fabs at Tata Electronics and CG Power, are a promising start. However, a fab alone is not enough without a supply chain law to serve as a foundation. India should establish a statutory Supply Chain Resilience Fund modelled after Korea's, with official designation of critical goods, co-investment requirements for semiconductors, critical minerals, EV battery inputs, and defence components. An early warning system to monitor supply stress before crises occur is essential. A dedicated Supply Chain Resilience Fund — a Korea-style instrument that India does not yet have — would need to be seeded at no less than ₹50,000-75,000 crore to be credible at scale. Clearly, a case for export-insurance: India's FY 2025-26 merchandise exports stood at $441.8 billion; preserving even 1 per cent of that base through a disruption year — holding inventories, securing alternative sources and maintaining logistics — saves $4.4 billion, a return that justifies the fund's cost many times over in a single shock event.

The issue with gold is financial, not fiscal. India holds $4.7 trillion in privately held gold. To make this asset productive, investing in gold ETFs, using derivatives, fiscally incentivising the substitution of physical imports, and developing a liquid domestic gold-derivatives market can transform a $72 billion yearly import into a local financial activity. The demand for bullion, driven by savings, is logical and will not be suppressed. It can be redirected if the domestic financial instrument is genuinely competitive with imported gold bars.

India possesses the ambition, market capacity, and emerging policy tools. Initiatives like the India Semiconductor Mission, the UAE energy partnership, and critical minerals diplomacy are in place. However, what's lacking is a cohesive legislative backbone, a funded stockpile to cushion future shocks, and the institutional urgency to act while opportunities remain. This trinity is not just a forecast. It exists.

Nair is former Director of National Institute of Securities Markets; Shumugam is Partner, MCQube

Can an AI platform hold a music copyright?

Indian laws do not guarantee any ownership to AI generated music. Transfer of ownership from platform to user is doubtful

Sundar Athreya

Copyright law was traditionally envisioned to achieve the goal of 'promoting learning' and it had adopted the mechanism of affording monopoly to the creator to achieve this end. The creator did not have the sufficient financial means to undertake the task of printing, and it necessitated a financier. This was the structure of the eighteenth-century print world. The monopoly that was afforded to the creator benefitted the large-scale print houses, who became the owner of the work leaving the creator with very limited rights.

The norms of print business have changed over the course of time. Internet and other industries for social expression have democratised the creation and dissemination of knowledge. The law, now, supports its owners by increasing the tenure of Copyright protection and digital rights to keep them behind a pay wall. This has made the law counterproductive. The law that was meant to promote creativity has become the very law that prohibits creativity. If the user cannot utilise the existing creation, newer works cannot emerge. This had raised the need to challenge the hegemony of the copyright owner.

Internet had blurred the line between the creator and the consumer. The consumer who was a passive spectator of art has become an active creator.

The copyright system now experiences further strain because of the inroads made by AI. A consumer who has never had any formal training in painting, can generate paintings in the style of Rembrandt at a click of a button. Similarly, a music listener without any training can generate songs by providing lyrics and few prompts to the AI platforms. But who owns the song is a question that remains unanswered.

AUTHORSHIP OF MUSIC

Does providing written prompts to the AI platform enable someone to be the author of the song? The Indian copyright law, like its counterparts, expects the author to be a human to qualify for authorship of the work. It is based on the logic that copyright law was created to promote and incentivise human creativity.

The songs generated by these platforms have the capability to raise monetary value and can even replace the human creation in the future for a cheaper cost. Delhi High Court at present, is grappled with the important question whether compositions generated by SUNO AI merit copyright protection.

AI MUSIC. Who owns it? GETTY IMAGES

At present the Indian laws do not guarantee any ownership towards AI generated music, which is the main reason behind this suit. However, the platform through its agreement with its paid user claims that it owns the music (composition) that is generated through it.

A user with a premium subscription of the platform is bestowed with ownership over the work as per its policy. What remains unanswered is, does the platform own the right in a song that is generated through it? If the answer to that is no, the platform cannot pass on a title to its user that it never had in the first place.

The answer has long-term implications; the platform has gained acceptance from the users even though it does not meet the existing norms of authorship under copyright law. The platform has managed to alter the music business across the world and India. The platform at present has over one million paid users and more than a hundred million people have used it to create songs, and $2.45 billion now.

The numbers have been impressive and signal the relevance of this platform. It had managed to enter a contract with Warner Music Group to train on its content, such licenses would signal legitimacy of the training.

However, the lack of clarity around its authorship raises question, would it deter users from dabbling with it in the future? Or would it be an inconsequential question as users continue to use the platform even if they do not get rights that are granted to the owners?

The writer is President & Head - Campus Operations, Manipal Academy of BFSI

LETTERS TO EDITOR

Send your letters by email to bleditor@thehindu.co.in or by post to 'Letters to the Editor', The Hindu Business Line, Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002.

Clean fuel

Apropos 'Nitin Gadkari clears E100 fuel framework' (June 15). The Union Government's approval of E100 fuel, enabling vehicles to operate on 100 per cent ethanol, represents a transformative milestone in India's energy architecture.

The initiative seeks to curtail the nation's chronic dependence on imported crude oil, thereby enhancing energy security and conserving foreign exchange reserves. By fostering a robust domestic ethanol ecosystem, the policy is expected to invigorate the agricultural sector, particularly sugarcane cultivation and allied industries.

Ethanol's comparatively lower carbon footprint also aligns with India's decarbonisation objectives. Nevertheless, the transition necessitates substantial investments in production capacity, distribution infrastructure, and vehicle adaptation to realise its full potential.

N Sadhasiva Reddy
Bengaluru

Jobs and AI

Apropos 'Will employment rise in age of AI?' (June 15), The policy silence, not AI itself, is the real threat. Jevons Paradox and Schumpeter's creative destruction reassure markets, yet they ignore the human ledger. If one algorithm replaces 10 coders, shareholders gain while 10 families face rent and bills.

The IT boom of the 2000s raised output without lasting jobs, and governments now carry debt they cannot spend away. Welfare cannot substitute for work that sustains dignity. We need skill funds tied to apprenticeships, portable benefits for gig roles, and incentives for firms that hire while automating. Growth must widen the circle of earners, not just efficiency.

K Chidanand Kumar
Bengaluru

This refers to the article 'Will employment rise in age of AI?' (June 15).

The comparison with the IT boom of the 2000s is apt and sobering. Productivity gains from technology have rarely translated into jobs in India, and AI may follow the same pattern unless policy steps are taken. Simply hoping that new jobs will emerge to replace displaced ones is not a strategy. Government investment in reskilling programmes, particularly for routine white-collar roles most exposed to automation, are needed now. Equally, sectors with genuine labour absorption capacity, such as care work, construction, and small manufacturing, deserve more attention.

Abbharna Barathi
Chennai

Expand crackdown

Apropos 'FSSAI cracks down on misleading brands & their claims' (June 15). Although belated, this is a welcome move.

However, the issue is not confined to food items but even to plant nutrients, yield and plant growth enhancers – which influence the farmers to choose a product oblivious of its ill effects on Agri produce.

Likewise, several attractive advertisements also claim on pest and insect control, soil health etc which are becoming more popular than scientifically recommended products. There must be an immediate crackdown on these ads to prevent contamination of food produce since it is resulting in rejection of Indian Agri produce, recent examples being rice and red chilli rejection by China.

Rajiv Magal
Halekere Village (Karnataka)

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Managing credit risk

Credit risk management should be sophisticated

K Srinivasa Rao

BALANCING ACT. Risk mitigation shouldn't hurt business prospects

While banks are actively preparing to adopt the expected credit loss (ECL) framework and migrate to the Basel 3.1 framework from April 1, 2027, the recent surge in credit risk due to geopolitical developments has added new dimensions to credit risk management (CRM). Banks, however, are in a strong position, with gross non-performing assets (GNPA) at 1.73 per cent in March 2026, down from 2.22 per cent in March 2025, and a strong capital adequacy ratio of 17.68 per cent.

Banks should be prepared to make additional provisions for the expected deterioration in asset quality under the ECL, and even if aggregate risk-weighted assets are low under the Foundation Internal Ratings-Based (FIRB) approach which the lenders may migrate to or under Basel 3.1. These two key regulatory policy measures can strengthen CRM but may impinge upon some key performance parameters such as NIM/ROA/EPS unless proactive measures are taken.

CRM DATA

Since the ECL framework calls for a minimum of five years of data to compute its components — probability of default (PD), loss given default (LGD), and exposure at default (EAD) — a look at past data will be pertinent. The ratio of loan assets to total assets was 61 per cent in FY22, which jumped to 64.5 per cent by FY26, with an average loan-to-total assets ratio over the last five years of 62.6 per cent. Similarly, among the risk-weighted assets (RWAs) forming the basis for computing the capital adequacy ratio (CAR), RWAs on loan assets were 82.1 per cent in FY22, rising to 84.8 per cent by FY26. The data clearly indicate that in the risk management hierarchy, CRM is the backbone of the risk architecture and has a major impact on balance sheet management. Credit risk intelligence must be so sharp and data-driven that composition of loan assets, internal and external ratings, risk weights, risk-based pricing, and trends in PD, LGD, EAD, SMA, and CRILC data should be under close scrutiny.

As banks move towards the Basel 3.1 framework, even if the RBI has not approved migration to the FIRB model, banks should run it as a parallel model alongside the conservative mandatory standardised approach to determine how close the risk weighted architecture to the 72.5 per cent floor limit enshrined in Basel 3.1, so that compliance is possible as soon as the RBI permits FIRB and to later adopt advanced credit risk assessment approaches. The four-year transition period can serve as a springboard for adopting the international CRM standards by March 2031.

The tighter regulatory norms call for rewriting the rule book of CRM. Right from sourcing the credit, through sanction and disbursement, monitoring, control, and intervention, and ultimately to debt resolution, the process should be quality-focused and risk-weight-sensitive.

Credit risk governance and board oversight may need to extend not only to the asset-liability management structure, growth in balance sheet, profitability, asset quality, but also to the composition of RWAs to ensure healthy growth of the credit portfolio. The risk-based internal audit teams should be persuaded to guide management on economising on risk weights without compromising business potential.

The CRM teams — sourcing, managing, and risk intelligence — should be developed with different objectives but all of them converging into one outcome — competitive asset quality with sustained risk-adjusted returns while consuming low capital, making the aggregate credit portfolio less risky. This needs a mix of loan assets phased over a 5-7-year time-frame, using strategic AI tools for better forecasting and developing a CRM vision with shifting year-on-year goals.

Moving from a credit growth model of 'let it grow' to 'make it grow' is the critical factor in changing the mix of loan assets over time.

The writer is an Adjunct Professor, Institute of Insurance and Risk Management, Hyderabad. Views are personal

India shouldn't shy away from frontier AI

CAPABILITY BUILDING. Democratisation of intelligence inside a nation's own borders is essential for economic dynamism and societal benefit

DEBJANI GHOSH

Frontier AI models have crossed a threshold. They are instruments of national power, economic dominance, and strategic advantage. As their capabilities grow, governments seem to be becoming less willing to leave decisions about access entirely to laboratories and markets. The perimeter of export control is expanding — from advanced chips and manufacturing equipment towards access to the models themselves.

The power these models carry is extraordinary. They can accelerate pandemic preparedness, democratise world-class education, raise farmer incomes through precise advisory systems, and enable genuine cross-border collaboration that lifts prosperity for everyone. Few technologies have offered comparable potential for broadly shared human progress.

Yet greater capability has not produced a commensurate commitment to shared access. Instead, it has intensified the race for strategic advantage. Governments and companies are erecting walls around capabilities that could otherwise accelerate development across the world.

So, is the real danger that AI will become too powerful... or is it that its power will become too concentrated in too few hands?

DIFFUSING INTELLIGENCE?

As we navigate the road ahead, we must stop wasting precious time debating diffusion versus development. Democratisation of intelligence inside a nation's own borders is essential for economic dynamism and societal benefit.

But when the core models that matter most are controlled by a handful of labs and the governments that regulate them, it forces an uncomfortable question: are countries diffusing intelligence they truly control — or merely distributing imported capability that can be withdrawn when a crisis or geopolitical calculation demands it?

This is not an either-or decision. Sovereign production of intelligence is non-negotiable. It gives us the ability to turn a nation's own data, institutions, talent, and strategic priorities into world-class frontier capability that no foreign power can switch off.

Some also argue that India should concentrate on smaller, vertical and domain-specific models rather than compete at the frontier. The first part of that argument is right. The conclusion is not.

> India needs at least a few truly powerful national frontier models if it is to achieve genuine technological self-reliance

Smaller models are already demonstrating substantial value in agentic systems. They can be developed faster, operated more cheaply and aligned more precisely with particular languages, industries and public priorities. India should move aggressively to build and deploy them in healthcare, agriculture, education, financial services, law, manufacturing and public administration. But India also needs at least a few truly powerful national frontier models if it is to achieve genuine technological self-reliance.

India is not starting from zero. Organisations such as Sarvam AI, BharatGen, Fractal AI and others have demonstrated serious technical ambition and an understanding of India's linguistic and developmental requirements. And I am sure the country can mobilise the necessary financing. The real task is prioritisation and ruthless channelisation. Money must move at the speed of the technology, not the speed of normal bureaucratic processes. And, we need the right talent.

LEADING ARCHITECTS

Indians are among the leading model architects and researchers powering frontier laboratories around the world. One of the highest-leverage moves India can make is to create compelling reasons for some of this talent to return — and to build in India and for India. Embed them within the best Indian research institutions. Give them the mandate, the compute, the data access, and the decision rights to deliver a national frontier model on an accelerated timeline.

Last but not the least, government must create the bridge to markets. Even the best model is worthless if it never reaches real markets and real users at scale. This is where government has its most important and least appreciated role: market connection.

We are watching a predictable but unfortunate pattern. With great power has come not great responsibility, but the race to capture maximum value and then close the barn door so others cannot catch up.

The result is a rapidly hardening divided global order: a small club of AI haves and a large periphery of have-nots. This fragmentation will produce mistrust, duplicated effort, lower global growth, and heightened geopolitical risk.

As G7 leaders meet this week, the larger question is what kind of global order they are creating. The technology now exists to generate unprecedented prosperity and problem-solving capacity for humanity. It can also be used to lock in permanent advantage and permanent division. Thankfully the choice remains available.

The writer is Distinguished Fellow NITI Aayog and former President, Nasscom

Sticking points in US-Iran peace deal

Sridhar Krishnaswami

The idiom "It ain't over until the fat lady sings" may not only be applicable to opera shows but also to ongoing military conflicts where warring parties are so close but not close enough to sign off on a "deal". In the case of the Iran conflict that has been going on for more than 100 days now, the message could not be more clear: do not prematurely start the celebrations.

Just when the international community was waiting for a Sunday ceremony, word now is Friday and at Switzerland. For a person who has been anxiously waiting for the process to be over, President Donald Trump once again lashed out at Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu for carrying out an attack on Beirut and risking an accord that was in the finishing stages.

"This morning's attack on Beirut should not have happened, particularly on a special day when we are so close to a peace deal with Iran," the President wrote on his Truth Social.

Lebanon has been a major sticking point in the peace process with Iran adamantly insisting that it should be a part of any comprehensive peace. President Trump has indicated that there would be guarantees that Israel will stop its offensives on all of Lebanon.

And for a country that is worried of being left in the cold in a US-Iran peace deal, Israel has made it known that it could stop targeting the capital city of Beirut but its operations in southern Lebanon would continue.

MAJOR IRRITANTS

In the current scenario, Tehran sees Washington's complicity in Israel's offensives and has on more than one occasion threatened to walk out of the peace process. "This could be the beginning of a long and beautiful peace — let's not blow it," President Trump has said. If Lebanon is a major irritant, there are other factors that could complicate a final signature even if no one other than the parties themselves are privy to details.

The unofficial versions floating around — attributed to Iranian official and semi-official state media, unnamed sources and officials of the US — have three things in common: re-opening the Strait of Hormuz; relief from sanctions; and start of negotiations on Iran's nuclear programme.

IRKED. President Trump unhappy with Israel's continued attacks on Lebanon

Even here there have been divergent views on details — for instance, if Iran would be allowed to collect a fee or service charge for vessels using the Hormuz. Washington will have no truck with this idea.

On the issue of sanctions there are a number of grey areas such as easing of frozen assets or lifting punitive measures on sale of oil. One figure floating around is of $25 billion only being released, and with Tehran demanding half of the frozen assets to be released; and there is the talk of a Iran reconstruction fund of $300 billion, which would involve the US and others in the region,upon a final deal.

The biggest stumbling block would seem not in what is going to be inked later this week but in the extraction and safekeeping of enriched uranium stockpile of about half a tonne and the future of Iran's nuclear programme, all of which Israel will be watching very closely.

It is unlikely that President Trump will give Israel any kind of veto on the outcome but will be mindful of critics and analysts who will be comparing the final result at the end of 60 days to that of the 2015 Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action of the Barack Obama administration that President Trump walked out of in 2018 saying it was weak.

The writer is a senior journalist who has reported from Washington DC on North America and United Nations

thehindubusinessline.

TWENTY YEARS AGO TODAY.

June 16, 2006

Norms for real estate MFs soon

The Securities and Exchange Board of India will soon come out with a slew of measures providing more leeway to the mutual funds industry. These include allowing MFs entry into real estate sector and launch of 'capital protection' schemes. SEBI will announce the norms for real estate mutual funds next week.

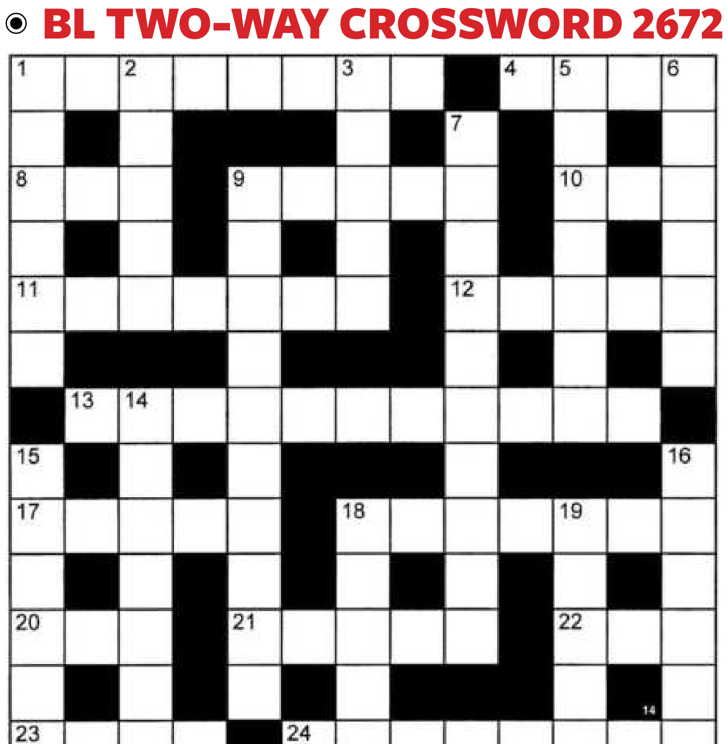
Nicholas Piramal set to buy Pfizer UK facility

Nicholas Piramal India Ltd (NPIL) is set to acquire Pfizer's manufacturing facility in the United Kingdom, a move that boosts NPIL's global presence in custom-manufacturing. The cost of acquisition was not disclosed. NPIL has also signed a supply agreement with Pfizer till November 2011, with the potential to bring in revenues of $350 million.

ESIC to increase wage ceiling for coverage

The board of the Employees State Insurance Corporation (ESIC) chaired by the Labour Minister, Mr K. Chandrasekhar Rao, has decided to increase the wage ceiling for coverage under the ESI Act from ₹7,500 per month to ₹10,000 per month. It also decided to takeover all ESI hospitals so far run jointly by States and the Centre, subject to the willingness of the State Governments.

BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2672



EASY

ACROSS

1. Underground burial-place (8)
4. Wooden barrel-ring (4)
8. Pen-point (3)
9. Pugilist (5)
10. Teacake (3)
11. Was put in the soil (7)
12. Thespian (5)
13. Water source said to bring good luck (7,4)
17. Thin biscuit (5)
18. Salad vegetable (7)
20. Bohea (3)
21. More agreeable (5)
22. To slice (3)
23. Back of foot (4)
24. Asserted, made known (8)

DOWN

1. Small savoury served with drinks (6)
2. Shinbone (5)
3. Mingled (5)
5. Of body's path through space (7)
6. Want, great poverty (6)
7. While swimming, move without progressing (5,5)
9. Slaughtering (10)
14. Excite, exacerbate (7)
15. On/off device (6)
16. In a sitting position (6)
18. 'Wealth' (5)
19. Open sore (5)

NOT SO EASY

ACROSS

1. Caught in a form of combat in which people were buried (8)
4. Jump round the ring produced by cask-maker (4)
8. It writes the rubbish put in it backwards (3)
9. A dog may be a southpaw (5)
10. Some hair gathered in Bath for consumption? (3)
11. Was set out with the scheme Heath devised (7)
12. He takes the stage when Croat is in trouble (5)
13. Giving one 'Gesundheit!' by throwing coins in it? (7,4)
17. Biscuit silicon chips are cut from (5)
18. Iceberg allowed to take a cute turn (7)
20. An infusion is at odds with the bar (3)
21. It is more pleasant to be back in the precinct (5)
22. Diluted one's share (3)
23. A despicable fellow will get ball back from scrum (4)
24. Stopped innings and, after 500, cleared out (8)

DOWN

1. Pancake with no potassium used as cocktail snack (6)
2. Bone one used in a form of bait (5)
3. Ten-time product of different sorts (5)
5. A part in the viva voce concerning planetary movement (7)
6. Great poverty of writer socially acceptable on the railway (6)
7. Is in the swim, but will get nowhere if one does so (5,5)
9. Making joints is a lethal occupation (10)
14. Get red file man ordered (7)
15. Turn over and give one a caning (6)
16. Not being on one's feet, is teased about it (6)
18. Money obtainable from 19 (5)
19. It may be a cruel form of sore (5)

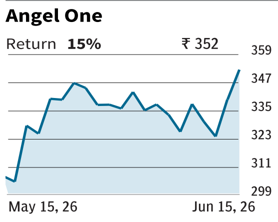
SOLUTION: BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2671

ACROSS 1. Garnished 5. Dab 7. Axil 8. Carousel 10. Contents 11. Smew 13. Detain 15. Carpus 18. Tuba 19. Militate 22. Palliate 23. Stet 24. Cor 25. Renounced

DOWN 1. Glanced 2. Reign 3. Hearts 4. Drop 5. Dishmop 6. Below 9. Devil 12. Basil 14. Tubular 16. Sweated 17. Mitten 18. Topic 20. Attic 21. Bier

QUICKLY.

Angel One pays ₹4.28 cr to end supervisory lapse case



Mumbai: Angel One has settled a case with SEBI, by paying ₹4.28 crore for settlement charges, closing adjudication and enquiry proceedings over alleged supervisory lapses by its authorised persons (APs), Deepankar Barman and Nadella Srinivas Rao. The settlement was made without any admission or denial of the findings by the company. SEBI had alleged that the broker failed to detect unauthorised fund collection by Deepankar Barman, failed to act on disproportionate trading patterns, and did not monitor unauthorised social media activities, including promises of assured returns and misuse of the broker's brand name. SEBI also alleged that Angel One failed to identify that the AP was trading through other stock brokers. It also failed to examine orders placed through common IP and MAC addresses for clients. OUR BUREAU

Leapfrog Engg IPO to open tomorrow at ₹21-23 a share

Mumbai: Leapfrog Engineering Services has fixed the price at ₹21-23 per share for its initial public offering which will open for subscription on Wednesday, according to a statement. The ₹88.51 crore IPO comprises a fresh issue of approximately 3.46 crore shares worth ₹79.60 crore and an offer for sale of around 38.75 lakh shares aggregating ₹8.91 crore, a company statement said. The IPO will open for subscription on June 17 on the BSE SME platform and close on June 19. PTI

SEBI introduces dynamic price bands for ETF to align with underlying assets

BETTER VALUE. Changes in base price calculation will improve price discovery for exchange traded funds

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) has revamped the trading framework for exchange traded funds (ETFs), introducing dynamic price bands, a new methodology for determining base prices and a pre-open call auction for commodity ETFs to bring ETF trading more in line with movements in their underlying assets.

The changes seek to address the mismatch created by the existing framework, under which ETF price bands were based on a two-day-old net asset value (NAV) and a uniform price limit irrespective of the underlying asset's volatility.

The revised norms will come into effect from September 1.

"In order to address the issues involved due to lag of 1 trading day in base price of ETFs and the fixed price band of ETFs not being commensurate with the range of the underlying... the norms for determination of base price, price bands, call auction in pre-open session and close-out mark-up for ETFs are provided below," SEBI said in its circular on Monday.

ON A ROLL. The regulator has replaced the fixed 20% price band for equity and debt ETFs with dynamic price bands

CLOSING PRICE

Instead of the T-2 day NAV, exchanges will use the previous day's closing market price, calculated as the last 30-minute volume weighted average price (VWAP). Where there is no trading during the final 30 minutes, the last traded price will be used, while the latest available NAV will serve as the fallback. SEBI said exchanges and mutual funds should work towards using the T-1 closing NAV as the base price from April 1, 2027.

The regulator has also replaced the fixed 20 per cent price band for equity and debt ETFs with dynamic price bands.

These ETFs will begin trading within a 10 per cent band, which can be expanded in stages of 5 percentage points up to 20 per cent after a cooling-off period if prices hit the threshold. Overnight and liquid ETFs will continue to have a fixed 5 per cent band.

METAL ETFS

For gold and silver ETFs, the initial price band has been set at 6 per cent and can be widened in stages of 3 per cent after cooling-off periods. The exchanges have been given flexibility to relax limits further in exceptional circumstances if global commodity prices move sharply after the domestic markets close.

SEBI also introduced a pre-open call auction mechanism to improve price discovery for gold and silver ETFs, similar that for stocks. It revised the close-out procedure for overnight and liquid ETFs while retaining the existing mechanism for other ETF categories.

Milky Mist to soon file updated DRHP for IPO

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai

K Rathnam, CEO, Milky Mist

Tamil Nadu-based Milky Mist Dairy Food Ltd is updating its books with the fiscal year numbers for 2025-26 and will soon file an updated draft red herring prospectus (UDRHP) to proceed with the IPO process as planned, Chief Executive Officer K Rathnam has said.

"We recently raised ₹482 crore in a pre-IPO round from Temasek," he told *businessline* in an online interaction.

The dairy firm, based in Perundurai in Tamil Nadu's Erode district, obtained approval from the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) for a ₹2,035 crore initial public offering in October 2025. SEBI's approval expires in October this year.

In April, Ratham said the company's IPO offer will comprise a fresh issue of up to ₹1,785 crore and an offer for sale of up to ₹250 crore by promoter shareholders.

BARAMATI FACILITY

As part of its expansion plans, the company has acquired land in Baramati through the Maharashtra Industrial Development Corporation to set up its second facility. It is a long-term project which will likely be ready in 2-3 years.

"This facility will help us to establish a strong footprint in the Western and Northern markets," he said.

The company plans to set up a milk processing and dairy processing manufacturing facility at an outlay of ₹1,130 crore. It signed a memorandum of understanding with the Maharashtra government at Davos in January this year.

Milky Mist, which is focusing on the health segment - particularly within the protein category, has begun to offer high-protein paneer, high-protein Greek yogurt, Skyr, and high-protein cheddar.

"While the technology for Skyr and Greek yogurt was acquired in 2022, we spent two years on marketing and seeding, and these products have seen great acceptance over the last 18 months," the company's CEO said.

The company is witnessing significant demand for protein products across all consumer sectors. While many protein products, such as whey protein concentrate (WPC), are already in the market, Milky Mist believes that 'taste is a key differentiator' for consumers. As a dairy-first product, it is gaining significant traction in this area, he said.

Milky Mist offers protein milk, whey protein, and high-protein variants of staple products, which are available across the country through its network of 3,100 distributors in the health and protein category.

"We reach consumers via more than 3,50,000 retail touchpoints across multiple channels, including general trade, modern trade, hotels, restaurants and cafes/catering (HoReCa), and digital platforms such as e-commerce and quick commerce," said Rathnam, adding that quick-commerce accounts for about 14-15 per cent of its topline. In addition, the company operates over 100 exclusive parlours and exports its premium dairy offerings to over 15 countries.

Razorpay files confidential IPO papers, with SEBI, targets up to ₹5,700 crore

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Razorpay has taken a major step towards its stock market debut, filing a pre-filed draft red herring prospectus (DRHP) with the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) and stock exchanges under the regulator's confidential filing route.

The Bengaluru-based fintech is expected to raise between $500 million and $600 million (₹4,700-₹5,700 crore) through the proposed initial public offering (IPO), according to people familiar with the matter. The issue is likely to comprise a mix of fresh shares and an offer-for-sale by existing investors, although the final structure and size of the offering will depend on market conditions and investor demand.

FILING FLEXIBILITY

The confidential filing mechanism allows companies to submit draft offer documents without immediately disclosing detailed business and financial information.

Razorpay has appointed Axis Capital, Kotak Mahindra Capital, JP Morgan and Citi as bankers to the issue.

The IPO filing comes after a series of strategic moves by the fintech firm to prepare for public markets. In April 2025, Razorpay converted itself into a public limited company before completing its long-awaited reverse flip to India later that year.

The relocation reportedly involved a tax outgo of nearly $150 million. It has also been expanding its product and regulatory footprint.

Earlier this year, it acquired a majority stake in UPI rewards platform POP UPI in a deal valued at around $30 million and secured a cross-border payment aggregator licence from RBI, strengthening its position in the fast-growing digital payments ecosystem.

The company has raised more than $741 million from marquee investors including GIC, Peak XV Partners, Z47 and Tiger Global. It was last valued at $7.5 billion during its $375 million funding round in 2021.

JP Associates to be delisted from June 18

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

Jaiprakash Associates Ltd (JAL), which has been acquired by Adani Enterprises through the insolvency process, will get delisted from stock exchanges with effect from June 18.

In a regulatory filing on Monday, JAL informed that it has received final approval from the BSE Ltd and NSE Ltd. Accordingly, the company's equity shares would stand delisted from the BSE and the NSE with effect from June 18, 2026. The delisting is as per the resolution plan approved by the NCLT, Allahabad Bench, Prayagraj.

SpaceX sustains momentum, rises on second day of trading

Bloomberg

SpaceX shares jumped on the second day of their trading, adding to gains following a blockbuster debut that instantly vaulted it into the ranks of the world's most valuable public companies.

The stock climbed as much as 8.7 per cent, extending Friday's 19 per cent rally. The move boosts the company's market value to more than $2.2 trillion, putting it among the top six largest companies in the world. At its current market capitalisation, it's roughly $400 billion away from overtaking Amazon.com Inc, which boasts a nearly $2.7 trillion value.

GREEN-SHOE OPTION

SpaceX has exercised the IPO's over-allotment option, which lets underwriters sell an additional 83.3 million shares, according to a statement Monday.

The green-shoe option increases the amount raised to $86.2 billion, or $85.7 billion less the $500 million of underwriting expenses listed in the prospectus.

A solid first-day performance for SpaceX assuaged fears about the market's ability to absorb such a large IPO, helping pave the way for the potential IPOs from Anthropic PBC and OpenAI, large competitors that could go public as soon as this year.

"The positive SpaceX debut and investor reception is a good sign for OpenAI and Anthropic as both companies likely head down the IPO path before year-end," Wedbush Securities analyst Dan Ives wrote in a note to clients.

Monday was the first full trading session for the stock formally known as Space Exploration Technologies Corp.

Shares opened a few minutes before noon on Friday in New York, meaning it traded for just over four hours before the market close.

"Overall, SpaceX going public is an important watershed moment for the broader tech sector in our view as this AI revolution and data takes this next step forward," Ives said.

Suzlon in focus as brokerages back its RE expansion strategy

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

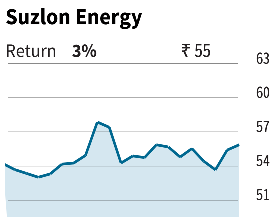
Suzlon Energy shares rose as much as 3 per cent in early trade on Monday before settling flat after multiple brokerages reaffirmed their positive stance on the stock following the company's investor day, where management outlined a roadmap to transform the wind turbine maker into an integrated renewable energy platform.

The stock closed flat at ₹55.57, after touching an intra-day high of ₹56.78.

EXECUTION FOCUS

Brokerages said Suzlon's plans to diversify beyond wind turbines into adjacent renewable energy segments could strengthen earnings visibility, improve margins and expand its addressable market, although investors are likely to remain focused on execution.

Motilal Oswal Financial said the investor day addressed key medium- to long-term growth concerns by laying out a clear strategy for expansion and diversification into adjacent renewable energy verticals.



It believes the move could enhance earnings resilience while positioning Suzlon as the most credible and investible player in the Indian wind energy market, backed by its strong market position and execution track record. It reiterated its 'Buy' rating with a target price of ₹65.

JM Financial said the company's evolution into "Suzlon 2.0" — an integrated renewable energy developer spanning multiple technologies and asset management services (AMS) — could significantly expand revenue opportunities beyond turbine manufacturing. It maintained a 'Buy' rating and a target price of ₹65, while noting that successful execution would be critical to the transformation.

Centrum Institutional said Suzlon is well positioned to deliver sustained revenue growth and cash flow generation as wind capacity additions accelerate and service revenues continue to scale. It maintained its 'Buy' rating with a target price of ₹75 per share.

UBS also retained its 'Buy' rating with a target price of ₹72. UBS said Suzlon's strategy appears relatively asset-light compared with solar manufacturing peers and that its EPC and project development model could improve project execution and predictability.

BROKER'S CALL.

Elara Securities

BEML (BUY)
Target: ₹2,620
CMP: ₹1,783

BEML expects strong acceleration on all fronts in FY27, with an executable orderbook of ₹55bn, and a sales growth target of 15-25 per cent in the next three years, along with an EBITDA margin of 15-16 per cent despite higher R&D spend as operating leverage kicks in.

Management has outlined a robust order pipeline in rail & metro (R&M) and defence, with expected order inflows of ₹15,000 crore for the year, with a closing order book of ₹24,000 crore.

Growth momentum is set to continue during FY28-29 once R&M execution ramps up. The exports order pipeline is increasing, with BEML receiving its first-ever order for metro rolling stocks exports in Q4FY26. In defence, it expects large orders for high mobility vehicle (HMV) for QRSAM, HMV for LRSAM, armoured recovery vehicle (ARV) overhaul, self-propelled mine barrier, ground support systems for LRSAM, and new projects, such as tunnel-boring machines, and ship-to-shore cranes. The high-speed rail (HSR) project is likely to see 16 additional trains in the pipeline, in addition to two currently under development.

We retain Buy with a lower TP of ₹2,620 on 37x March FY28E P/E on account of robust visibility in FY27 on both sales and order inflows fronts, scope for margin improvement, and unexplored exports potential.

Key risks to our call include supply chain constraints on the castings and components front, dragging execution.

UBS

MOTILAL OSWAL (BUY)
Target: ₹1,150
CMP: ₹939.50

Motilal Oswal Financial Services (MOFSL) is a diversified Indian financial services group with businesses spanning wealth management, asset management and capital markets.

MOFSL looks well positioned to capitalise on India's structural financialisation, with exposure to high-growth AUM pools from wealth and asset management. We believe industry tailwinds remain robust and forecast mutual funds' AUM to grow at an 18 per cent CAGR by FY30E, with a 20%-plus CAGR (FY30E) for HNI wealth and alternatives.

The firm is transitioning to an AUM-led, annuity-driven model, where growth is linked to client assets rather than transaction volumes. For FY26-29E, we expect AUM to expand at a 21 per cent CAGR, driving a 19 per cent revenue CAGR. We believe the market underappreciates MOFSL's shift to higher quality, recurring wealth and distribution earnings, reducing broking cyclicality and driving a 22 per cent earnings CAGR over FY26-29E.

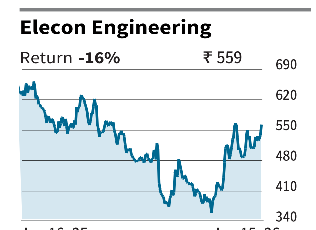
We believe historical multiples are of less relevance due to the evolving business model and increasing share of fee-based income. Our valuation is anchored to higher multiples for asset-light businesses (AMC about 28x, private wealth around 25x, wealth 18x) and a relatively lower multiple for capital markets (14x) on FY28E earnings. Based on our PEG ratio analysis, we think the stock offers attractive risk-reward, trading at 15x one-year forward PE, slightly above its three-year average. We initiate coverage at Buy.

businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: **blmarketwatch@gmail.com**

TODAY'S PICK.

Elecon Engineering Company (₹559.90): BUY

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau



The short-term outlook is bullish for Elecon Engineering Company. The stock has been in a good uptrend since April. The rise on Monday has taken the share price well above a key intermediate resistance level of ₹545.

It also indicates that the upmove could be gaining momentum. Moving average crossovers on the daily chart also strengthens the bullish case. Short-term supports are at ₹545 and ₹520. Elecon Engineering Company share price can rise to ₹625 in the coming weeks. Traders can buy Elecon Engineering company shares now at ₹560. Accumulate on dips a ₹548. Keep the stop-loss at ₹518 initially.

Trail the stop-loss up to ₹568 as soon as the stock goes up to ₹575. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹580 and ₹598 when the price touches ₹592 and ₹610 respectively. Exit the long positions at ₹620.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is a risk of loss in trading

Day trading guide

23930 » **Nifty 50 Futures**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
23880	23700	23985	24150	Go long on a break above 23985 with a stop-loss at 23940

₹777 » **HDFC Bank**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
775	769	782	789	Go long only above 782. Keep the stop-loss at 779

₹1136 » **Infosys**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1124	1110	1165	1180	Go long on dips at 1128. Keep the stop-loss at 1115

₹288 » **ITC**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
285	282	290	295	Take fresh longs above 290. Keep the stop-loss at 288

₹244 » **ONGC**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
242	239	248	252	Wait for a rise. Go short at 247. Keep the stop-loss at 249

₹1307 » **Reliance Ind.**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1300	1285	1315	1340	Go long only above 1315. Keep the stop-loss at 1310

₹1020 » **SBI**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1010	997	1030	1050	Wait for dips. Go long at 1015 with a stop-loss at 1007

₹2163 » **TCS**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
2150	2110	2175	2190	Go short on a break below 2150. Keep the stop-loss at 2160

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

Nifty 50 Movers ▲ 231.00 pts.

	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	Wt(%)
L&T	4169.80	30.90	30.26	4.48
Reliance Ind	1307.00	20.65	18.47	8.08
M&M	3134.30	17.84	20.93	2.56
HDFC Bank	777.35	16.38	15.10	10.89
Infosys	1134.90	14.16	15.62	3.64
Bajaj Finance	942.30	14.02	30.33	2.31
Shriram Finance Ltd.	1000.65	13.98	23.48	1.28
Eternal Ltd.	252.00	12.90	664.45	1.66
Maruti Suzuki	13805.00	12.58	29.57	1.66
Bharti Airtel	1841.20	12.53	33.17	5.17
Trent Ltd.	2901.10	10.60	89.87	0.88
Eicher Motors	7624.50	9.39	37.92	0.96
UltraTech Cement	11466.00	9.03	41.26	1.24
Titan	4283.50	8.97	74.95	1.62
IntGlobeAvi	4880.40	8.43	0.00	1.01
Bajaj Finserv	1750.20	7.70	14.24	0.92
Axis Bank	1368.30	7.52	16.02	3.59
HDFC Life	581.20	6.07	65.58	0.57
ITC	287.90	5.89	17.16	2.54
SBI Life	1759.50	5.25	71.44	0.72
Grasim Ind	3164.50	4.90	20.91	1.10
Kotak Bank	405.75	3.94	20.92	2.73
State Bank	1020.85	3.35	10.87	3.88
Tata Motors PV	396.40	2.93	4865.98	0.76
Max Healthcare	1028.90	2.67	69.42	0.70
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	239.52	2.60	97.49	0.72
Bharat Elec	409.55	2.39	49.38	1.34
HCL Tech	1119.30	2.24	18.24	1.08
Adani Enter	2942.50	1.31	38.20	0.77
PowerGrid Corp	285.70	0.89	16.68	1.18
Wipro	181.38	0.77	14.34	0.47
Dr Reddys Lab	1279.50	0.55	25.69	0.71
Coal India	444.05	0.27	8.81	0.92
TCS	2162.00	0.13	15.82	2.02
TataConsumerProduct	1100.40	-0.04	70.40	0.66
NestleIndia	1374.70	-0.16	75.76	0.90
JSW Steel	1296.50	-0.23	12.43	1.11
Sun Pharma	1806.00	-0.39	37.65	1.75
Tech Mahindra	1425.60	-0.50	29.07	0.83
Apollo Hosp	8468.50	-0.66	60.80	0.80
Asian Paints	2739.30	-0.80	59.79	1.13
Cipla	1381.30	-1.00	28.89	0.71
Tata Steel	197.28	-1.05	22.62	1.49
Adani Ports	1804.80	-1.30	32.53	1.22
ONGC	243.65	-2.16	6.16	0.87
Hindalco	1013.90	-2.43	17.01	1.34
Hind Unilever	2156.10	-2.46	47.87	1.75
Bajaj Auto	9943.00	-2.90	26.28	1.01
NTPC	348.10	-6.00	12.25	1.51
ICICI Bank	1327.60	-20.61	16.40	8.69

Pts: Impact on index movement

Nifty Next 50 Movers ▲ 1,678.05 pts.

	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	Wt(%)
Vedanta Aluminium	495.90	1801.92	0.00	3.33
Cholamandalamin&Fin	1653.60	103.58	26.92	2.79
Tvs Motor Cmp .	3459.50	97.46	51.58	3.21
Tata Motors Cv	406.60	96.37	49.45	3.35
Hdfc Amc	2622.90	96.25	39.32	2.11
Varun Beverages .	541.00	72.78	57.01	2.92
Samvardmothersoninternatl	148.12	59.09	38.26	2.59
Cummins Inida	5754.00	50.63	67.54	3.07
Tata Power	404.10	49.96	25.23	2.67
Dlf	614.45	49.72	34.45	1.56
Hindustanaeronautics	4284.70	49.59	31.44	3.21
Bpcl	310.60	47.30	5.21	2.48
Avenuesuper	4099.00	43.90	89.81	2.38
Cg Power & Ind Sol	935.50	40.85	123.11	2.53
Indian Oilcorp	144.49	37.52	4.67	2.13
Gail (India)	175.41	37.47	15.21	1.87
Muthootfin	3160.10	35.77	11.96	1.34
Pidilitind	1571.00	31.15	64.71	1.92
Indian Hotels Co. .	689.85	25.83	43.70	2.39
Shree Cement	24825.00	24.59	51.22	1.31
Abb India	6922.50	22.55	92.84	1.43
Tata Capital	340.70	17.90	29.57	0.58
Macrotech Developers .	920.85	17.16	26.81	1.02
Hyundai Motor India .	2030.10	16.13	30.37	1.14
Bajaj Holdings	10286.00	15.31	11.69	1.76
Power Finance	424.50	14.21	4.17	2.44
Ltimindtree	3897.90	13.96	23.19	1.43
Rural Elec	351.85	13.43	5.68	1.73
Britannia Ind	5199.50	11.33	49.36	2.42
Punjab Natl Bank	107.96	10.53	6.72	1.47
Ambuja Cements	428.85	9.92	19.29	1.03
Solar Industries	17277.00	9.23	90.02	1.66
Siemens	3601.80	8.05	83.68	1.26
Union Bank	171.30	6.83	6.73	1.31
Bank Of Baroda	276.05	6.82	7.11	2.02
Indian Railway Finance Corp	97.08	6.77	18.10	0.77
Mazagoan Dock	2440.40	6.51	35.72	0.73
Canara Bank	132.20	5.05	6.71	1.76
Hindus Zinc	563.85	4.84	17.22	0.96
Godrej Consumer	1036.80	3.98	56.99	1.65
Adani Energy Solutions .	1491.90	2.26	74.90	2.04
Jindal Steel	1149.50	1.05	34.89	1.68
Bosch	39070.00	0.25	41.55	1.34
United Spirits .	1271.50	-0.75	49.54	1.48
Adanigreenenergy	1482.60	-2.94	122.90	1.96
Divis Lab	6608.50	-10.60	68.32	3.31
Zyduslifesciences	1088.10	-11.75	21.37	1.07
Siemens Energy India .	3550.90	-14.01	96.55	1.24
Torrent Pharma	4504.00	-19.88	71.30	1.86
Adani Power .	220.52	-29.84	32.79	3.60
Vedanta	302.50	-34.37	7.46	2.03
Vedanta Power	40.94	-384.95	0.00	0.27
Vedanta Oil & Gas	36.10	-408.21	0.00	0.24
Vedanta Iron & Steel	21.06	-480.50	0.00	0.14

Pts: Impact on index movement

Iran, US agree to end war, reopen Hormuz

DEAL DONE. The memorandum of understanding is scheduled to be officially signed on Friday in Switzerland

Reuters
Dubai/Washington

The US and Iran said they had agreed terms to end their war and reopen the Strait of Hormuz, news that brought relief to markets although the pact may hinge on an end to hostilities in Lebanon and defers talks on Tehran's nuclear programme.

While still a framework, the deal marked the biggest breakthrough towards resolving the conflict that has killed thousands and upended energy markets since it began with joint US-Israeli strikes on Iran in February.

"The deal with the Islamic Republic of Iran is now complete," US President Donald Trump wrote on his Truth Social platform at around 5:30 pm in Washington (21:30 GMT) on Sunday. His post came shortly after Pakistani Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif, whose country has served as a mediator, announced a deal had been struck.

The memorandum of understanding is scheduled to be officially signed on Friday in Switzerland.

The precise terms were not immediately known. Sharif said in a post on X that the pact called for "the immediate and permanent termination of military operations on all fronts, including in Lebanon."

Leaders of the Group of Seven wealthy nations are due to arrive at a French lakeside resort on Monday, where Trump will be pressed for details.

STICKING POINT

While the US and Iran had largely ceased hostilities as they engaged in weeks-long negotiations, Lebanon has suffered the deadliest spill

HUGE RELIEF. A teacher of Gurukul School of Art welcomes the US-Iran peace deal through a painting in Mumbai ANI

over of the conflict. Nearly 1.2 million people have been uprooted by an Israeli offensive against the Iran-backed group Hezbollah, which opened fire on Israel in support of Tehran on March 2.

Lebanon has been a persistent sticking point in talks, with Israel and Hezbollah ignoring calls from Trump and others to stop their attacks on each other, while Iran made a full ceasefire in Lebanon one of its demands.

The secretariat of Iran's Supreme National Security Council said war and military operations on all fronts, including Lebanon, would end permanently starting on Monday night.

Iran's Foreign Minister Abbas Araqchi said there must be a complete halt to Israeli attacks against Lebanon and wrote on Telegram that the US bears responsibility for implementing the framework deal.

Hezbollah has not yet publicly commented on the US-Iran deal, but Lebanese and foreign security sources told *Reuters* that the group had held fire at Israel before midnight on Sunday night and had not launched operations since then. The pace of Israeli attacks has decreased dramatically, they added.

Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu has yet to respond publicly to the US-Iran agreement.

Trump said the Strait of Hormuz, a major shipping route for global oil and gas supplies that Iran has effectively shut down for months, would open on Friday, and that he had ordered the end of the US blockade of Iranian ports.

STRAIT TO REOPEN

"Ships of the World, start your engines. Let the oil flow!" Trump wrote. Oil prices fell on the news, though shippers remained cautious and ensuring the waterway is clear of mines could take weeks. Brent crude futures fell some 5 per cent on Monday as stock markets jumped.

The agreement was sealed despite an Israeli strike on Lebanon on Sunday.

The fate of Tehran's nuclear programme, another thorny issue, will also be addressed in those later talks, sources previously told *Reuters*.

USTR Jamieson Greer to visit India to finalise interim trade deal

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

Notwithstanding the recent strain in diplomatic ties over the killing of three Indian civil mariners by the US forces in the Gulf of Oman, India and the US are taking forward their trade talks with a key visit by US Trade Representative Jamieson Greer, scheduled next week to finalise the interim trade deal.

Greer is scheduled to hold talks with Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal on June 23-24, giving "final touches" to the framework deal, Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agrawal said at a media interaction on Monday.

"Our expectation is that discussions will be centred around giving final touches to the framework deal, which has been discussed during the visit of their (US) delegation. There will be talks also on the larger BTA (bilateral trade agreement), that has also been under discussions between the two sides," said Agrawal.

The US is keen to get an early agreement on the interim trade deal so that its industry has increased market access after India eliminates or brings down tariffs on all industrial products and a wide range of agricultural products, as agreed in the framework deal announced (but not signed) by the two on February 6.

However, the upcoming

US Trade Representative Jamieson Greer VIA REUTERS

high-level talks face intense political backlash at home, with Opposition parties aggressively calling for New Delhi to walk away from the negotiating table in protest of the maritime fatalities.

Compounding the bilateral tensions is the unresolved shadow of Washington's Section 301 investigations into Indian exports. Agrawal emphasised that India was handling both the Section 301 investigations and the trade talks parallelly. "US Section 301 are legal investigations. We have made our point, which was indicated throughout last month, and we are also engaged to see what the outcome is... As far as the trade deal is concerned, I think the trade deal covers the entire gamut of trade relationship between India and the US, so definitely whenever we finalise and sign the deal, I think they try to have clear answers on the 301 investigations," he said.

Oman transit corridor lifts India's exports to West Asia

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

Exports to West Asia bounced back in May 2026, rescued primarily by the swift operationalisation of an alternative transit route leveraging Oman's advanced port infrastructure.

With the Strait of Hormuz facing heightened maritime security risks, India managed to successfully circumvent the volatile chokepoint by routing cargo directly through Omani ports like Sohar, Salalah and Duqm, Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agrawal noted.

"Exports to the region have risen due to the effort of exporters and our agencies on ground, along with the Ministry of Ports to see that new routes for exports were opened and new ports in Oman were made functional," Agrawal said.

By opening new routes through Oman's Sohar, Salalah and Duqm ports, India effectively established a structured transit corridor straight into the UAE and across the Gulf, including through Jebel Ali, officials explained. This has now positioned Oman as a permanent, vital hub for India's trade flows across the region.

SHARP RECOVERY

While the initial outbreak of the regional conflict caused exports to West Asia to crash to $2.6 billion in March 2026, down 56.8 per cent from $6.03 billion in March 2025, there was a gradual recovery in April, with shipments jumping heavily back on track in May. Outbound shipments to the region climbed back to $5.30 billion for the month, almost neck-and-neck with the $5.38 billion recorded in May 2025, with the rapid turnaround driven strongly by resilient demand in the UAE, Saudi Arabia, Jordan and Yemen.

"So we have more or less achieved the same level of exports in spite of the challenges that we are facing in that region," Agrawal said.

The UAE remained the primary anchor of the recovery, with merchandise exports rising 3.18 per cent year-on-year to $3.06 billion in May, demonstrating a sharp rebound from April's 36.43 per cent plunge. Shipments to Saudi Arabia grew 11.12 per cent to $0.92 billion over the same period.

Officials said that while initially, priority was being given to shipments of perishables, exports from India had started using the Oman route.

Agrawal noted that trade flows could get an additional boost from any sustained de-escalation in regional friction.

Govt caps bulk retail diesel sales as 3.5 lt gets diverted

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

The government capped diesel sales at retail fuel dispensing stations after bulk industrial and commercial users diverted as much as 3.50 lakh tonnes of the key transport fuel in May 2026, leading to "panic buying and unusually high sales" at fuel bunks that serve the common man.

For comparison, more than 10 per cent of the total districts in India (80 districts) witnessed over 30 per cent diesel sales of industrial, commercial and bulk users shifting to retail outlets (ROs) last month. Almost 42 per cent districts (327) saw sales rising over 10 per cent in May 2026 compared to last year.

Sujata Sharma, Joint Secretary in the Oil Ministry, said that some retail outlets are witnessing "unusually high sales".

The primary reason for this is that industrial, direct, institutional and commercial consumers have shifted to ROs leading to higher sales there. In May 2026, around 42 crore litres of diesel sales shifted from bulk to retail fuel dispensing stations.

RO PRICES

Sharma said that bulk diesel sales accounted for 12.6 per cent of the total direct diesel sales in May 2025.

However, this share has come down to 8.3 per cent in May 2026, which means around 350,000 tonnes of diesel sales by bulk users was diverted to ROs.

Another reason is that diesel at ROs is cheaper by ₹40-42 per litre compared to the fuel being sold at the dedicated dispensing stations for industrial, commercial and bulk users.

In Delhi, diesel is priced at ₹95.20 a litre at retail pumps, while bulk diesel sales are priced at ₹134.50 a litre.

As per the Ministry, private OMC sales exhibited a decline of around 58 per cent in high-speed diesel (HSD) sales during May 2026 due to higher prices fixed by them. On June 11, the Oil Ministry through a notification mandated that a retail fuel outlet can sell up to 200

litres of diesel per person per day to curb black marketing and hoarding by unscrupulous elements.

GOVT ACTION

Last month (May 29), the Ministry said that around 156 districts witnessed over 30 per cent jump in diesel sales. Also, six districts witnessed sales doubling.

The Oil Ministry official emphasised that enforcement has been ramped up. Since March, 1,330 FIRs have been registered in LPG cases with 311 arrests and 75,960 cylinders seized. For petrol and diesel, 12,303 litres of petrol and 91,263 litres of diesel were seized since May 27, with 50 FIRs and 49 arrests.

PSU OMCs are currently incurring an under recovery of ₹27 per litre on diesel and ₹3 per litre on petrol.

PSUs must be patient investors in India's future: CEA

Sindhu Hariharan
Chennai

The framework of the new peace deal between the US and Iran is welcome for oil importing countries like India and it should be a catalyst to deepen reforms and grow faster, Chief Economic Advisor (CEA) V Anantha Nageswaran said on Monday.

'The peace deal that has been announced in terms of its framework, therefore, is welcome for an oil, natural gas and fertilizer importing country like India, and I hope it lasts. This is the environment in which India must keep growing fast and keep reforming faster," Nageswaran said.

"India is not in a crisis. We are at a fork. The world that allowed us to grow for three decades, has changed in ways that are not temporary," he added.

The CEA was speaking virtually at the inaugural CPCL-SOOPER-MMA Leadership Lecture series held in Chennai. The topic of his speech was 'Public sector leadership in nation building'.

GLOBAL CAPITAL

Highlighting the ground reality, he said the era of cheap global capital was over, and money that once chased yield into emerging markets now has alternatives at home.

"Every dollar that comes to India must clear a higher bar than before and rate

R Vijaykumar (left), Executive Director, Madras Management Association, exchanging an MoU with Purushotham, CGM (Corporate Planning and Business Development), CPCL, in the presence of H Shankar, Managing Director, CPCL, for the MMA-CPCL-SOOPER lectures in Chennai BIJOY GHOSH

power competition has hardened," he said.

Nageswaran said that while the private sector is plagued by a "a disease of incentives" chasing short horizon goals, a public enterprise is not run with short-term results in mind, and hence is better placed to build deep capabilities. "It can take on projects that gestate over 15 years and pay back over 50 years," he said.

He called on the public sector to step in and apply its "long horizon" strategy to a new set of problems that the country now faces. These include aiding in resource and energy security, including acceleration of nuclear energy; focusing on research and development; nurturing of small and medium enterprises; and learning to compress their decision-making timelines.

Addressing the event, H Shankar, Managing Director, Chennai Petroleum Corporation Ltd (CPCL), spoke about how the public sector oil major had reinvented itself over the years. This includes our recent foray into retail marketing of fuel, he said. "It is a milestone moment; it required a lot of courage to step into unfamiliar territory," he added.

Besides exchanging an MoU with the Madras Management Association (MMA) for the MMA-CPCL Annual Endowment Lecture, he also paid tribute to late VR Deenadayalu, former Chairman and Managing Director, CPCL.

The CPCL-MMA lecture series aims to create a thought leadership platform that brings together policymakers, industry leaders, management professionals, academia and young executives to engage in meaningful dialogue on leadership, governance, sustainability, and institution building in the public sector ecosystem.

QUICKLY.

Adani, US' Jabil in AI infra manufacturing deal

Ahmedabad: Adani Group and US-based manufacturing services major Jabil Inc on Monday announced plans to form a strategic alliance to build a largescale artificial intelligence and data centre infrastructure manufacturing platform in India. The proposed alliance seeks to combine Adani Group's infra, energy, logistics and data centre capabilities with Jabil's engineering and manufacturing expertise to create a vertically integrated ecosystem, stated an official release. OUR BUREAU

EU and France to sign €15 billion defence deal

The European Union and France will sign a €15.1 billion ($17.5 billion) loan agreement for defence on Wednesday, European Commission President Ursula von der Leyen said. The loan is part of the European Commission's SAFE loan programme, which aims to mobilise €150 billion to fast-track defence spending and joint procurement in the EU. BLOOMBERG

India Inc raises more funds via CP route than corporate bonds

SAFE BET. Up to June 12, there were 1,920 CP issuances by companies, aggregating ₹4,39,693 crore

Our Bureau
Mumbai

India Inc has so far raised more short-term resources via the commercial paper (CP) route against longer-term resources via the corporate bond route in the current financial year.

This comes amid investors' expectation that interest rates could go up during the course of the year due to possible inflationary pressures, resulting in them seeking higher coupon rate on private placement of debt (non-convertible debenture/NCD issuances).

So, to reduce cost of resources, companies stepped up CP issuances at softer rates.

In the current financial year (up to June 12), there were 1,920 CP issuances by companies aggregating ₹4,39,693 crore.

During this period, the number of corporate bond issuances was at 607 aggregating ₹1,51,117 crore, according to data sourced from Prime Database.

The aforementioned data clearly show that raising funds via CPs suited issuers as investors were demanding higher coupon for NCDs.

The average yield to maturity for CPs was at 7.46 per cent against average coupon rate of 7.76 per cent for corporate bonds, per Prime Database. In the first quarter (April-May-June) of FY25, there were 2,166 CP issuances by companies aggregating ₹4,50,746 crore.

During this period, the number of corporate bond issuances was at 982 aggregating ₹3,57,907 crore.

FOREX MEASURES

Venkatakrishnan Srinivasan, Founder and Managing Partner, Rockfort Fincap LLP, observed that the movement in both CP and NCD markets since RBI's monetary policy and subsequent forex-support measures reflects a significant shift in corporate funding behaviour.

He opined that prior to the forex-support measures, elevated bond yields, geopolitical tensions in West Asia, crude oil volatility, rupee weakness and concerns over imported inflation made issuers reluctant to lock themselves into long-term fixed-rate borrowings.

Consequently, many corporates preferred shorter-tenor CPs, floating-rate bonds and EBLR (external benchmark-linked lending rate) bank loans that offered greater flexibility in an uncertain interest rate environment.

RBI INITIATIVES

Venkatakrishnan emphasised that following the RBI's initiatives to attract foreign currency inflows through FCNR(B) deposits, ECB-related swap concessions and other measures, borrowing costs across markets have eased materially, with both CP and NCD yields declining by nearly 40-60 basis points (bps) from pre-policy levels.

"Looking ahead, the sharp correction in CP and NCD yields witnessed after the RBI measures may not be fully sustainable through the remainder of FY27. From a market activity perspective, CP issuances are likely to remain the preferred funding avenue for many highly rated corporates because of their flexibility, lower all-in cost and ease of rollover," said Venkatakrishnan.

"CP issuances and outstanding volumes are expected to potentially reach all-time highs in FY27. The NCD market is likely to witness a meaningful revival from the subdued levels seen at the start of the financial year as issuers utilise the current window to lock in funding costs," he added.

FUNDING DRIVE. In the first quarter of FY25, there were 2,166 CP issuances by companies, aggregating ₹4,50,746 crore

Ensure policies don't create incentives for mis-selling: RBI to banks

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The RBI on Monday issued comprehensive instructions on advertising, marketing and sale of financial products and services by banks and NBFCs, whereby they have to ensure that their policies and practices do not create incentives for mis-selling or lead to bundling of products/services.

DARK PATTERNS

Further, banks and NBFCs (regulated entities/REs) cannot resort to dark patterns to mislead or trick users into doing something they originally did not intend or want. They have to obtain explicit customer consent, which indicates agreement to a specific action by or arrangement with them.

The instructions, which come into effect from January 1, 2027, specify what constitutes mis-selling and require them to determine the suitability and appropriateness of a financial product/service for individual customers.

FEEDBACK MECHANISM

The REs shall establish a mechanism to seek feedback from customers within 30 days from the sale of any financial product/service to ensure that customers have understood the features of the financial product/service, and also the risks associated with such financial product/service.

The RBI, in its Responsible Business Conduct Second Amendment Directions, 2026 for REs, emphasised that they should eschew the practice (compulsory bundling) of making availment of one product or service by a customer conditional upon availment of another product or service, whether their own or that of a third-party.

Banks and NBFCs cannot resort to dark patterns to mislead or trick users into doing something they originally did not intend or want

CUSTOMER CONSENT

REs have to obtain explicit customer consent, which is a specific, informed and unambiguous indication of an individual's choice, given through a duly recorded/documented statement or clear affirmative action. This indicates agreement to a specific action by or arrangement with them.

Mis-selling of a financial product/service, whether own or third party, includes the sale of a product/service which is neither suitable nor appropriate in view of the customer's profile evaluated at the time of sale, notwithstanding her/his explicit consent; or the sale of a product/service without providing correct or complete information or by giving misleading information.

Rupee touches 5-week high as US, Iran reach deal to end war

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The rupee was buoyed on Monday, touching a five-week high, as the US and Iran reached an agreement to end the West Asia conflict, leading to crude oil prices sinking to three-month lows.

UP 40 PAISE

The currency closed stronger at 94.71 per/dollar, up 40 paise against the previous close of 94.11. In intraday trades, the rupee hit a five-week high of 94.4625.

The rupee gained 65 paise last Friday to close at 94.11 per dollar, a one-week high.

Anindya Banerjee, Head of Commodity and Currency Research, Kotak Securities, said: "We believe this marks the beginning of a more durable recovery, rather than a one-off bounce.

Two powerful tailwinds are now converging. First, the government and the RBI have delivered what is effectively a bazooka on the capital-flows front."

MAJOR REFORMS

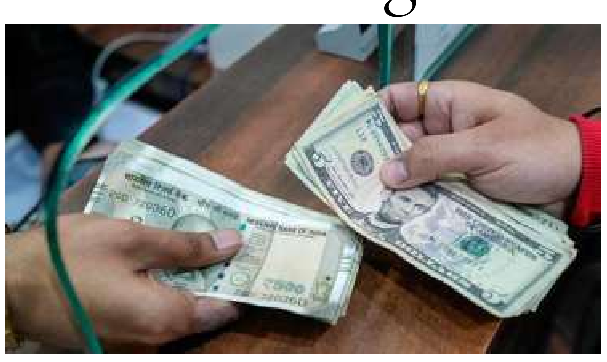
He emphasised that the measures announced earlier this month are sweeping — full tax exemption for foreign investors on government bond interest and capital gains, fully accessible route opened up to long-tenor 15-, 30- and 40-year bonds and green bonds, widening equity access to a broader class of non-resident individuals and, crucially, the RBI bearing the entire hedging cost on fresh three-to-five-year FCNR(B) deposits until September 30.

Banerjee said the move on FCNR(B) deposits allows banks to offer NRIs close to 7 per cent on dollar deposits with no exchange-rate risk, and the September deadline creates a strong incentive to bring those dollars in quickly.

The market is estimating these measures could draw inflows of anywhere between $40 and $55 billion.

"Second, the oil equation is now turning in India's favour. If the Hormuz agreement holds — and this morning's developments suggest it will — and Brent moves down towards $70–73, that materially eases our import bill and current account, which only amplifies the inflow story. Alongside this, we expect flows into the equity segment to improve as global risk sentiment recovers. Taken together, this is a decisively positive setup for the rupee," he said.

Banerjee assessed that over the next one to two weeks, the rupee is expected to strengthen towards 94, and a decisive break of that level would open the door to 93, and potentially 92.5, over the following 2-3 months.



ADVANTAGE RUPEE. The rupee gained 65 paise last Friday to close at 94.11 per dollar, a one-week high PTI

'Global hiring has normalised, but India remains a bright spot'

bl.interview

Janaki Krishnan
Mumbai

US recruitment firm Michael Page CEO Nick Kirk says the global hiring market has moved beyond the post-pandemic frenzy, but demand for skilled talent remains strong. Kirk and PageGroup India Managing Director, Nilay Khandelwal, discuss hiring trends, AI-driven workforce shifts, GCC expansion and why India remains one of the firm's brightest growth markets.

Edited excerpts:

How would you describe the recruitment market now?

Kirk: Trying to talk about today needs context. The last normal year we had was 2019, and we haven't had a normal year since. Everyone knows what happened in 2020. If you'd said to me in the summer of 2020, 'don't worry, Nick, in 2021 and 2022 you are going to see the greatest recruitment market of your entire career, which for me spans 31 years at Michael Page, I would not have believed you. Nobody would have believed you.

There was no indication we were about to head into the greatest recruitment market of all time, but we did. Based on the results of not only our organisation but a number of our competitors as well, there was, through that two-year period, the greatest volume of movement of white-collar workers ever.

Candidates came to market having reassessed their lives during the pandemic and decided that now was a good time to move. They felt they wouldn't put up with their boss any more or that they could do better. At the same time, a whole lot of organisations were transforming as a result of the pandemic. So, there was mass transformation across multiple companies and a whole load of talent coming to market. It was a perfect feeding ground for recruitment consultancies.

We had our all-time record year in 2021 and then beat that in 2022. It was never better.

> We had our all-time record year in 2021 and then beat that in 2022. It was never better
>
> **NICK KIRK**
> CEO, Michael Page

What has changed after the hiring boom?

Kirk: What we then started to hear was this phrase called internal equity.

Organisations suddenly recognised that they had hired somebody on a salary 20 per cent higher than everybody else.

Existing employees would come into their appraisal and say, 'he's not 20 per cent better than me, so why are you paying him 20 per cent more? I want a pay rise, otherwise I'm going to leave'.

In order to make it fair and equitable across the team, companies had to increase salaries for everyone else. It was costing companies so much money.

Companies started coming to us and saying, 'we just can't afford the impact of hiring one individual on so much more money than everybody else'.

So, offers suddenly started to go back to what I would call normal — somewhere between 5 per cent and 8 per cent on a global scale — although it varied by market.

Nobody told the candidates that. We went into 2023 and candidates were coming to market expecting the kind of increases they had seen colleagues receive a year earlier. When we told them they could probably expect a 5 per cent to 8 per cent increase, they didn't believe us.

They would go through the entire recruitment process, get to the end, receive a 7 per cent or 8 per cent offer and turn it down. They would think, 'it's a one-off. The next process will get me 15 per cent or 20 per cent'.

It was only after doing that two or three times that they started to realise those increases had gone.

Then we started seeing more candidates accepting those offers.

The problem with those types of offers is that if I've only got a 5 per cent salary increase and I come to resign to my boss, and my boss values me, he'll probably put my salary up enough to keep me. So, buybacks became a very big issue.

> Real estate, infrastructure and renewables remain very high-growth engines for us
>
> **NILAY KHANDELWAL**
> Michael Page India MD

Is geopolitical uncertainty affecting the job market?

Kirk: Naturally, whenever you have any kind of macro event, it creates uncertainty. Our target area is white-collar professionals. They are educated, typically risk-averse, they've had good careers, and they don't want a blemish on their CV. If there is some kind of macro event that makes them feel uncertain, often their reaction is just to sit on their hands and stay put.

Without doubt, unhelpful headlines around anything that might lead to higher oil prices, inflation, interest rates and so on do not help. But all I can do as CEO, and all I ask my employees to do, is control the controllables. You cannot control those elements.

Which sectors are driving hiring in India?

Khandelwal: Real estate, infrastructure and renewables remain very high-growth engines for us. Data centres are another area with very high demand. GCCs have always been a flavour, so we haven't seen a shift in that. However, what we are seeing is more European companies viewing India as a real option, rather than just playing with the idea of setting up a GCC.

Europe has been tough overall, especially France. In the past there was hesitation from line managers about having technology teams based in India. Today, they don't really have a choice because financial performance is under pressure. Either you grow the top line or improve the bottom line. GCCs form part of that story.

To build confidence, we're often introducing companies that are considering a GCC to another company from the same country that already has one operating successfully in India. That is also giving rise to growth in Tier-II cities because some companies don't want to be in Tier-I locations where the cost arbitrage starts becoming a question mark.

At supper clubs, 'connection' is the real treat

The new dining trend is emerging as a counterpoint to crowded restaurants

Jyoti Banthia
Bengaluru

On a recent Saturday evening in Bengaluru, Siddhi Jain found herself seated between a venture capitalist and a ceramic artist in a stranger's living room.

The table was set for a dozen guests. Some had arrived alone, others in pairs. By the time dessert was served, conversations had drifted from start-up burnout and solo travel to book recommendations and neighbourhood discoveries.

SENSE OF BELONGING

That search for connection is increasingly driving a new dining trend across India's cities. Supper clubs — intimate, reservation-only meals often hosted in private homes or unconventional venues — are emerging as a counterpoint to crowded restaurants, noisy bars and algorithm-driven social networks.

Unlike restaurants, where efficiency and scale often take precedence, supper clubs thrive on scarcity, storytelling and shared participation.

For Aditya Ramakrishnan, Founder of Bengaluru-based Ma La Kitchen, the idea began with a personal frustration. His wife, originally from Chengdu in China's Sichuan province, struggled to find authentic Sichuan food in India.

"I felt like there's a market for it, given how popular Asian food is here and how a lot of people are looking for more traditional, authentic food," said Ramakrishnan. Rather than open a restaurant, he chose a lower-risk route. "I thought the supper club was just a very easy way to start something."

What started as an experiment with a handful of guests soon turned into a thriving operation. At its peak, Ma La Kitchen hosted dinners three times a week, accommodating 12 to 14 guests each evening at roughly ₹4,200 per person. "We've always been sold out," said Ramakrishnan.

Yet profitability alone does not explain the appeal.

The most successful supper clubs are increasingly positioning themselves as experience businesses rather than food businesses.

HOME TRANSFORMED

At Xanadu Kitchen, Founder-chef Susan George and Brand Lead Aashna Rao have transformed their home into a rotating stage for immersive themed evenings.

"The food is one part of the story. Every element is designed to bring the theme to life. Guests don't simply attend dinner — they're stepping into an evening built around a shared idea, story or world," said George.

Dhiraj Shah, Co-founder of Bunco, which hosts The Tasting Lab supper club, believes the format fills a gap left by traditional social spaces.

"The food is what brings people in, but it's often the connections that make the experience memorable," said Shah.

Tickets for The Tasting Lab are priced at ₹1,707 and frequently sell out within minutes.

Yet Shah insists commercial objectives are secondary. "From the beginning, the goal was never to maximise profitability; it was to maximise creativity," insisted Shah.

BON APPETIT. The most successful supper clubs are increasingly positioning themselves as experience businesses, rather than food outlets SUDHAKARA JAIN

Motor insurance policies fully valid even when E-20 fuel used: ICICI Lombard

G Naga Sridhar
Hyderabad

Motor insurance policies remain fully valid when E-20 fuel is used, said ICICI Lombard General Insurance.

Responding to a query by *businessline* on the status of motor insurance claims in the wake of E-20 fuel use, the company said: "We do not treat use of E-20 fuel in older vehicles as a negligence, and we consider the E-20 fuel programme as a progressive, environment-friendly step."

"Our insurance policies are designed to cover accidental damages, theft, personal accident for owner-drivers and co-passengers, as well as third-party liabilities, depending on the covers opted by the insured," it said.

Claims are admissible based on the occurrence of insured perils such as vehicle accidents or theft.

"The type of fuel used in the vehicle such as petrol, diesel, CNG is not a determining factor in claim admissibility. If a claim is admissible with conventional fuel, it is equally admissible with E-20 fuel and ICICI Lombard does not reject claims merely on the basis of fuel usage."

QUICKLY.

Amazon India rolls out AI seller assistant

Bengaluru: Amazon India has introduced its AI-powered seller assistant, a tool designed to help MSMEs manage and scale their operations. It comes ahead of Prime Day 2026 to provide sellers with enterprise-grade capabilities during high-volume shopping periods. Operating in English and Hinglish, it allows sellers to ask questions and manage their business through simple conversation. OUR BUREAU

N-ABLE scales Bengaluru innovation hub by 50%

Bengaluru: Cybersecurity firm N-ABLE is expanding its presence in the Bengaluru Global Capability Centre by 50 per cent. Over the last 18 months, it has established its presence in the city, growing to a team of 140 professionals. The company is planning to expand its city workforce by over 50 per cent, prioritising roles in AI data modelling, AI software design, lifecycle management and LLM optimisation tech. OUR BUREAU

'Delicensing 5.9 GHz band for V2V communications improves road safety'

SAFE AND SOUND. Move also expected to accelerate deployment of safety-enhancing applications: BIF

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

The Broadband India Forum (BIF) on Monday said the government's decision to delicense 30 MHz of spectrum in the globally harmonised 5.9 GHz band for vehicle-to-vehicle (V2V) communications is a transformative step towards improving road safety, reducing traffic fatalities and enabling the next generation of connected mobility solutions in India.

'DECISION TIMELY'

It said several Indian automobile manufacturers have already begun integrating on-board units (OBUs) capable of operating in this band, making the government's decision both timely and critical for supporting the V2V technology deployment in the country.

"This decision is not merely about spectrum policy; it is fundamentally about saving lives, especially at a time when India is witnessing an unacceptably high number of road accidents and fatalities. Delicensing this band for V2V will accelerate adoption of advanced safety technologies by automobile manufacturers, strengthen India's connected mobility ecosystem, reduce the enormous socio-economic burden of road accidents and support the development of intelligent transportation systems that are essential for the future of mobility," said TV Ramachandran, President, BIF.

STAYING FOCUSED. Vehicle-to-vehicle systems enable vehicles to detect hazards beyond the drivers' line of sight

The benefits will extend far beyond the automotive sector and contribute significantly to public safety, economic productivity and national welfare, he added. Recently, the DoT, through Gazette notifications, informed of de-licensing spectrum bands for automotive radar and vehicle-to-everything (V2X or V2I) communication, clearing the regulatory path for next-generation road safety technology in India.

The DoT notified onboarding units enabling Cellular Vehicle-to-Everything (C-V2X) communication in the 5875-5905 MHz band (or 5.875-5.925 GHz band), where radar gives a vehicle the ability to sense its immediate surroundings.

In another notification, the DoT gave a go-ahead for the 77–81 GHz frequency band, used for short-range automotive radar systems.

BIF also said the delicensing of the 5.9 GHz band is expected to accelerate deployment of a broad range of safety-enhancing applications, including collision avoidance systems, emergency braking alerts, blind-spot warnings, intersection safety systems, vulnerable road-user protection and other advanced driver assistance technologies.

ROAD ACCIDENTS

The decision comes at a time when India continues to face one of the world's most serious road safety challenges. The country records over 4.6 lakh road accidents and nearly 1.7 lakh fatalities annually, resulting in an enormous human, social and economic burden on the nation.

The financial burden of road accidents has been estimated at 3.14 per cent of the nation's GDP.

'Chemical used to make contraband mephedrone is a controlled substance'

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The Ministry of Finance has notified 2-Bromo-4-Methylpropiophenone as a controlled substance under the Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances (Regulation of Controlled Substances) Order, 2013, due to its increasing use in the manufacture of mephedrone, a psychotropic substance.

SYNTHETIC STIMULANT

The compound is most widely known as the primary starting material for manufacturing mephedrone (4-methylmethcathinone), a synthetic stimulant and psychotropic substance. The chemical is primarily produced by specialised pharmaceutical manufacturers as it's highly valued in organic synthesis for several legal industrial applications.

All persons and entities engaged in the manufacture, distribution, sale, purchase, possession, storage, consumption, import or export or in offering 2-Bromo- 4-Methylpropiophenone through any website, social media platform or other electronic means, are required to obtain registration number from their jurisdictional Zonal Director, Narcotics Control Bureau.

Obtaining registration by filing Form A and meeting other compliances are in accordance with the NDPS (RCS) Order, 2013, said the Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB) in a statement issued on Monday.

"All such firms/entities are requested to submit registration applications in Form B to the concerned NCB Zonal Unit well in advance, on or before August 7, so that the registration number is issued by NCB within the statutory period of 180 days from March 11," read the statement released on the basis of notification issued by Department of Revenue under the Ministry of Finance.

'Enterprises need to figure out their sovereignty strategy and roadmap'

bl.interview

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

Sovereignty has become a buzzword in the AI era with discussions around data localisation entering boardroom discussions globally. Everyone wants to go sovereign; however, the roadmap to this as well as the definition around the term are not well chalked-out.

Rohit Badlaney, General Manager, IBM Cloud Product, Design and Industry Platforms, spoke about how enterprises need to define sovereignty before planning their architecture design around sovereignty. Breaking down the Indian CXO-level conversations around this, Badlaney also discusses India's progress compared to other global markets.

Edited excerpts:

How have client priorities evolved when it comes to technology and AI?

They are more thoughtful of their landing zones, what stays on-premise, what goes to one cloud, considering what's happening around concentration risk of big hyperscalers, sovereignty and protection of assets within a market and what's fuelled by AI. I find clients to be more thoughtful now versus just saying the answer is public cloud. Clients that think through their app estate and landing zones, and design them correctly, get faster acceleration on both their hybrid cloud journeys and their AI journeys. So, I find that's changed since the 2018-19 timeframe.

Everyone wants to go sovereign. How does it impact the idea of putting your data on cloud? Are there valid concerns of data being geopolitically gated?

I find sovereignty to be a highly overloaded domain. I want to break it up a little bit. I think of sovereignty as a design choice. Everything around data governance — data privacy, data sovereignty — is it within region?

The biggest question clients ask is: can you not access the client data? So, enable clients to load their key encryptions so that IBM can never access that data.

There's also operational sovereignty — do you have local citizens managing the data? The third is technological sovereignty: are you building on open technologies? Are you building on things that are portable and doesn't lock you down against concentration risk?

If I pick a particular hyperscaler, can I get out? With hybrid cloud platform, if a client chooses our cloud today and another tomorrow, the day after they have the portability choice. What I advise clients is to make sure you have control over data, operational aspects. Can you pinpoint who is accessing your services and where?

Then build on an open portable platform. If you want a kill switch and not use our cloud, move it on-prem to your data centre. That's why we're so obsessed with open.

> Focus on the basics of leading with the right architecture for hybrid cloud, and then apply it to a domain specific use case to get the acceleration of AI
>
> **ROHIT BADLANEY**
> General Manager, IBM Cloud Product, Design and Industry Platforms

Do you see that understanding among clients?

It's improving. It is not as pervasively known, but some markets are more mature. India is getting there.

In all the CIO conversations I have had, it's definitely a boardroom topic of sovereignty. What is your point of view? What is your sovereignty point of view?

I encourage the industry to really break down the problem versus use the buzzword of sovereignty.

Indian companies are still lagging in the proof-of-concept to execution shift. What is the hurdle in that jump?

I definitely see AI taking off in certain clients.

The differentiation factor of those clients who've made progress is a well-thought-out hybrid cloud strategy.

Our CIO has a well-defined hybrid cloud platform. It is on-premise in their data centres.

Thinking through infrastructure, data strategy, automation strategy, once you've done that, AI becomes easier.

Then you apply AI to a specific problem or a domain. Focus on the basics of leading with the right architecture for hybrid cloud, and then apply it to a domain specific use case to get the acceleration of AI.

Automobile market gears up for 23 launches as EVs outpace ICE models

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

The next push in the automobile sector has begun nearly four months before Diwali, and this time the industry is offering something for almost every buyer.

Over the next nine months, automakers are expected to introduce 23 new passenger-vehicle models, including 16 electrified offerings — 10 battery-electric vehicles, four plug-in hybrids and two hybrid-assisted models — alongside seven all-new ICE vehicles. The lineup spans everything from sub-₹10 lakh city cars to ₹2-crore luxury sedans.

Setting the tone for the cycle, Mercedes-Benz India on Monday launched the S450e, its first plug-in hybrid S-Class in the country, priced at ₹2.20 crore (ex-showroom). Offering up to 115 km of electric-only range, the model reflects growing interest in alternative electrification pathways.

"Customers increasingly want options, and adoption grows when more products and powertrain choices become available," Mercedes-Benz India MD and CEO Santosh Iyer told *businessline*.

The June to March launch cycle will involve nearly every major manufacturer, including Toyota, Tata Motors, BYD, MG Motor, Honda, Hyundai, Kia, BMW, Mahindra and Maruti Suzuki.

Among the early launches are Toyota's Urban Cruiser Ebella EV and Tata Motors' Sierra EV, which will be followed by a steady stream of electric, hybrid and plug-in hybrid models through the rest of the financial year.

A CLASS APART. Mercedes-Benz India on Monday launched the S450e, its first plug-in hybrid S-Class in the country, priced ₹2.20 crore (ex-showroom)

CLEAR TREND

The numbers point to a clear trend. For every new internal-combustion vehicle entering the market, more than two electrified products are lining up as automakers respond to rising fuel costs, tighter efficiency norms and changing consumer preferences.

More importantly, electrification is no longer confined to a niche corner of the market.

It is moving simultaneously into entry-level hatchbacks, family SUVs, premium crossovers and luxury vehicles.

At the entry end, BYD's Seagull, Hyundai's Inster EV and Maruti Suzuki's Fronx EV are expected to test whether electric mobility can finally move into India's largest volume segments.

In the ₹12 lakh-₹25 lakh sweet spot, Tata Motors' Sierra EV, Honda's Elevate EV, Toyota's Urban Cruiser Ebella, Kia's Syros EV and MG's Starlight plug-in hybrid will compete for family buyers increasingly conscious of running costs.

At the premium end, products such as BYD's Seal U plug-in hybrid, Mercedes-Benz's S450e, the upcoming GLC EV, BMW's iX3 and MG's IM6 suggest electrification is steadily moving from a niche proposition to a mainstream technology choice.

THREE ROUTES

The opening months of the cycle also showcase three distinct strategies. Mercedes-Benz is betting on plug-in hybrids, Tata Motors is pushing dedicated EV platforms through the Sierra EV and its acti.ev+ architecture, while Toyota continues to back hybrids as a transition technology.

Together, these approaches highlight an industry that is no longer converging around a single solution but pursuing multiple pathways to electrification.

June opens with the Mercedes-Benz S450e, Toyota's Urban Cruiser Ebella and Tata Motors' Sierra EV. Kia's Syros EV and Honda's Elevate EV follow in the months ahead, while the festival season is expected to bring launches such as BYD's Seagull, MG's IM6, MG's Starlight plug-in hybrid and BMW's iX3.

Further launches, including Hyundai's Inster EV, Maruti Suzuki's Fronx EV, BYD's Seal U plug-in hybrid and Tata Motors' Avinya, are expected before the end of FY27.

Shobana Kamineni set to head Apollo Hospitals' Healthtech spin-off

Our Bureau
Chennai

Apollo Hospitals Enterprise (AHEL) on Monday confirmed that Shobana Kamineni is proposed to be appointed Executive Chairperson of Apollo Healthtech after the scheme receives approval from the National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT).

Apollo also stressed that an upside agreement, that is part of the scheme of arrangement, is fully funded by investor Rasmeli, and will not involve any cash outflow from Apollo Healthtech or its shareholders.

Releasing additional information around the proposed demerger and listing of Apollo Healthtech, Apollo said the proposed governance framework is an integral part of the restructuring scheme, and is designed to ensure strong oversight and long-term value creation.

TWELVE DIRECTORS

Apollo Healthtech's board will comprise 12 directors, with half of them being independent, in line with SEBI regulations. The company said shareholder approval will still be sought for Kamineni's appointment terms, tenure and remuneration.

To address governance concerns, Apollo said these nomination rights will lapse if the shareholding of either the investor (Rasmeli) or the promoter group falls below 10 per cent.

"As set out in the Articles of Association of Apollo Healthtech, half of the board shall comprise independent directors [six independent directors] as required under the SEBI LODR Regulations. Each of the directors shall be bound by his/her fiduciary duties, and the independent directors shall continue to retain autonomy, ensuring robust governance and balanced decision-making," Apollo said in its exchange filing. Apollo also reiterated plans to appoint a lead independent director and said the board's composition would be reviewed to ensure compliance.

Shobana Kamineni

NO CASH OUTFLOW

Apollo stressed that the upside agreement is fully funded by investor Rasmeli, and will not involve any cash outflow from Apollo Healthtech or its shareholders. Apollo added that all shareholders would benefit from the value creation, while the cost of the incentive mechanism would not be borne by the company.

"We would like to clarify that this upside agreement forms part of a broader performance-linked framework, contingent on the delivery of a highly ambitious equity value-linked target, which will be measured by the Multiple of Invested Capital (MOIC). No minimum amount is guaranteed, with a maximum of 9 per cent of the upside delivered to Rasmeli for achieving at least 4x MOIC," the company said in its exchange filing.

The Apollo Hospitals Group demerger and restructuring scheme is designed to spin off, merge and independently list its omnichannel retail pharmacy, pharmacy distribution and digital health business.

India a key growth engine for HVAC business, top market for residential ACs: LG Electronics

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

LG Electronics expects India to remain its top market for residential air-conditioners on the back of strong growth fuelled by lower penetration and higher disposable incomes. The South Korean consumer durable major said it is strengthening its market leadership in the India market through locally optimised HVAC (heating, ventilation, air-conditioning) solutions, especially with the third factory now coming up in Sri City.

Speaking to the media recently, Kiyoon Seong, Head of ES Asia/ India, Sales & Marketing Department, LG Electronics, said, "India's AC penetration has grown to 12 per cent now, from about 7 per cent 10 years ago. Air conditioners are no longer considered to be a luxury, but an essential product in the country. India has a large population, but the penetration of air conditioners still remains low. For room air-conditioners, India is already the largest market in terms of sales volume, and we expect this trend to continue because the market still has significant growth potential."

India's AC penetration has grown to 12 per cent from about 7 per cent 10 years ago

In terms of the overall HVAC business, India is among the top three markets. "There is a lot of room for growth in the commercial air-conditioning business. India is one of LG's key strategic markets globally. That is why LG established its third manufacturing facility in India to strengthen local production and support future growth," Seong noted.

The company operates two manufacturing units in Noida and Pune, with a facility coming up in Sri City.

AC makers in the country have had to take at least three rounds of price hikes this year due to implementation of new BEE ratings, as well as higher raw material costs.

Responding to a query on the impact of the ongoing geopolitical conflict, Seong said, "We are seeing cost pressures, particularly from compressors, heat exchangers and other key components required for higher-efficiency products. This is not unique to LG and is affecting manufacturers across the industry. The Indian market has experienced AC price increases in recent years due to higher commodity costs, including copper, aluminium and petrochemical-based materials. Although raw material costs have risen significantly, LG continues to work on reducing costs wherever possible."

The writer was recently in Seoul at the invitation of LG Electronics India

Lahori Zeera-maker eyes international presence

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

Archian Foods, known for beverage brand Lahori Zeera, is looking at establishing an international presence while also deepening pan-India presence.

The company, which ended FY26 with net revenues of about ₹775 crore, has also been doubling down on ramping up manufacturing capacity with a focus on contract manufacturing.

Saurabh Munjal, Co-founder and CEO of Archian Foods

"We have been witnessing strong growth year-on-year since 2019. We closed FY26 with net revenues of ₹775 crore. We are hoping to garner growth of 50-60 per cent in this fiscal as well and targeting close to ₹1,100-1,200 crore in FY27 in topline," Saurabh Munjal, Co-founder & CEO, Archian Foods, told *businessline*.

The brand, which has been scaling at a fast clip, has a relatively stronger presence in the northern, eastern and western regions.

"How we have approached growth is by not focusing on a large portfolio with a lot of SKUs, but instead we have been sharply focusing on our hero product and continuing to have a unified conversation with our conversation. What is key in the beverage category is habit formation, which means you are not just available but densely available. Hence, we have been focusing on going deeper rather than wider," Munjal explained.

Talking about international plans, Munjal said the company is keen to tap into the demand for ethnic packaged drinks from the Indian diaspora in international markets.

CHENNAI
businessline.
TUESDAY - JUNE 16 - 2026

QUICKLY.

Crude oil hits 3-month low on US, Iran peace deal

London: Crude oil prices slipped to a three-month low on Monday after US President Donald Trump and Iran's Deputy Foreign Minister said they had reached an initial deal to end the war and to resume traffic through the Strait of Hormuz. Brent crude futures fell $4.16 to $83.17 a barrel by 1315 GMT and US WTI was at $80.49, down $4.39. REUTERS

Aluminium falls to lowest since late March

London: Aluminium prices fell to their lowest level in two-and-a-half months as a US-Iran framework agreement to end their war improved prospects for deliveries from Gulf producers. The benchmark three-month aluminium on the LME was down 3.2 per cent at $3,422.50 a tonne by 1120 GMT. REUTERS

Gold drifts higher as US, Iran reach peace deal

Gold prices climbed to a near one-week high after Iran and the US agreed to halt their war, a move that eased expectations of higher interest rates. Spot gold rose 3 per cent to $4,344.77 per ounce, as of 1242 GMT. US gold futures climbed 3 per cent to $4,366.80. Silver rose 4.6 per cent to $71.07. REUTERS

Row over new law firm to handle basmati cases

'ARBITRARY DECISION'. Exporters claim Apeda's decision to tackle GI, IPR cases was taken without consultation

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai

Two rice exporters' organisations have urged the Commerce Ministry to reconsider the Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (Apdea) decision to "arbitrarily" appoint a law firm to handle global cases on basmati geographical indication (GI) and intellectual property rights (IPR).

However, Apeda sources said the law firm had been engaged after due process of tender by an expert selection panel.

Stirring a controversy over the decision, the All-India Rice Exporters Association (AIREA) and The Basmati Rice Millers and Exporters Association (Punjab), or BRMEA, in separate letters to Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal and Apeda Chairman Abhishek Dev, said the law firm had been selected without consulting stakeholders and exporters.

The organisations said their representations do not question the law firm's professional competence, and they were not against the firm. One of the main reasons for raising the concern was the firm's "conflict of interest." "Our concern relates to institutional governance, stakeholder confidence and adherence to the Memorandum and Rules of BEDF (Basmati Export Development Foundation) in matters concerning protection of India's basmati Geographical Indication," said AIREA President Satish Goel.

OFFICIAL STAND. However, Apeda sources said the law firm had been engaged after due process of tender by an expert selection panel

CONFLICT OF INTEREST

Bal Krishan Garg, President of BRMEA, said one of the most contentious issues in recent years was the demand to include Madhya Pradesh in the Basmati GI area.

The law firm selected by Apeda had represented petitioners for the inclusion of some regions in the State where basmati rice is grown.

Apeda had been "historically opposing" the inclusion of Madhya Pradesh regions in the GI area for basmati rice.

"Any firm representing parties favouring the expansion of the basmati rice growing area while simultaneously advising Apeda is in conflict of interest," he said.

BASMATI GI SCOPE

"Concerns have been raised by stakeholders regarding past positions taken (by the law firm) in matters relating to the territorial scope of basmati GI. Without commenting on the merits of such issues, we believe these concerns deserve consideration before any final appointment is made," said AIREA's Goel.

The GI defines that basmati rice is grown in the Indo-Gangetic plains. The law firm chosen by Apeda questioned this and termed it arbitrary.

The firm said that agro-climatic factors should prevail over historical and reputational considerations, and public perception had no "independent significance" in GI law, said BRMEA's Garg.

"These propositions (of the law firm) are fundamentally inconsistent with the position consistently maintained by Apeda and the Government of India," he said. Madhya Pradesh-linked petitioners, lawyers and Pakistan have opposed India's application to the European Union, while Apeda has opposed Pakistan's application.

"Apeda's international position is built on the fact that basmati originates from the specified Indo-Gangetic plain area," said the BRMEA President. Referring to the BEDF rules, Goyal said rule 19.2.21 specifically empowered the board to appoint and pay consultants and advisors. The proposed law firm is a strategic consultant and advisor to BEDF, and, therefore, it should have been involved in the selection.

Rule 19.1 of the BEDF rules makes the board responsible for the management and administration of the society's affairs and vests in it all powers for the furtherance of its objectives, he said.

"Current assignment proposed by Apeda and BEDF goes well beyond conventional litigation and requires complete alignment with India's long-standing policy...," Garg said.

WRONG SIGNAL

Any perception that India is internally divided on territorial boundaries, historical reputation and the legal foundations of basmati could be exploited by adverse parties, particularly Pakistan.

This may weaken India's position in ongoing and future proceedings, said the BRMEA President.

Monsoon deficient by 32% during June 1-15, says IMD

PATCHY PROGRESS. Nearly 65% of the country remains rain-deficient so far this monsoon season, with North-West India being the lone region to report surplus rainfall of 8 per cent

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

India received 42.4 mm rainfall in the first fortnight of the monsoon season that began on June 1, against the normal 62.1 mm, registering a deficit of 32 per cent.

Three of the four meteorological regions reported below-normal rain.

Only North-West India reported an 8 per cent surplus rain, and in terms of geographical areas, 65 per cent of India was rainfall deficient during June 1-15.

According to India Meteorological Department (IMD) data, the south peninsular region, comprising Kerala, Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, Telangana, Andhra Pradesh and Puducherry, has received 68.2 mm rainfall until June 15, which is 9 per cent lower than its long period average (LPA) of 75 mm.

Similarly, the East and North-East meteorological subdivision, comprising Assam, West Bengal, Bihar, Jharkhand and other NE States, reported 41 per cent less rainfall at 80.8 mm against the LPA of 136 mm. Central India, comprising Odisha, Chhattisgarh, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra and Gujarat, reported 57 per cent deficient rain at 22.7 mm against the normal 53 mm rainfall.

The North-West region, which includes Punjab, Haryana, Uttar Pradesh and Rajasthan, among others, reported 27.5 mm actual rain during June 1-15 against the normal 25.4 mm.

MERCURY MAY RISE

Of the 36 meteorological subdivisions, six reported large deficiency (60-99 per cent below normal rain), 15 reported deficient (20-59 per cent below normal rain), eight reported normal (81-119 per cent of the LPA), five reported excess (120-159 per cent of the LPA) and only east Rajasthan and Andaman & Nicobar Islands reported a large excess (more than 60 per cent above normal).

The weather bureau also said that a gradual rise in maximum temperatures is likely over North-West India by 2-4 degree C till June 18 and thereafter there will be no significant change until June 21. No significant change in maximum temperatures is likely over the rest of the country till June 21.

Further, advisories have been issued to take precautions as heat wave conditions are very likely in isolated pockets over Telangana during June 15-16 and in Vidarbha during June 15-17, and hot and humid conditions are likely over Konkan, Goa, Madhya Maharashtra, Marathawada and Odisha during June 15-17.

Monsoon set to advance in four-five days

Vinson Kurian
Thiruvananthapuram

Dry westerly winds sweeping in from across the international border continue to dominate North and North-West India, blocking moisture-laden south-easterly monsoon currents from the Bay of Bengal and keeping the seasonal advance at a standstill.

Forecasts, however, point to a tentative revival of rainfall activity along the West Coast during the coming week.

The India Meteorological Department (IMD) said on Monday that the northern limit of the monsoon had remained unchanged for the past week.

The monsoon boundary currently passes through Harnai and Solapur in Maharashtra, Hyderabad, Bhadradri Kothagudem in Telangana, Kalingapatnam in Andhra Pradesh, Paradeep and Baripada in Odisha, Purulia in West Bengal, Dhanbad in Jharkhand, and Muzaffarpur in Bihar. The IMD expects conditions to remain favourable over the next 4-5 days for the monsoon to advance into more parts of Maharashtra, the rest of Karnataka, Telangana and Andhra Pradesh, as well as West Bengal, Odisha, Jharkhand, Bihar and parts of south Chhattisgarh, where it has already established its presence.

A positive development is the establishment of the crucial seasonal trough extending from west Rajasthan to the plains of West Bengal through north-east Rajasthan, north Madhya Pradesh, south Uttar Pradesh, Bihar and Jharkhand.

The trough persisted on Monday and is expected to act as the primary corridor through which moisture-laden south-easterlies from the Bay can penetrate Central and North-West India.

NO BAY LOW

A stronger monsoon surge typically requires the formation of a low-pressure area over the Bay of Bengal to energise and deepen the moist south-easterly flow. Current forecasts, however, offer little support for the development of such a system through the remainder of June.

While some weather models indicate weak wind convergence along the Andhra Pradesh-Odisha coast, they do not suggest any significant intensification capable of generating sustained rain-bearing systems.

Soybean imports may touch a record 9 lt for oil year 2025-26

Vishwanath Kulkarni
Bengaluru

Soybean imports during the oil year 2025-26 ending in September are likely to touch a record 9 lakh tonnes, a huge increase over 0.02 lakh tonnes (lt) in the last oil year. The sharp increase in imports is due to the demand-supply mismatch.

The Soyabean Processors Association of India (SOPA) has estimated that till May-end in the current oil year, soybean imports have touched 6.3 lt, with bulk of them coming in the past four months. Based on the import trend, SOPA has revised the projections and expects imports to touch 9 lt for the year, from the earlier estimates of 6 lt for the year.

"Soybean imports will be at an all-time high this year and should help us make up for the shortfall in supplies," said DN Pathak, Executive Director, SOPA. The earlier high in imports was about 6 lt a couple of years ago.

OUTLOOK RAISED

SOPA has also raised soybean crushing figures to 104 lt from the earlier 102 lt. "We have also revised the soybean meal exports upwards to 11 lakh tonnes from 10 lakh tonnes earlier," Pathak said.

India imports soybean mainly from least developed countries in sub-Saharan Africa such as Niger, Togo and Nigeria, where the non-GMO varieties are grown. Till May-end, the market arrivals were lower by 13 per cent at 72.5 lt compared to the corresponding last year's 83.5 lt. Crushings during the October-May period of the oil year 2025-26 were lower at 73 lt (79 lt).

SOPA had estimated soybean production of 110.26 lt for 2025-26 — about 14 per cent lower than the previous year's 128.82 lt — on a decline in area and the output being impacted by weather vagaries.

FEED SECTOR OFFTAKE

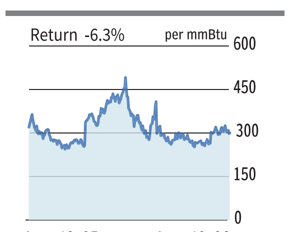
Total crushing for the oil year 2025-26 is estimated lower at 104 lt (113.50 lt). As a result of this, the production of soybean meal is expected to be lower at 82.09 lt (89.56 lt). Consumption by the feed sector is projected flat at 62 lt, while the offtake from the food sector is estimated flat at 8 lt for the year, according to SOPA.

The shortfall in supplies has led to an increase in prices in the domestic market, and feed makers and consuming sectors, such as the poultry sector, have been expressing concern in the recent weeks.

The USDA recently raised India's soybean imports from 5 lt to 7 lt for 2025-26. India had a smaller soybean crop in 2025-26, and meal prices reached nearly 60 per cent premium compared to the US origin.

Go short in natural gas if futures slip below ₹286

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau



WEAK BIAS
Target: ₹270
Stop-loss: ₹300

Natural gas futures (₹290/mmBtu) were down nearly 4 per cent last week, and thus posted a loss for the second consecutive week. The contract is now hovering near a support. The June futures fell off from the resistance at ₹323 towards the end of the first week of the month.

The price is now below both the 21- and 50-day moving averages and has slipped below a trendline.

COMMODITY CALL.

While the above factors show a bearish bias, the contract has a support ahead at ₹286. If this level is breached, the near-term outlook could turn bearish.

In such a scenario, natural gas futures could decline to ₹270. Support below ₹270 is at ₹260. On the other hand, if the contract reclaims ₹300, it could recover back to ₹323.

A breakout of ₹323 will open the door for a rally to ₹350. Nevertheless, as it stands, the bears are gaining traction but there is one last hurdle to win over the bulls.

TRADE STRATEGY

Short natural gas futures if they slip below the support at ₹286. Target and stop-loss can be ₹270 and ₹300.

Since the risk-reward ratio is only slightly above 1, risk-averse traders can refrain from trading.

12 ships carrying urea, DAP may head to India once Hormuz opens

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

The government on Monday said that with 196.65 lakh tonnes (lt) of fertilizer in stock as of June 14, the availability of crop nutrients is sufficient to meet demand.

It said that with the conflict in West Asia resolved, as many as 12 ships carrying 3.3 lt of urea and 2.57 lt of di-ammonium phosphate (DAP) may transit through the Strait of Hormuz, which will further boost domestic availability.

At the inter-ministerial briefing on the West Asia crisis, which began with the Iran war, Fertilizer Ministry's Joint Secretary Bandana Preyashi said since March 1, Indian companies had entered into contracts to import 50 lt of of fertilizers, of which 21.95 lt of urea and 4.18 lt of DAP, had arrived in the country.

She said against a total fertilizer demand of 383.9 lt during (April-September) for kharif sowing, the country had 196.65 lt of stock of various fertilizers available as of June 14.

The stock was 155.19 lt on April 1.

Official data show that sales of urea, DAP, MoP, complex and SSP were 70.57 lt during April-May.

7-10 DAYS WAIT

After factoring sales in the first fortnight of June, total sales in the current kharif season had reached 102.78 lt, she said, adding that it means the requirement may be 281.12 lt by September 30.

The official said that as many as 16 ships carrying different fertilizers — 8 with 3.3 lt urea, 4 with 2.6 lt DAP, 3 with 1.1 lt sulphur and 1 ship with ammonia — were awaiting passage through the Strait of Hormuz.

Sources said that once the Strait is reopened after the agreement between the US and Iran, these may take 7-10 days to reach India.

The government said India had imported a total of 39.36 lt of fertilizers and domestically produced 123.65 lt between March 1 and June 14, which helped in bolstering availability.

India has secured urea supplies from Oman, Malaysia, Vietnam, Georgia, Nigeria, Russia, Finland, Egypt, Algeria, Turkiye and the Netherlands, while DAP and complex (a combination of N, P, K, S nutrients) fertilizers were imported from Russia, Morocco, Egypt, the US, Jordan, South Korea, Tunisia and Saudi Arabia.

Blenders, upcountry buyers lift tea prices at Coonoor auctions

V Sajeev Kumar
Kochi

Brisk buying from blenders and upcountry buyers pushed tea prices at Coonoor auctions, which witnessed a ₹2 per kg rise in average price realisation.

Traders said there was improved demand, and the offered quantity was also lower, which facilitated the prices to move up.

Generally, a strong demand was noticed in the overall CTC leaf in Sale 24 with high-priced teas and better liquoring sorts sold steady dearer by ₹3-₹4 per kg and more at times in line with quality.

The better medium sorts had good demand and sold fully firm to dearer by ₹2-₹3.

LEAF DEARER

Global Tea Auctioneers said that the offered quantity in leaf was 10,43,732 kg, witnessing 96 per cent sale, while for dust, the sales percentage was 88 out of the offered quantity of 3,34,618 kg. The mediums and plainer sorts bolder grades sold fully firm to dearer by ₹1-₹2 and brokens sold dearer by ₹2-₹3. The primary whole leaf grades in orthodox sold steady to dearer by ₹3-₹4 a kg and more at times. The brokens were lower by ₹1-₹2 with some withdrawals.

DUST LOSES STEAM

The high priced teas and better liquoring sorts in Dust CTC were lower by ₹6-₹8 and more at times with a few withdrawals.

The primary orthodox dust grades were lower ₹3-₹4 with some withdrawals. The secondaries and finer dusts were barely steady and lower by ₹2-₹3 a kg.

Agrizy comes up with AI-based formulation studio for new products

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai

Agrizy, a business-to-business platform in the agri-processing sector, has come up with a Gen AI (artificial intelligence) formulation studio to reduce the cost and timelines for product development, Co-founder and CEO Vicky Dodani said.

"Once a company comes up with concept ideation, they may not have the required resources or marketing insights of a country in the customer segment. Our Gen AI formulation studio cuts the number of iterations required to launch a new product, and it reduces over 90 per cent of the options that need to be done manually," he told *businessline* in an online interaction.

The studio has been developed in-house. For example, if someone wants to launch a lip balm, it can tell the exact ingredients, per kg cost of composition, regulatory challenges in various geographies and the total cost of production.

The studio has been trained on failure data to provide a "deterministic layer", said the company's Co-founder.

In the second stage, the product has to be taken to the research and development (R&D) lab to know various things, such as its shelf life and whether it would work.

LAB REVAMP

Towards this end, Agrizy has revamped its lab to work on food and beverages (F&B), snacks, savouries and functional protein bars and other similar products.

> The studio can help cut costs and time for bringing out new products
>
> **VICKY DODANI**
> Co-founder and CEO, Agrizy

"Yes, these are the three broad categories in which we have revamped the R&D lab. We have onboarded senior and R&D formulation scientists," said Dodani.

The company has a healthy mix of customers, both in India and abroad.

However, Agrizy focuses more on Europe, where most of its exports head. "Today, we are supplying our products to more than 20 countries. Our major products to Europe are fruits and vegetables," he said.

Besides, it ships customised pulses and purees, apart from ingredients for the wellness segment, such as gherkins and baby corn, said the Co-founder of the start-up, which has divided its business into F&B and wellness segments.

CUSTOMISING PRODUCTS

On the F&B front, Agrizy, founded in September 2021, deals with spices, plant ingredients and their extracts. For example, it deals in curcumin, derived from turmeric, or *ashwagandha* plant extract. "We do a lot of research on these products. We have come up with higher bioavailable products, liposomal products from these extracts. These are wellness ingredients. We use the ingredients for formulated products in the nutraceutical and cosmetics segment," said Dodani. The products are used for nutraceuticals and cosmetic items.

Agrizy, a contract development and manufacturing organisation (CDMO), launches 25-30 products a year utilising the Gen-AI formulation studio.

While the company sources auspices in Kerala, Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, Karnataka and the North-East, it procures and processes them in clusters where they are grown.

QUICKLY.

MoD gives nod to ₹500 cr drone hub at IIT-Kanpur

New Delhi: The Ministry of Defence (MoD) has granted in-principle approval for a ₹500 crore National Military Drone Technology Hub at IIT-Kanpur, offering a full stack capability from design, test and certify military payloads, data links, ground stations and counter-drone systems. The Uttar Pradesh Expressways Industrial Development Authority, the nodal agency for the Uttar Pradesh Defence Industrial Corridor (UPDIC), drafted the proposal submitted to the MoD. OUR BUREAU

Settle ₹200 cr dues, liquor makers urge Jharkhand

New Delhi: Three leading alcoholic beverage industry associations — CIABC, BAI and ISWAI — have urged the Jharkhand government to clear pending dues exceeding ₹200 crore, warning that delays could disrupt supplies and investments. They also sought the separation of supplier payments from internal reconciliation processes of the Jharkhand State Beverages Corporation. PTI

Unemployment rises as labour force participation dips to 54.4%

DISPARITY. Overall, male participation is twice that of females, shows Govt data

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Overall Labour Force Participation Rate (LFPR) dipped to 54.4 per cent in May, down from 55 per cent the previous month of this year, according to the latest government data.

This marginal downward trend was mirrored on a year-on-year basis, with the national LFPR slipping by 0.4 percentage points compared to May 2025, as shown by the Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS) released by the National Statistics Office (NSO) on Monday.

While rural participation stood at 56.6 per cent, a decrease of 0.3 percentage points, year-on-year, urban areas recorded a notably lower participation rate of 49.8 per cent, marking a sharper annual contraction of 0.6 percentage points, as per the PLFS data listed out in a statement of the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation.

GENDER ROLES. Females are notably more active in the labour force in rural areas than in urban areas

LFPR ANALYSIS

"The LFPR for persons aged 15 years and above was reported as 54.4 per cent in May 2026, compared to 55 per cent in April 2026," the primary source of data on activity participation, employment and unemployment conditions of the population. There remains a significant gap between male and female labour force participation.

NATIONAL LEVEL

At the national level, male participation is more than double that of female participation. However, females are notably more active in the labour force in rural areas than in urban areas, possibly due to agricultural and seasonal manual labour opportunities.

Female Labour Force Participation Rate (FLFPR) for individuals aged 15 years and above stood at 32.8 per cent in May 2026.

In rural areas, FLFPR was recorded at 36.7 per cent, whereas it remained almost at the same level at 24.8 per cent in urban areas compared to the previous month. Compared to May 2025, the overall female LFPR declined marginally by 0.4 percentage points, from 33.2 per cent to 32.8 per cent in May 2026.

Rural FLFPR remained broadly unchanged, whereas LFPR for urban females recorded a decline of 0.5 percentage points over the year, said the Ministry. It slipped to 51.4 per cent, a slight come down from the 52.2 per cent recorded in April and marginally below the 51.7 per cent figure from the same period last year.

MNRE floats wind supply chain portal

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The Minister of New and Renewable Energy, Pralhad Joshi, on Monday launched the Wind Turbine Supply Chain Management (WT-MARUT) portal at the Global Wind Day Conference in Goa.

This is India's first dedicated digital platform for wind supply chain management.

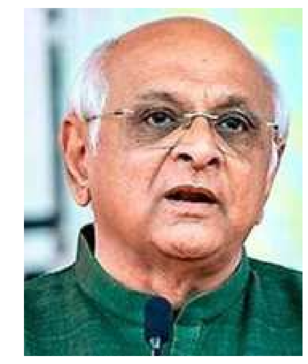
Developed under the aegis of the Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE), supported by the Indian Wind Turbine Manufacturers Association (IWTMA), the WT-MARUT portal will provide visibility for component sourcing and support the domestic sourcing requirements under the ALMM framework, the IWTMA said.

It will also ensure secure hosting of industry data within India, the industry body added.

The country added a record 6.1 GW of new wind capacity in FY26, an increase of 46 per cent y-o-y.

Gujarat unveils flexible five-year industrial policy

Avinash Nair
Ahmedabad



A file photo of Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel

In a significant departure from previous industrial policies, Gujarat on Monday unveiled a flexible 'Choose Your Incentive' regime and relocation framework for industries operating within city limits, betting on customised incentives and spatial reorganisation of manufacturing to drive the State's next phase of industrial growth.

BUSINESS EASE

The measures form part of the Viksit Gujarat Industrial Policy 2026, which will remain in force for five years from June 1, 2026.

The policy seeks to build on Gujarat's strengths in manufacturing and exports while positioning the State as a hub for advanced manufacturing, innovation and research-driven industries.

Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel said the policy had been designed keeping future industries in mind, with special thrust on sectors such as green hydrogen, green ammonia, battery storage, electrolysers, electric mobility, aerospace, space manufacturing, semiconductor support industries, robotics, drones, sports goods and toys.

"For the first time in the State, we are coming with a 'Choose Your Incentive' scheme, where industries can choose from a bouquet of incentives," Additional Chief Secretary (Industries) Mamta Verma said while outlining the policy.

The new framework moves away from a one-size-fits-all incentive structure and gives businesses greater flexibility in selecting benefits aligned with their investment requirements.

"It will be very easy for any unit to get incentives. Apart from the flexibility to choose incentives, units can get faster approvals," Verma said.

The government has reduced the number of documents required for availing incentives from around 30 to 14, and the process has been streamlined. "We are coming for the first time with Project THRIVE, which is looking into the concept of decongesting cities," Verma said.

Units opting for relocation will be treated as new units and become eligible for a range of incentives and support measures. These include capital subsidy, a wage support subsidy of ₹5,000 per employee per month for six months, assistance for housing and worker infrastructure, and relaxation in floor space index (FSI) norms.

According to government estimates, a micro unit investing ₹1 crore can receive incentives worth ₹25-45 lakh, a medium enterprise investing ₹100 crore is eligible for ₹35 crore-₹45 crore; large projects investing ₹1,000 crore can get ₹250-350 crore. In identified thrust sectors, ₹1,000 crore investment potentially qualifies for ₹450-500 crore. A mega unit investing ₹21,000 crore can receive incentives ranging from ₹6,300 crore to ₹7,000 crore, while an ultra-mega investment of ₹37,000 crore can avail benefits of up to ₹15,000 crore.

Gem, jewellery exports drop 2% on gold supply shortage, weak demand

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Gem and jewellery exports dipped two per cent in May to $2.05 billion against $2.10 billion in the same period last year, largely due to the shortage of gold and growing uncertainty over the war between the US and Iran.

In rupee terms, exports were up 9 per cent to ₹19,574 crore (₹17,896 crore a year ago) due to the depreciation of the rupee against the dollar.

The overall imports declined 16 per cent to $1.41 billion ($1.69 billion) and in rupee terms, it was down 6 per cent at ₹13,500 crore (₹14,406 crore).

After prolonged sluggishness, the export of cut and polished diamonds increased 3 per cent to $981 million ($949 million). The export of polished lab grown diamonds jumped 26 per cent at $101 million ($81 million). Gold jewellery dipped 15 per cent at $758 million ($890 million).

Kirit Bhansali, Chairman, GJEPC, said a key reason for the decline in exports was the tightening in gold imports, which had affected the availability of gold for export manufacturing.

The impact is evident in gold consumption for export production, which declined 21 per cent to 11 tonnes during April–May this year against 14 tonnes logged in same period last year, he said.

EXPORT TREND IN FY'27

In two months of this fiscal, gem and jewellery exports declined 6 per cent to $4.27 billion ($4.55 billion) while in rupee terms, it dipped 4 per cent to ₹40,399 crore (₹38,848 crore).

The import of gems and jewellery was down 13 per cent at $3.25 billion ($3.72 billion).

The decline was primarily driven by a sharp contraction in plain gold jewellery exports, which fell 40 per cent year-on-year to $636 million ($1.06 billion). The sector has been facing challenges arising from elevated gold prices, limited availability of gold for export production and regulatory bottlenecks affecting the supply of gold through banking channels.

Strengthening exports is critical to supporting India's balance of payments position and addressing the current account deficit, said Bhansali.

"We have noted with concern that gold availability from banks has been affected due to certain regulatory bottlenecks, creating additional challenges for exporters. These issues have been further compounded by a sharp rise in gold prices," he added.

Further, the increase in gold import duty from 6 per cent to 15 per cent has significantly raised the landed cost of gold.

While exporters continue to bear the burden of higher input costs, the duty drawback rates have not been revised accordingly, adversely affecting their competitiveness and margins, said the GJEPC.

'AP, Uttar Pradesh and Rajasthan are top investor-friendly States for clean energy'

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

For investors navigating India's crowded renewable energy landscape, a new study offers a roadmap. Andhra Pradesh, Uttar Pradesh and Rajasthan have emerged as the most investor-friendly destinations for clean energy capital, according to The Institute for Energy Economics and Financial Analysis (IEEFA)'s annual *Indian States' Electricity Transition (SET) 2026* study.

IEEFA evaluated 21 States on their preparedness to navigate the next phase of electricity transition, scoring them across regulatory initiatives, market enablers, infrastructure readiness and demand-side factors.

The study's authors, Saloni Sachdeva Michael, IEEFA's Lead Energy Specialist for India Clean Energy Transition, and Tanya Rana, Energy Analyst for South Asia, said, "The pace and effectiveness of electricity transition will ultimately be shaped at the subnational level, where policy implementation, infrastructure development and demand-side realities intersect."

THE FRONT-RUNNERS

Rajasthan makes perhaps the most compelling case on pure cost grounds. The State offers the lowest green tariff premium in the country — just ₹0.05 per kilowatt-hour — reflecting its renewable resource abundance and policy choices to keep the cost of clean power competitive. Its renewable energy policy landscape is among the most well-established in India, giving investors the regulatory predictability they prize above almost everything else.

Uttar Pradesh has set itself an ambitious solar capacity target of 22 GW by FY27. It has introduced solar-hour-aligned time-of-day tariffs and is making early moves in green hydrogen, with a target of 1 million tonnes by 2028. This is a market that global investors are increasingly circling. Its green tariff premium for FY26 stands at ₹0.34 per kWh, lower than the previous year, signalling a direction of travel that investors will find encouraging. The study noted, however, that the State "could benefit from accelerating its efforts to install storage capacity to facilitate reliability of renewable energy sources".

Andhra Pradesh rounds out the list with perhaps the most diversified clean energy profile. With 1.44 GW of pumped hydro storage either operational or under construction, it directly addresses the intermittency problem that remains renewable energy's central challenge for investors. It has adopted the Green Energy Open Access Rules of 2022, easing the path for large consumers to directly procure renewable power, and is actively deploying smart meters to implement solar-hour-aligned tariffs.

Andhra Pradesh's progress across multiple dimensions "has attracted significant investments across energy storage, green hydrogen production and exports, and renewable energy projects," the study said.

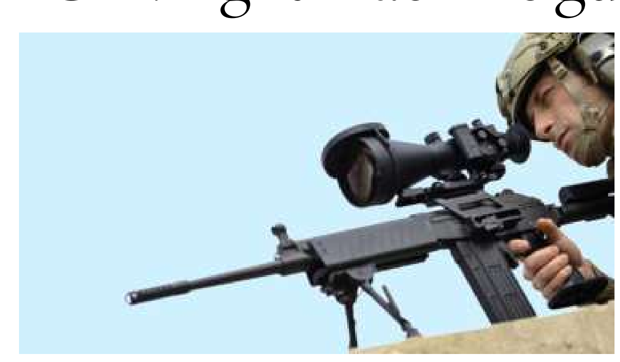
Army picks Israel's MEPRO X6 telescopic sights for NEGEV light machine guns

Dalip Singh
New Delhi

The Army has selected the Israeli defence company Meprolight's MEPRO X6 telescopic sight as the dedicated daytime optic for its in-service NEGEV light machine guns, which will be manufactured locally under a partnership with India's RRP Defense.

The MEPRO X6 delivers enhanced target identification and engagement capabilities at extended ranges for one of the world's largest military forces, the Israeli company said in a statement.

State-owned Bharat Electronics Ltd (BEL), which secured the tender with a solution based on the MEPRO X6, will supply products sourced from RRP Defense.



BULLSEYE. Bharat Electronics Ltd, which secured the tender with a solution based on the MEPRO X6, will supply products sourced from RRP Defense

LOCAL MAKE

The Army's overall evaluation process was focused on reliability, durability, accuracy and ease of operation under demanding conditions.

To support local manufacturing and the Make in India initiative, Meprolight has signed a comprehensive transfer of technology (ToT) agreement with RRP Defense, under which the company will transfer the knowledge, processes and manufacturing capabilities required for full production of the MEPRO X6 in India, the company said.

RRP Defense is awaiting the signing of a contract from BEL to begin manufacturing telescopic sights for NEGEV 7.62x51 mm light machine guns.

Since 2020, the Army has contracted 57,479 NEGEVs, with 16,479 of them directly coming from the original manufacturer, Israel Weapon Industries (IWI), while the remaining 41,000 units for the infantry will be sourced through PLR Systems, a joint venture between the Adani Group and IWI.

The Army has contracted 57,479 NEGEVs, with 16,479 of them directly coming from the original manufacturer IWI

NIGHT VISION

RRP Defense has a partnership with Meprolight and has established assembly lines for the production of conventional electro-optic series of weapon sights, including 'Red Dot' for the Army and 'Mepro Mor' for the Coast Guard.

It will roll out the manufacturing of the MEPRO X6 at its Navi Mumbai facility.

From Kashmir's hearths to global menus, Kaladi cheese gets scientific makeover

Gulzar Bhat
Srinagar

For generations, Kaladi has been a culinary staple across the hills of Udhampur and the Pir Panjal region of Jammu and Kashmir.

Often described as the region's answer to mozzarella, the traditional cheese is prized for its unique taste, texture and cultural significance. Made of cow or buffalo milk, Kaladi is a ripened dairy product cherished for its firm exterior and soft and creamy interior. However, despite its popularity, Kaladi's commercial expansion has been squeezed by its short shelf life.

But that may now be changing. According to Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Science and Technology and Earth Sciences Jitendra Singh, the GI-tagged cheese is undergoing technological intervention at the Central Food Technological Research Institute (CFTRI), Mysuru, one of India's premier food research institutions.

The Minister on Monday announced via a social media post that scientists had already succeeded in extending Kaladi's shelf life to 21 days without affecting its quality, texture or nutritional value.

The development could mark a turning point for the traditional dairy product, opening possibilities for largescale marketing beyond Jammu and Kashmir.

NEXT PHASE

Researchers are now working on the next phase, a commercially scalable product "that can be served in different recipes by professional food chains," Singh said.

Both the officials and locals said that if successful, Kaladi could move from local kitchens and roadside eateries to restaurant chains and retail shelves across the country. "The push could boost rural incomes and help bring the heritage cheese to a wider community of cheese lovers," said Sanjay Kumar of Ramnagar.

Naidu seeks Singapore PM's support for collaboration in several areas

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N Chandrababu Naidu met Singapore Prime Minister Lawrence Wong on Monday as part of his two-day visit to Singapore and discussed bilateral cooperation in diverse fields, including technology and urban development.

Naidu invited Singapore to explore the import of horticulture and aquaculture products from Andhra Pradesh, particularly those cultivated through natural farming practices, while highlighting the State's efforts to promote natural farming.

EMERGING SECTORS

He requested support in developing semiconductor manufacturing ecosystems and capacity-building initiatives in Andhra Pradesh.

STRATEGIC TALKS. Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N Chandrababu Naidu with Singapore Prime Minister Lawrence Wong during a meeting on Monday PTI

Naidu invited Singapore to partner with Andhra Pradesh in strengthening urban management systems in Amaravati and other cities across the State.

The Chief Minister further proposed deeper cooperation in port-led development, airport infrastructure, logistics and emerging economic opportunities.

Prime Minister Wong expressed interest in the development of Amaravati and sought details regarding the capital city's progress. He enquired about educational institutions, infrastructure projects and the internationally benchmarked urban development initiatives being undertaken in the capital region, according to a release.

Milma targets ₹10,000 cr turnover by 2030-31, eyes global expansion

Our Bureau
Kochi

The Kerala Cooperative Milk Marketing Federation, popularly known as Milma, has set an ambitious target of achieving a turnover of ₹10,000 crore by 2030-31.

Speaking at the inaugural session of the Kerala Retail Conclave, organised by the Cochin Chamber of Commerce and Industry in association with Altacit Global in Kochi, Milma Chairman KS Mani said, "Kerala ranks third in the country in milk productivity, yet nearly 50 per cent of the State's milk requirement is met through imports from other States. This presents tremendous opportunities for investment and expansion in the dairy sector," Mani said.

Milma recorded a turnover of ₹4,344 crore in 2025-26 and continues to maintain a farmer-centric business model, with nearly 83 per cent of its selling price being passed on directly to dairy farmers, its Chairman noted.

QUICKLY.

Novartis unveils advanced prostrate cancer drug

Mumbai: Swiss drugmaker Novartis has launched its advanced prostrate cancer drug Pluvicto in India. The development comes about four months after the parent company had announced its exit from its listed entity in India. According to Novartis India, Pluvicto (lutetium (177Lu) vipivotide tetraxetan) was the country's first "regulatory authority approved" radioligand therapy for patients with prostate-specific membrane antigen-positive prostate cancer. It is designed to target prostate cancer cells, minimising exposure to healthy tissues, the company said, without disclosing the medicine's price. OUR BUREAU

Zetwerk's FY26 revenue rises to ₹15,900 crore

Bengaluru: IPO-bound contract manufacturing firm Zetwerk reported an estimated revenue of ₹15,900 crore in FY26, up from ₹12,800 crore in FY25, supported by strong execution capabilities and a robust order pipeline, according to a CRISIL Ratings report. The company has filed its draft papers confidentially and has appointed bankers, including Kotak Mahindra Capital, JM Financial, Avendus Capital and the Indian units of HSBC, Morgan Stanley and Goldman Sachs to manage the issue. OUR BUREAU

Noida airport opens for business, eyes a 'true aerotropolis' status

GROWTH CATALYST. Aims to boost regional travel options, serve as economic hub for western UP and beyond

Rohit Vaid
New Delhi

The National Capital Region (NCR) got its third airport on Monday as Noida International Airport (NIA) at Jewar commenced domestic commercial operations, and the Centre is thinking well beyond runways and terminals.

The vision is of a true aerotropolis: a self-sustaining economic universe where manufacturing, information technology, hospitality, cargo, agriculture and aviation services grow around the greenfield facility, generating employment and economic activity for a region that stretches from western Uttar Pradesh all the way to Agra.

Union Civil Aviation Minister Kinjarapu Ram Mohan Naidu, speaking at the launch of domestic commercial operations, said: "It is the vision of both the Government of Uttar Pradesh and the Government of India that NIA should evolve not only as a transportation hub but as a true aerotropolis."

The ambition, he added, was for NIA to become "an integrated ecosystem" where industries ranging from manufacturing and information technology to hospitality, cargo, maintenance repair and overhaul services, and other aviation-related activities develop organically around the airport.

CONNECTIVITY BOOST. IndiGo flight 6E-2278 receives a water salute as commercial flight operations kick off at Noida International Airport in Jewar on Monday ANI

ECONOMIC ACTIVITY

"This airport is not merely about transporting passengers from one place to another. Across the world, wherever airports emerge, tremendous economic activity follows," the Minister said.

The launch itself carried a moment that set the tone for what the government wants this airport to represent. Among the first passengers to fly out of NIA were farmers whose land was acquired for to build it.

They were flown to Lucknow in a gesture conceived by Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath as a symbol of respect and gratitude towards those who made the project possible.

IndiGo became the first airline to operate from NIA, with its inaugural arrival touching down from Lucknow on Monday morning. The first departure from the airport took off for Bengaluru shortly thereafter, marking the formal beginning of commercial services at a facility that Prime Minister Narendra Modi had inaugurated in March this year. The airline said the commencement of operations from NIA represents a significant milestone in strengthening regional connectivity and expanding travel options for passengers across Delhi-NCR and western Uttar Pradesh.

TRANSITION TRIALS

The airport has completed extensive operational readiness, activation and transition trials ahead of the commercial launch, with international operations expected to follow in the coming months.

For passengers asking the most basic question — how do I get there — the answer is more reassuring than it might seem for a greenfield airport built on the outskirts of the NCR. NIA sits along the Yamuna Expressway, one of the region's most important arterial roads, and its connectivity network has been designed to serve a vast catchment area.

"Within a one-hour radius, crores of people will have access to this important airport, connecting them not only to destinations across India but also to international destinations in the future," Naidu said.

The proposed Delhi-Varanasi High-Speed Rail Corridor, once operational, is expected to further cement that connectivity, potentially making NIA one of the best-connected greenfield airports in the country and drawing passengers who might otherwise default to the congested Indira Gandhi International Airport (IGIA).

BUILT FOR SCALE

The cargo infrastructure, too, is already in place and built for scale.

Developed through Air India SATS Airport Services Pvt Ltd, the airport's dedicated cargo terminal has an initial handling capacity of 200,000 metric tonnes annually, with expansion plans that would take that figure to 1.5 million tonnes in the future.

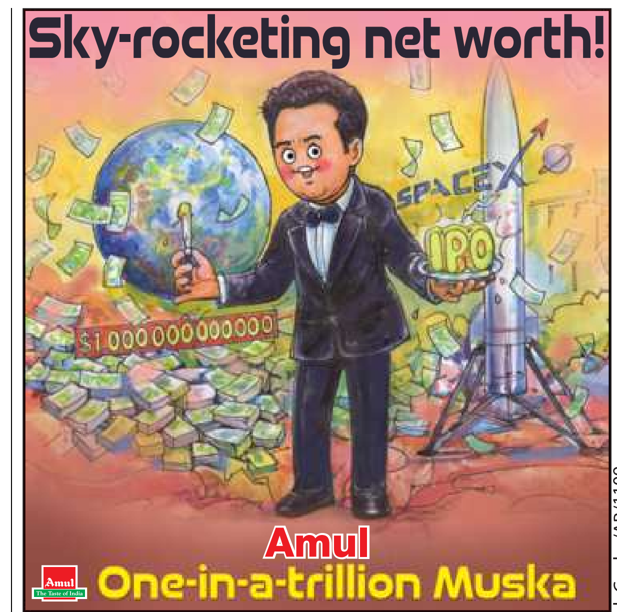
A significant part of that capacity is expected to serve the agricultural economy of western Uttar Pradesh, giving farmers and agri-businesses a direct air link to domestic markets and, eventually, international ones.

Naidu underlined that the airport's cargo network would serve to ferry agricultural produce alongside products from manufacturing and information technology sectors, a dimension of the aerotropolis vision that goes beyond the conventional airport-as-passenger-hub model and speaks directly to the region's economic character.

The development of an aerotropolis around the airport, Naidu said, would create a strong economic base serving both India and the international community, and would eventually emerge as a major employment generator for the region.

This is a claim that greenfield airports have made before, but one that carries more weight here given NIA's strategic location, the depth of its connectivity ambitions, and the scale of investment already committed around it.

NIA joins IGIA and Hindon Airport as the third airport serving the NCR, bringing much-needed capacity relief to a region that has long strained against the constraints of a single major hub. Its strategic location along the Yamuna Expressway positions it as something more than a pressure valve for IGI if the surrounding ecosystem develops as envisaged.



IndiGo tweaks business class offering to lure flyers

Aneesh Phadnis
Mumbai

IndiGo has tweaked its business class offering with a revamped menu and priority baggage handling to lure business and leisure travellers.

The changes in soft product will help the airline grow occupancy and revenue as it battles with Air India and international carriers for a larger pie of traffic. The changes also come amid a high fare and slow demand environment following the outbreak of tensions in West Asia.

The airline launched its business class product called Indigo Stretch on the Delhi-Mumbai route in November 2024 using a dual class Airbus A321 aircraft.

The IndiGo Stretch product offers customers wider seats, better leg room, complimentary meals among other benefits. Gradually more domestic routes were added, and service extended on international routes with IndiGo's own aircraft and leased Boeing 787 planes.

NEW CHANGES

IndiGo's Airbus A320/321 aircraft which fly on do-

The IndiGo Stretch product offers customers wider seats, better leg room, complimentary meals among other benefits

mestic and short-haul international routes do not have ovens. Thus, though the Stretch seats are priced lower than Air India's business class seats it did not provide hot meals on domestic and short-haul routes. Lounge access is also restricted to a few European routes.

However, recently changes have been made to make the product more attractive. Priority baggage has been implemented for Stretch customers from May 1 and their bags are tagged at origin and arrive first on the belt at destination.

An IndiGo spokesperson said meal service in Stretch cabin on Airbus A321 aircraft has been elevated for a consistent and premium experience. The service features a tray service with fine chinaware and steel cutlery.

Biotech push reaches an inflection point; funding remains the missing piece

Aishwarya Kumar
Bengaluru

India's healthcare and biotech start-up ecosystem is beginning to show signs of a shift from services, generics and contract manufacturing towards innovation-led businesses, but industry leaders say the availability of long-term growth capital remains the biggest hurdle in building globally-competitive companies.

While early-stage support through incubators, academic institutions and government-backed programmes has improved significantly over the past decade, start-ups developing novel drugs, diagnostics and advanced therapies continue to face challenges in securing funding required for clinical development, manufacturing scale-up and commercialisation.

"Even the large Indian pharma companies have done a lot of acquisitions in the last few years because they had cash on the books. The way to grow was to test of add to that. But now they realise that's not going to get them too far. The real focus has shifted towards innovation," said Mayur Sirdesai, Partner and Co-Founder at Somerset Indus Capital Partners.

IP INNOVATION

However, the next phase of growth is expected to be driven by intellectual property-led innovation, particularly in areas such as oncology, diagnostics and biotechnology.

Vedha Sampath Kumar, Partner, Endiya Partner, noted that much of the past decade was spent building the foundational ecosystem of research institutes and incubators.

"The ecosystem is only now beginning the 1-to-10 challenge of moving from isolated success stories to a self-sustaining innovation hub," she said.

She also highlighted the shortage of domestic GMP-certified pilot plants and scale-up infrastructure needed to take innovations from laboratories to commercial production.

Industry executives say capital availability becomes particularly challenging after the seed stage.

Industry executives say capital availability becomes particularly challenging after the seed stage

"The biggest struggle has been the next group of funding which will take it to a commercial scale. And that mantle has not really been taken over by the private sector," Sirdesai said.

UNLOCKING GROWTH

Amit Mookim, CEO of Immuneel Therapeutics, echoed similar concerns.

"The biggest need is patient, long-term capital aligned with biotech development cycles," he said.

While seed funding availability has improved, growth-stage investors capable of supporting clinical development and commercialisation remain limited, particularly in advanced areas such as cell and gene therapies.

According to Sirdesai, dedicated sector-focused funds will be critical to unlocking the next phase of growth. "You are slowly seeing that ecosystem evolve. But it is still not at a critical mass yet. It will require dedicated VC funds focused specifically on biotech, medtech, healthcare innovation and deep tech."

Recent global validation of Indian innovation, including large licensing and partnership deals involving domestic biotech firms, has begun attracting investor attention. Yet industry participants believe meaningful change will take time.

"I think it's realistically a five-to-ten-year story. This transition is not going to happen in one or two years," Sirdesai said.

"Over the next five years, you will start seeing some meaningful innovations emerge."

'Dream come true', say Jewar farmers after taking first flight from Noida airport

Press Trust of India
Lucknow

Around 170 villagers, whose land was acquired for the development of Noida International Airport, boarded the first passenger flight from the newly-operational airport on Monday and described to the Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister their air journey to Lucknow as a "dream come true".

For most of the travellers from Jewar, including 28 women, it was their first air travel, according to MLA Dhirendra Singh, who said the moment reflected the participation of farmers in the airport's development journey.

The passengers reached Lucknow on the launch-day flight after the airport commenced passenger services on Monday morning.

They were welcomed by Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath at his residence, where they expressed gratitude for being part of the historic journey.

Farmers, during their interaction with Adityanath, said a long-cherished dream of travelling by air was fulfilled and described the experience as "unforgettable".

OFFERING GRATITUDE. Union Civil Aviation Minister Kinjarapu Ram Mohan Naidu meets farmers and their families, who gave their land for the Noida International Airport in Gautam Buddha Nagar, on Monday ANI

Jewar resident Poonam, whose land was acquired for the airport project, said it was her first opportunity to sit in an aircraft. She thanked the Chief Minister and said the initiative had increased the respect and confidence of farmers.

MATTER OF PRIDE

Farmer Dharmveer Sharma said having a world-class international airport in their village area was a matter of pride. "The government has made farmers wearing slippers fly in an aircraft, proving that the benefits of development can reach the last person," he said, while thanking Adityanath and Singh.

Hira Rashid, a young doctor from the region, was among the passengers. She said the flight journey to Lucknow felt like "a dream becoming reality".

She credited the Chief Minister and the Jewar MLA for the development.

Farmer Haji Zafar said the government had taken farmers' consent during the land acquisition process and that they had "willingly contributed their land" for the project.

He said he was proud of the development and appreciated that government schemes were reaching people without discrimination.

Another farmer, Iqbal Kallu, said losing land for the airport had now become a part of a larger development journey as farmers were made stakeholders in the project — beyond just receiving compensation.

Women passengers also shared their thoughts about the experience.

'BEYOND WORDS'

Farmer Suman said she travelled by air for the first time, and a dream she had carried for years had finally been fulfilled. Meenu said she saw her land from the sky for the first time after the airport was built and described the experience as "beyond words".

Earlier in the day, the group boarded one of the first IndiGo flights from Noida International Airport to Lucknow.

Pollution check on farms around Tata iPhone plant

Reuters
Hosur

Officials stepped up government checks on farmland surrounding Apple supplier Tata's iPhone parts factory near Bengaluru on Monday, after *Reuters* reported that State authorities found discharge from the plant had contaminated groundwater.

The plant facing scrutiny is located in Hosur, 25 miles south of tech hub Bengaluru, and makes back panels and other components for iPhones.

Tamil Nadu's pollution body has warned Tata of a forced shutdown unless it explains why the body's inspections between December 2025 and May 2026 found that wastewater discharge was affecting open wells in adjacent agricultural lands, *Reuters* reported earlier. Tata says its independent analysis determined it was in compliance with regulatory norms and it was "committed to responsible business practices and protection of the environment and local communities."

RAISING CONCERN

Reuters reporters on Monday saw a team of three district administration officials, who oversee agricultural land issues, surveying the fields, walking behind the Tata factory with farmers who had expressed concerns about alleged water odour and contamination due to discharge from the factory.

Football mania grips Kerala with community screenings, carnivals

V Sajeev Kumar
Kochi

The FIFA World Cup 2026 fever is gripping Kerala, with fan clubs across the State transforming streets into football hubs through towering cutouts of stars Lionel Messi, Neymar and Cristiano Ronaldo, alongside large-scale LED public screenings that bring communities together.

This year's tournament carries a special emotional connection for Kerala following the selection of Kannur-rooted footballer Tahsin Mohammed Jamshid to Qatar's 26-member World Cup squad.

The 19-year-old winger, born and raised in Doha to parents from Kannur, could become the first footballer of Indian origin to play in a FIFA World Cup if he takes the field.

Community screenings are taking several forms across the State, ranging from commercial fan parks and community hall screenings to traditional open-air neighbourhood watch parties.

NOVEL INITIATIVE

In a novel initiative, an arts and sports club at Kurikkathoor in Kunnamangalam, Kozhikode, has purchased one acre of land for playing and community viewing of World Cup matches.

Nithin KT, secretary of Nithya Club, said the land was acquired for ₹20 lakh through contributions from 1,700 members, each donating ₹2,000.

The intention is to convert the property into a football ground, addressing the shortage of accessible playing fields that affects children's sporting development and community health.

Since the land requires preparatory work before it can be used as a playing field, the club decided to utilise it during the World Cup season by organising a football carnival featuring a giant screen and seating for more than 500 spectators.

WORLD CUP FEVER. A huge cut-out with images of Cristiano Ronaldo, Lionel Messi and Neymar installed near the St Andrews beach in Thiruvananthapuram PTI

As football fever intensifies, football-themed *mundus* and *lungis* featuring star players and team colours are also emerging as popular fashion statements across Kerala.

UNUSUAL CHALLENGE

However, industry experts say that the tournament is confronting an unusual challenge in India. With most matches scheduled during post-midnight and early morning hours, concerns are growing over audience delivery, advertiser interest and media monetisation.

The timing challenge appears to have already influenced broadcaster sentiment, with relatively subdued interest from advertisers regarding audience reach and commercial viability, according to Dominic Savio, Founder of Buzzstop Integrated Communications.

The issue is particularly significant in Kerala, where football traditionally commands strong engagement during World Cup seasons. The 2022 edition witnessed substantial participation from brands and marketers, including sponsorship involvement from edtech company Byju's.

The time-zone disadvantage may also create monetisation challenges for digital platforms. While OTT services can continue benefiting from highlights, clips and catch-up viewing, premium advertising rates remain closely linked to live audience delivery.

FAN ENGAGEMENT

According to Savio, brands should shift a portion of their football marketing budgets towards experiential initiatives such as public screenings, fan engagement programmes, prediction contests and community-based activations rather than conventional television advertising.

For broadcasters, advertisers and streaming platforms, FIFA World Cup 2026 could become an important case study on how global sporting events perform in a market where audience attention is increasingly fragmented and commercial success depends as much on viewing convenience as on sporting appeal, he added.

For BSE/NSE live quotes, scan the QR code or click the link https://bit.ly/2FpossK

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low		52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
Aavas	1405.70	1405.20	1416.90	1424.90	1392.00	154.47	2152.00	1050.25	17	1401.10
AB Capital	358.10	368.20	363.15	374.50	363.15	4180.87	375.90	237.35	31	367.90
AB Cotspin	210.18	246.33	214.00	252.21	210.81	1365.35	504.00	197.69	-	-
AB InfraBuil	10.82	10.65	11.32	11.95	10.31	3488.13	224.98	8.82	-	-
AB Real Est	1198.40	1240.00	1229.00	1261.00	1218.10	345.58	2537.90	1080.10	-	-
AB Sun Life	1101.20	1146.10	1118.00	1158.50	1092.20	1017.81	1158.50	708.00	-	-
ABB [2]	6770.50	6922.50	6880.00	6977.50	6821.00	227.94	7824.95	4640.50	96	6925.50
ABB Powerpro	34325.00	34695.00	35000.00	35000.00	34125.00	109.90	38785.00	16111.00	-	-
Abbott (I)	26280.00	26255.00	26555.00	26580.00	26170.00	5.92	35921.55	25164.00	36	26268.00
ABFRL	59.90	61.04	60.84	61.60	60.46	3579.68	94.95	53.59	-	61.02
ABML [1]	131.32	136.77	134.90	138.00	134.90	82.15	201.35	95.03	13	136.30
ACC	1336.60	1356.40	1360.00	1374.30	1351.80	154.00	2027.75	1250.00	12	1357.70
ACME Solar	335.75	347.25	339.90	352.00	335.30	2101.29	364.80	195.90	-	-
Action Cons [2]	931.05	928.95	943.00	953.00	926.00	462.42	1235.00	746.10	26	928.60
Acutaas Chem	3145.30	3096.70	3249.90	3249.90	3072.00	285.99	3444.30	1059.00	-	-
Adani Ent [1]	2921.60	2942.50	2960.00	2983.00	2935.00	1174.23	3058.70	1753.45	332	2942.85
Adani Green	1485.70	1482.60	1502.00	1512.10	1476.70	2245.38	1544.70	767.00	298	1482.95
Adani Ports [2]	1812.90	1804.80	1839.00	1840.30	1798.90	1421.74	1857.60	1291.00	222	1804.35
Adani Pwr [2]	223.07	220.52	226.95	227.00	220.00	26726.68	254.15	105.66	39	220.50
Adani T Gas	728.50	720.05	739.95	744.95	717.55	2630.61	859.85	462.80	-	-
Adani Wilm	190.82	191.16	193.00	196.45	190.61	4405.49	286.00	171.19	-	-
Adani.E.Sol	1489.60	1491.90	1506.90	1534.80	1486.10	1914.04	1614.80	744.90	-	-
ADF Foods [2]	283.20	282.40	285.90	292.65	280.00	224.05	300.00	153.65	30	281.70
AdityaBirlaL	98.34	100.12	100.18	101.75	99.65	797.09	175.00	87.91	-	-
AdityaInfote	3375.90	3366.30	3544.00	3544.00	3345.10	199.66	3714.40	1015.00	-	-
AdityaVisi	536.90	567.40	554.00	570.70	547.55	472.94	598.70	327.60	-	-
AdorWelding	1165.70	1177.80	1190.00	1199.00	1166.50	22.84	1260.00	848.00	-	-
Advait Ener	2305.80	2335.10	2380.50	2385.80	2276.10	76.59	2385.80	1351.00	-	-
Advent Hotel	129.83	139.93	134.40	143.30	130.20	391.16	345.05	120.02	-	-
Advenzymes [2]	368.95	367.35	373.00	385.50	365.40	152.00	419.80	251.90	30	366.50
Aegis Log [1]	944.40	984.30	954.95	1005.00	920.25	8796.57	1004.00	576.00	37	983.40
Aegis VopakT	217.85	231.69	225.13	234.00	219.76	2332.05	302.00	158.00	-	-
Aequs	182.53	203.43	185.90	214.89	184.50	36273.53	223.85	113.30	-	-
Aeroflex Ind	448.10	478.00	459.90	485.00	452.65	5416.72	485.00	158.00	-	-
AeroflexEnt	109.78	110.42	111.18	112.31	109.00	996.95	114.80	62.20	-	-
Aether Ind	1142.90	1149.60	1160.60	1163.00	1141.30	135.91	1275.10	726.45	-	-
Afcons Infra	326.00	325.15	329.25	337.10	323.10	845.57	479.40	265.80	-	-
Affle [2]	1446.30	1486.40	1465.00	1524.40	1454.30	650.77	2186.80	1251.85	156	1487.30
Agarwal ind	483.55	580.25	510.00	580.25	503.35	2102.89	1002.65	360.45	25	581.75
AGI Greenpac	645.75	660.40	653.00	665.30	651.05	198.32	1009.00	465.00	-	-
AGI Infra	372.50	380.05	378.80	389.10	375.15	3530.65	1408.00	224.70	-	-
Ahluwalia [2]	798.10	808.50	807.60	831.95	806.80	56.54	1129.20	645.00	20	805.90
AIA Engg [2]	4333.70	4469.20	4429.90	4519.00	4362.30	58.20	4779.95	3000.60	33	4465.20
Ajanta Ph [2]	3131.00	3054.40	3176.00	3176.00	3038.00	184.69	3314.80	2335.00	40	3058.75
Ajax Engg	548.30	549.35	558.00	571.95	544.30	58.64	730.10	394.80	-	-
Ajmera [2]	120.84	133.80	124.90	135.87	123.22	4316.59	221.23	98.10	21	133.40
Ajooni Bio	3.80	3.74	3.90	3.94	3.70	729.37	6.60	3.40	-	-
Akums Drugs	622.90	619.95	629.90	635.00	613.90	438.25	635.00	409.30	-	-
ALEM PHAR [2]	743.35	737.75	750.00	753.70	736.10	59.05	1107.80	635.30	21	738.60
Alembic Ltd [2]	87.06	89.38	89.50	90.55	88.01	347.03	125.70	70.64	18	89.28
Algoquant Fi	56.23	56.54	56.10	57.78	54.60	1032.90	71.01	47.80	-	-
AlivusLife	1045.70	1051.20	1055.00	1069.90	1047.20	104.16	1148.40	819.00	-	-
Alkem labs [2]	5298.00	5334.00	5320.00	5362.00	5305.00	70.01	5933.00	4716.75	28	5336.80
ALKYL AMI [2]	1831.80	1814.80	1880.00	1881.40	1806.10	56.25	2448.80	1212.35	52	1814.00
Allcargo Glo [2]	8.90	9.18	9.00	9.74	9.00	6100.52	16.18	7.10	-	9.19
ALLIED DIGIT [5]	117.44	119.99	120.50	121.28	119.10	101.98	209.10	86.50	-	119.90
AlliedBlend	644.45	627.85	648.95	652.60	620.90	554.42	696.80	382.10	-	-
AllTimePlas	234.22	254.09	238.02	270.00	237.02	2325.52	334.90	186.00	-	-
Alok Ind	12.16	12.69	12.45	13.19	12.45	18114.21	23.50	11.11	-	-
Amagi Media	425.95	426.25	443.70	443.70	422.30	102.49	450.80	310.20	-	-
AmantaHealth	151.82	157.14	160.00	161.00	154.00	414.12	164.00	92.00	-	-
Amar.Raj.Enr	823.65	837.10	845.00	856.00	834.90	473.22	1057.85	670.00	-	-
AMBALAL SARAB	32.56	33.22	32.90	34.75	32.90	146.19	38.50	30.30	-	-
Amber	7420.00	7620.00	7520.00	7688.00	7411.00	381.34	8970.00	5404.00	179	7615.85
AMBIKA COTTO	1607.10	1636.00	1625.20	1699.00	1625.20	24.88	1738.35	1100.60	13	1640.30
Ambuja Cem [2]	423.10	428.85	431.40	435.90	427.00	3311.69	625.00	394.00	27	428.50
AMIR CHAND J	123.23	129.12	125.00	131.40	125.00	1298.07	200.00	117.02	-	-
Amrutanjan [1]	557.70	554.65	560.05	564.70	552.65	24.31	789.95	490.00	25	553.70
Anand RathiW	1765.30	1781.60	1789.00	1790.20	1759.80	340.99	3735.00	1710.60	-	-
AnandRathiS	542.95	550.50	553.00	558.30	545.00	300.01	794.85	416.00	-	-
Anant Raj [2]	534.75	537.30	545.00	546.80	535.05	1621.26	744.10	403.00	65	537.20
Anant Raj Gl	125.33	128.79	126.14	133.00	126.14	394.31	206.10	109.10	-	-
Andhra Sug [2]	82.81	84.22	84.40	86.06	83.68	244.15	107.00	63.27	11	84.35
AngelOne	339.50	352.30	344.00	356.15	342.85	14953.83	3015.00	208.63	-	-
Anlon Health	15.06	15.24	15.35	15.62	14.90	10062.46	172.75	12.91	-	-
AntelopusSel	836.55	794.75	828.25	834.60	794.75	164.86	933.65	357.00	-	-
AnthemBiosci	788.70	773.45	798.00	798.00	765.35	420.89	873.50	579.15	-	-
Antony W Hdg	444.90	453.05	456.00	459.90	448.30	109.22	693.00	372.50	-	-
Anuh Phar	79.59	77.86	80.80	81.96	77.34	80.90	229.67	67.00	-	-
Anup Engg	1901.10	1961.10	1939.90	1998.00	1920.00	63.41	2954.90	1422.30	-	-
Anupam Ras.	1250.30	1269.50	1234.80	1285.00	1211.00	577.82	1415.00	1045.20	-	-
Apar Ind	15221.00	15986.00	15600.00	16174.00	15373.00	235.86	16190.00	6800.00	64	15973.35
Apcotex Ind [2]	529.30	518.15	535.00	579.00	513.10	486.02	579.20	310.15	27	520.00
Apex	419.15	426.80	435.00	436.90	423.40	374.87	514.20	202.90	34	426.95
APL Apollo [2]	1817.60	1833.80	1832.20	1851.30	1817.60	1936.42	2300.90	1493.00	93	1833.50
APOLLO [1]	409.40	421.65	415.00	430.90	410.20	27989.99	447.00	162.25	126	422.00
Apollo Hosp. [5]	8498.00	8468.50	8526.00	8534.00	8391.00	358.22	8624.20	6680.00	81	8467.10
Apollo Pipes	495.00	506.50	500.00	515.00	496.15	200.48	554.00	252.10	-	-
Apollo Tyres [1]	396.30	414.35	407.35	415.90	405.20	2449.23	540.30	365.35	14	414.35
Aptech Ltd	114.66	117.18	117.60	120.50	113.78	2177.47	161.80	69.50	32	117.25
Aptus V Hsg	271.70	272.70	275.75	277.95	271.45	854.45	364.00	193.03	-	-
Aqylon Nexus	56.85	55.88	57.37	57.99	55.48	13092.23	2247.00	39.26	-	-
Archean Chem	543.00	538.90	550.00	553.25	536.75	203.11	727.60	483.00	-	-
Arfin IndiaL	84.82	92.02	85.50	94.86	85.00	6223.44	106.20	31.43	-	-
Arih.Capital	69.03	71.99	70.00	73.69	69.59	524.72	120.00	56.97	-	-
Arisinfra So	120.13	125.40	120.99	127.00	118.25	2731.56	208.50	82.18	-	-
Arkade Dev	114.30	114.83	116.00	117.29	114.10	324.27	213.69	92.62	-	-
Arman Fin	1646.90	1658.60	1653.90	1721.00	1651.00	34.18	1903.15	1256.10	43	1650.25
Artemis Med	262.60	264.30	267.45	269.40	263.15	104.80	297.50	203.35	-	-
Arvind Fash [4]	450.20	461.65	454.70	465.00	450.20	196.27	579.05	366.60	-	462.00
Arvind Ltd	494.50	498.70	502.65	518.30	492.65	1866.51	517.95	275.00	46	499.20
ArvindSmart	573.90	594.65	590.95	600.45	583.05	39.77	718.40	490.35	59	594.60
Asahi Ind. [1]	883.60	892.85	897.90	905.00	888.05	42.69	1072.95	689.80	68	892.90
Ashapura [2]	692.05	709.05	700.00	727.15	700.00	609.66	924.70	377.30	43	708.70
Ashiana h [2]	359.95	364.10	371.90	371.90	362.00	48.99	389.00	250.60	30	363.55
ASHIKA CREDIT	378.55	390.45	379.90	400.00	376.70	121.15	410.95	339.95	-	-
Ashok Ley [1]	152.45	157.70	159.00	160.80	157.25	55366.73	215.35	115.00	24	157.65
Ashoka [5]	123.06	132.49	128.00	140.13	127.85	38723.49	218.50	101.00	19	132.50
Asian Energy	366.20	363.45	368.00	373.85	361.50	340.79	392.00	230.00	-	-
Asian granit	60.42	61.04	61.65	62.95	59.60	7019.71	79.08	55.23	-	60.83
Asian Paints [1]	2747.40	2739.30	2820.30	2832.70	2730.00	2752.02	2985.50	2116.00	60	2739.15
ASK Auto.	429.35	452.00	437.00	458.45	435.55	210.49	578.50	375.30	-	-
Asso Alcohol	819.90	826.45	840.00	845.00	823.05	25.63	1277.00	660.65	-	-
ASTECFE	769.60	762.95	777.50	794.75	760.05	81.24	990.87	512.35	-	761.20
ASTERDM	814.95	786.70	825.00	832.75	782.20	689.89	847.95	519.80	124	787.75
Astra Micro [2]	1443.80	1458.00	1477.00	1490.00	1447.40	807.92	1490.00	835.90	78	1457.75
Astral Poly [1]	1508.60	1544.80	1531.00	1554.90	1518.00	593.86	1767.95	1262.75	66	1544.55
Astrazeneca [2]	8249.50	8423.50	8260.00	8461.00	8234.50	7.06	10557.00	7630.00	110	8425.15
Atal RealTe	29.46	30.47	30.00	30.70	29.96	10723.13	31.85	17.75	-	-
AtherEnergy	1028.70	1027.40	1045.00	1045.00	1016.00	2309.24	1069.00	312.20	-	-
ATUL AUTO [5]	455.70	465.10	455.70	468.50	455.70	125.97	554.20	381.00	24	464.10
ATUL.	6517.50	6569.00	6649.00	6651.00	6550.00	18.94	7793.00	5563.00	32	6565.35
AU SFB	1015.50	1033.60	1035.00	1056.00	1023.40	1771.74	1079.65	682.50	29	1033.10
Auri GrowInd	0.35	0.34	0.34	0.36	0.34	18984.70	1.00	0.20	-	-
Aurionpro So	777.25	852.55	812.40	882.90	803.60	2710.06	1663.15	720.10	42	853.60
Aurob Pha [1]	1472.80	1408.30	1462.50	1469.40	1391.00	3171.18	1550.00	1017.00	34	1407.00
Aurum Prop	183.39	192.29	188.50	193.50	184.91	313.16	225.70	151.90	-	-
Authum Inv	530.15	558.70	531.00	581.60	531.00	8528.31	3318.70	400.00	-	-
Auto Axles	1689.00	1758.70	1702.50	1773.10	1690.10	12.46	2125.95	1536.00	15	1752.70
Avalon Tech	1687.00	1760.00	1691.00	1777.00	1690.10	611.90	1777.00	777.30	-	-
Avantel	166.53	167.06	170.30	172.59	166.41	1289.61	215.00	117.05	-	-
Avanti Feeds [1]	1060.10	1039.80	1078.10	1091.80	1031.30	726.56	1592.30	614.05	26	1040.50
AvenueSai	13.50	13.79	13.80	14.24	13.65	13937.47	23.42	12.92	-	-
AVG Logistic	178.43	170.50	176.02	185.00	168.02	163.09	311.95	116.66	-	-
Avro India	11.00	10.82	11.20	11.20	10.42	594.78	188.00	10.00	-	-
AVT Natur [1]	70.01	72.50	70.95	73.99	70.71	180.43	83.50	53.34	20	72.69
Awfis Space	303.05	303.25	310.00	316.65	300.15	413.36	696.00	229.05	-	-
Axis Bank [2]	1356.30	1368.30	1372.00	1378.00	1360.60	7522.83	1418.30	1041.30	17	1368.20
AXISCADES [5]	1947.60	1905.80	2030.00	2030.00	1889.90	247.37	2210.00	1061.00	560	1908.25
Aye Finance	149.86	156.75	152.78	158.26	151.96	1312.39	169.00	151.40	-	156.65
AYM Syntex	224.03	220.63	229.99	229.99	216.00	30.67	266.05	144.35	197	219.90
Azad Engg	2150.10	2122.00	2190.00	2219.30	2112.60	632.28	2350.00	1360.00	-	-
B										
BAJAJ AUTO	10063.00	9943.00	10164.00	10178.00	9930.00	400.02	10834.95	7879.45	28	9942.60
Bajaj Cons [1]	591.65	592.40	598.20	620.85	584.85	997.20	619.50	168.35	40	592.70
Bajaj Elect [2]	310.95	320.45	314.00	328.05	312.95	419.55	710.00	300.70	-	320.55
Bajaj Fin [1]	918.30	942.30	942.00	959.00	939.00	11989.43	1102.45	788.40	35	943.35
Bajaj Finser [1]	1689.10	1750.20	1714.00	1761.10	1710.00	2002.93	2194.65	1598.15	196	1749.75
Bajaj HCare	303.80	299.20	309.90	312.00	297.60	228.88	552.60	272.35	-	-
Bajaj Hindus [1]	18.94	19.82	19.60	20.38	19.35	21072.73	29.62	14.89	-	19.82
Bajaj Holdng	10161.00	10286.00	10280.00	10552.00	10254.00	62.63	14753.50	8597.50	40	10283.55
Bajaj HsgFin	84.59	86.59	85.70	87.40	85.60	5895.25	124.00	72.65	-	-
Bajel Proj.	198.49	199.49	201.20	203.35	198.11	275.28	263.90	135.10	-	-
Bal Phr	86.19	87.78	87.00	90.90	87.00	52.80	112.97	59.69	21	88.72
Balaji Amine [2]	2133.00	2108.10	2180.00	2199.10	2081.50	174.48	2260.00	905.15	41	2107.20
Balaji Tele. [2]	88.35	84.87	88.98	90.78	83.84	845.94	139.99	70.00	-	84.21
Balkrish Ind [2]	2013.10	2192.50	2060.70	2209.50	2050.30	1031.76	2800.20	1971.50	35	2191.00
BALMER LAWRIE	69.88	71.85	71.00	72.90	70.71	71.60	79.50	67.00	-	-
BalmerLawrie	174.96	177.23	177.90	179.00	175.82	164.18	238.00	148.35	12	177.70
BalramChini [1]	539.95	551.60	554.90	570.00	548.00	1156.48	627.00	393.40	34	552.05
Balu Forge	448.80	448.65	458.35	467.90	445.00	1177.08	719.00	341.05	-	-
Banco Prod [2]	689.55	687.45	698.00	705.95	685.10	391.39	879.60	503.00	24	687.90
Bandhan Bk	204.60	210.88	208.00	214.94	208.00	13330.72	214.80	134.30	28	210.90
Bang Ovrseas	31.73	30.69	32.80	33.98	30.00	172.00	63.99	27.00	7	30.86
Bank of Maha	87.30	89.12	88.61	91.10	88.23	33101.45	91.05	51.71	10	89.13
Bansal Wire	303.85	313.45	325.00	325.95	310.20	185.47	434.30	222.50	-	-
BartronicInd	7.25	7.52	7.35	7.62	7.30	686.30	17.60	6.95	-	-
BASF India	3356.50	3448.00	3379.00	3545.60	3379.00	27.52	5251.00	2906.90	36	3446.35
Bata India [5]	669.10	680.30	675.10	691.80	675.10	143.67	1287.85	605.55	53	679.50
Bayer Crop	4247.60	4291.30	4247.60	4315.00	4247.60	11.13	6539.95	4202.00	28	4294.80
BCL Ind.	37.79	38.33	38.74	39.75	38.02	1899.80	49.30	25.53	-	-
BDL [5]	1200.20	1209.70	1217.00	1225.00	1205.00	773.24	2013.55	1090.00	106	1210.05
Belrise Inds	228.23	238.26	231.01	242.00	231.00	6682.70	242.00	97.72	-	-
BEML [5]	1775.70	1778.80	1795.00	1815.00	1770.00	178.53	2437.43	1361.10	100	1783.00
BergerPaints [1]	515.15	519.40	528.70	538.15	516.15	480.25	604.60	391.50	53	519.05
Best Agroli	15.81	16.11	15.77	16.47	15.77	391.81	533.70	12.30	-	-
Beta Drugs	1771.20	1835.60	1920.00	1920.00	1784.00	217.18	2000.00	990.10	-	-
BF INVEST [5]	437.30	445.00	447.00	454.70	440.60	41.38	526.80	316.00	11	446.05
BF UTILI [5]	621.85	613.75	638.00	641.00	610.00	131.15	899.00	369.00	-	616.10
BFLYGANDHI	627.10	629.90	627.10	639.90	626.60	27.53	844.00	566.95	24	630.45
BHAGIL [5]	209.25	217.80	215.00	220.00	208.04	244.32	245.75	128.15	19	218.80
Bhagira.Chm	270.04	260.08	274.70	274.70	259.09	162.39	325.00	170.60	-	-
BHANSALI [1]	97.15	99.44	98.30	100.78	98.30	802.09	119.60	75.52	14	99.35
BHARAT BI [5]	2778.60	2792.70	2824.90	2846.70	2783.10	15.89	3403.40	2009.45	26	2791.65
Bharat Elect [1]	406.50	409.55	412.00	412.50	406.00	11500.11	473.25	361.05	50	409.45
Bharat Forge [2]	1945.10	2020.50	1971.50	2036.00	1954.80	1665.03	2043.90	1100.50	83	2020.60
Bharat Ra [5]	1405.10	1440.40	1425.00	1475.80	1425.00	11.42	3030.25	1202.05	15	1441.50
Bharat Wire	208.99	211.32	213.17	215.90	210.10	109.54	262.20	149.15	20	211.60
BharatCoking	37.57	37.64	38.02	38.45	37.53	21638.97	45.09	29.74	-	-
BharatSeats	180.19	182.57	183.00	190.24	181.60	194.22	239.45	98.50	-	-
Bharti Airte [5]	1822.50	1841.20	1841.00	1857.00	1816.00	5307.28	2174.70	1745.00	70	1840.85
Bharti Hexa	1477.40	1475.60	1495.00	1495.00	1462.00	128.98	2052.90	1434.20	-	-
BHEL [2]	378.75	382.85	384.00	391.25	381.05	7802.47	424.85	205.20	84	382.90
Bigbloc [2]	49.22	50.54	52.22	52.22	49.50	134.56	79.97	38.00	-	50.32
Bikaji Fds	673.80	659.55	678.90	682.00	655.00	814.97	818.70	592.55	-	-
Billionbrain	198.97	207.34	202.90	208.00	198.81	79080.71	227.20	112.00	-	-
Biocon [5]	419.00	416.05	422.00	422.15	412.90	3231.33	440.30	331.00	283	416.25
BIRLA CORPN.	951.10	981.35	960.90	999.00	960.90	88.97	1537.15	773.90	26	983.10
Birlasoft	316.00	323.90	322.40	327.10	320.30	995.91	474.00	306.40	-	-
Bk of baroda [2]	274.75	276.05	278.55	282.50	275.40	9344.48	325.55	230.55	7	275.90
Bk of India	145.68	146.23	149.00	151.00	145.84	7545.26	178.45	109.00	6	146.20
BL kashyap [1]	53.75	54.21	54.70	55.35	54.00	204.48	80.07	40.79	27	54.07
Black Box	1018.60	1011.70	1050.00	1050.00	996.40	594.92	1103.00	435.05	-	-
Bliss GVS [1]	437.85	439.55	440.00	449.10	433.70	687.77	462.70	118.35	47	439.70
BLS [1]	262.10	263.90	269.60	269.60	263.00	2164.54	415.00	218.45	106	264.00
BLS e-Svc	228.40	234.25	232.00	237.00	228.00	349.54	237.00	124.30	-	-
Blue Jet Hlt	512.50	504.30	520.00	522.00	503.00	655.20	1027.80	325.00	-	-
Blue Star [2]	1583.80	1611.20	1618.00	1640.00	1587.60	301.66	2049.95	1450.00	80	1610.95
BlueDart Exp	4758.60	4904.40	4860.00	4949.50	4860.00	19.14	7079.00	4630.50	43	4904.10
BluestoneJew	520.50	527.50	534.00	536.00	525.35	395.94	793.00	399.80	-	-
BluspringEnt	88.36	92.81	90.50	93.40	89.00	566.35	100.88	43.98	-	-
Bom Dyeing [2]	127.15	131.43	129.05	134.39	128.79	2299.36	196.50	92.10	98	131.45
BombayBu [2]	1518.80	1523.50	1543.30	1552.00	1517.10	46.50	2135.00	1301.00	142	1521.55
Borosil	220.87	226.16	227.24	228.50	223.75	92.64	397.95	213.73	-	-
Borosil.Ren.	544.60	547.45	554.00	558.20	545.35	425.10	721.00	374.40	-	-
Bosch Home	1331.70	1345.80	1380.00	1380.00	1337.00	14.49	1849.00	1021.30	-	-
BOSCH	39060.00	39070.00	39400.00	39775.00	38960.00	45.46	41894.30	28650.05	49	39046.15
BPCL	302.35	310.60	315.00	316.75	308.75	15261.09	391.85	266.55	5	310.40
BrainbeesSol	216.76	218.68	219.95	221.10	218.00	733.20	438.70	207.05	-	-
Brigade	678.60	684.10	689.00	697.00	675.90	417.12	1208.45	615.00	60	684.40
BrigadeHotel	62.31	63.90	63.99	64.74	62.62	123.86	91.77	54.36	-	-
BrightcomGr [2]	10.91	10.85	11.30	11.40	10.75	10814.11	21.65	7.71	-	10.85
Britannia [1]	5165.50	5199.50	5250.00	5258.00	5180.00	226.80	6336.95	5038.00	49	5196.70
BSE Ltd	4041.10	4126.00	4149.90	4192.30	4048.00	4653.05	4446.80	2021.50	-	-
C										
Camlin Fine [1]	136.73	138.64	139.35	145.41	137.60	4173.10	334.70	96.30	-	138.80
Campus Act.	238.40	237.70	243.05	243.05	236.30	257.47	304.40	215.20	-	-
CAMS	757.55	777.35	768.00	786.00	768.00	1322.59	4375.00	611.40	-	-
Canara Bank [2]	131.67	132.20	134.00	135.17	131.87	20283.19	162.90	103.50	6	132.15
Canara HSBCL	138.68	139.91	139.89	142.11	139.19	293.05	159.00	106.00	-	-
Canara RobAM	250.15	256.99	255.00	260.79	251.73	727.48	353.40	214.20	-	-
Canfin Hom [2]	862.30	864.40	872.00	886.25	860.95	147.27	970.00	709.05	11	861.70
Cantabil [2]	217.04	219.40	221.00	224.80	218.11	84.95	321.50	208.05	19	219.30
CAPACITE	220.96	224.03	226.00	229.77	223.21	266.29	342.00	178.90	11	224.10
CapillaryTec	508.05	504.10	518.15	527.35	498.00	157.44	798.95	464.25	-	-

For BSE/NSE live quotes, scan the QR code or click the link https://bit.ly/2FpossK

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
Pakka	79.62	80.70	80.49	83.58	79.86	309.71	226.78	74.12	-	-
Panacea Bio [1]	536.00	540.80	548.50	568.70	513.80	678.21	647.50	293.10	-	541.15
Panama Pe [2]	377.25	381.50	384.80	388.00	380.05	158.43	408.55	229.00	16	381.25
Par Drugs	86.68	93.40	94.00	98.00	91.28	114.53	122.43	78.05	-	-
ParadeepPhos	126.25	127.60	128.50	130.49	127.10	2409.18	234.39	99.70	-	-
Parag Milk	233.50	232.52	236.51	241.94	231.10	421.66	377.20	178.35	19	233.40
PARAMOUN [2]	64.12	64.07	65.40	66.40	63.52	2138.63	72.45	28.40	32	64.12
Paras Defen	1097.15	1108.15	1125.50	1133.00	1040.00	6807.20	1757.40	580.50	-	-
Park Hotels	116.23	118.03	117.50	120.70	117.50	239.77	173.20	95.10	-	-
Park MediWo	274.60	272.50	276.00	278.95	272.00	350.95	297.00	138.10	-	-
PashupatiCot	88.37	87.36	90.74	90.90	87.18	442.54	1036.40	67.75	-	-
Patanjali Fd	425.55	425.70	435.00	435.05	423.40	1284.38	1961.80	408.15	-	-
Patel engg [1]	27.31	27.65	28.10	28.25	27.56	4487.53	41.02	22.08	7	27.68
Patel Retail	217.43	219.23	217.44	223.30	214.66	234.95	305.00	150.25	-	-
PayTM	1073.90	1121.40	1087.70	1133.70	1079.00	2463.01	1381.80	857.15	-	-
PB Fintech	1547.80	1581.10	1569.00	1591.70	1552.50	1678.96	1978.00	1364.00	-	-
PC Jeweller [1]	8.92	9.17	9.12	9.40	9.06	61129.46	19.65	7.45	-	9.17
PCBL	290.25	303.10	298.75	307.60	295.00	3131.24	437.30	226.50	-	-
PDS	305.80	320.10	308.20	321.50	308.00	139.05	433.90	246.05	-	-
PENNAR IND [5]	155.06	159.29	160.00	163.00	158.22	487.51	279.80	128.90	21	159.35
PERSISTENT [5]	4811.00	4890.50	4885.00	4914.00	4845.50	519.73	6597.00	4450.00	45	4890.45
Petronet LNG	274.75	285.90	280.50	291.00	280.25	4766.70	326.40	235.45	11	286.05
Pfizer Ltd.	4509.20	4518.00	4548.90	4577.90	4511.00	13.43	5987.65	4396.55	27	4520.45
PG Electro [1]	483.30	492.80	496.35	506.30	490.35	2911.99	836.35	436.85	114	492.70
PGIL [5]	1630.90	1694.90	1647.10	1738.30	1647.10	136.26	1993.30	1180.00	112	1694.10
Phoenix Mill [2]	1757.60	1846.90	1788.00	1861.70	1766.70	661.44	1965.00	1403.00	224	1848.70
PhysicsWall	106.79	108.52	108.82	110.25	107.56	5619.72	161.99	77.72	-	-
PI INDUS. [1]	2841.70	2834.50	2855.00	2921.90	2830.00	238.69	4329.00	2658.00	28	2833.95
PiccadilyAgr	580.95	573.40	595.00	595.45	572.00	138.96	805.50	515.00	-	-
Pidilite [1]	1535.50	1571.00	1568.80	1582.70	1555.80	1848.65	1582.00	1259.45	67	1570.10
Pine Labs	150.57	153.59	153.00	154.78	149.77	29813.42	284.00	134.73	-	-
Piramal Fin	2017.20	2009.50	2035.00	2091.00	2005.00	399.93	2091.00	1260.00	-	-
Piramal Phr	163.85	167.20	166.45	170.85	165.39	6199.94	220.85	132.30	-	-
Pitti Engg [5]	993.00	977.50	1010.00	1019.00	972.10	83.73	1069.85	677.20	38	976.55
Pix Transm	1604.20	1624.40	1604.20	1635.00	1598.20	10.77	1706.00	1220.10	-	-
PlatinumInd	224.87	229.06	230.00	232.40	228.01	62.45	342.40	183.50	-	-
PN Gadgil Jw	547.55	560.85	561.00	566.75	551.85	247.78	736.40	503.00	-	-
Pnb Gilts	89.83	91.09	91.72	93.30	90.21	1682.83	119.84	58.75	9	90.95
PNB Housng	989.90	1017.30	999.80	1023.80	999.80	1091.67	1135.00	730.00	11	1016.95
PNC Infra [2]	201.62	206.26	207.88	211.54	205.67	446.11	331.80	157.95	16	206.55
PNGS Reva Di	378.35	380.80	390.00	394.80	379.30	168.45	476.75	324.25	-	-
Pokarna Ltd [2]	846.15	870.75	859.80	909.85	852.00	183.36	1147.35	692.55	-	871.55
Poly Medicu [5]	1532.40	1510.90	1546.50	1552.00	1498.00	121.71	2318.35	1184.00	45	1512.45
Polycab Ind.	9554.00	9556.00	9679.50	9681.00	9540.00	197.99	9833.00	5787.00	-	-
Polyplex	898.35	913.70	905.65	923.60	905.65	62.64	1287.25	743.00	48	913.55
PonawallaFin	391.90	399.50	400.00	408.30	398.05	1353.92	570.40	361.20	-	-
Pondy Oxides	1263.60	1285.60	1299.00	1301.90	1270.70	221.65	1619.00	689.00	-	-
Popular Veh.	94.60	95.47	94.60	98.99	94.50	33.79	163.00	82.41	-	-
Power Finan	421.05	424.50	426.50	433.70	423.20	5820.09	486.45	330.05	7	424.50
Power grid	284.80	285.70	290.00	290.00	284.05	9319.07	324.80	250.05	17	285.60
Power Instru	104.56	106.89	104.56	109.50	104.25	97.58	189.70	88.05	-	-
Power Trad	189.20	190.61	192.00	194.24	190.08	1157.17	229.40	149.90	14	190.65
POWERICA	458.75	479.00	478.95	488.20	463.80	453.27	586.30	365.10	-	-
POWERMECH	2789.50	2852.30	2859.90	2924.00	2831.40	291.26	3415.45	1718.00	30	2848.80
Prabha Energ	160.71	162.65	163.00	171.50	159.15	100.34	315.90	145.15	-	-
Praj Ind.ltd [2]	332.10	336.95	347.00	350.90	333.30	2157.77	514.00	273.05	45	336.80
Prakash Ind.	141.30	151.14	143.10	154.55	142.60	893.16	191.00	110.00	8	149.70
Prakash Pipe	241.32	257.76	247.00	262.00	243.19	389.83	413.90	163.21	-	-
PRAVEG.	226.20	232.05	229.05	239.40	226.20	143.42	325.00	210.40	-	-
Precam	144.03	150.74	148.90	155.00	147.75	354.53	263.30	104.05	42	150.80
PRECISION	248.90	243.10	248.00	252.60	240.00	97.31	295.35	177.05	45	243.45
Precision Wr [1]	391.75	403.80	398.00	411.00	395.20	429.32	467.10	166.90	48	403.80
Premier Enr	1034.60	1045.40	1047.70	1052.00	1028.90	951.46	1136.40	660.00	-	-
Premier Expl [2]	692.65	683.30	704.00	704.80	675.00	651.57	779.60	378.80	74	683.30
prestige Est	1387.30	1472.50	1415.00	1481.40	1394.00	1205.50	1812.40	1090.45	346	1472.45
Pricol Ltd [1]	550.50	581.30	556.15	587.25	556.15	1265.14	694.95	415.25	34	581.20
Primo Chemic	24.58	24.52	24.70	25.20	24.21	251.34	31.39	16.10	-	-
Prince Pipe	276.90	279.65	280.00	284.00	278.50	338.51	387.70	205.00	-	-
Prism Cement	117.89	119.73	119.65	121.00	118.91	294.11	172.15	115.70	-	119.65
Privi Speclt	3444.30	3469.10	3500.00	3529.00	3461.00	169.83	3590.90	2050.00	-	-
Procter&Gam	8993.50	8992.00	9100.00	9151.00	8980.00	17.36	14536.60	8939.25	34	8993.30
ProstarmInfo	141.60	143.13	143.95	145.50	141.31	237.92	253.49	111.25	-	-
Protean EGov	617.40	622.70	625.00	635.90	616.85	350.42	958.05	444.00	-	-
Prudent Corp	2909.10	3003.70	2925.00	3060.00	2879.00	43.15	3098.00	2121.00	-	-
PSPPROJECT	917.20	921.35	928.95	937.05	908.35	114.49	1030.80	569.30	69	921.55
PTC Ind.	18602.00	18656.00	18955.00	19345.00	18600.00	16.15	19851.00	13251.00	-	-
PTCFIN SER	30.52	30.78	31.00	31.44	30.61	919.94	44.00	23.78	6	30.83
PTL Enterp [1]	40.75	41.08	41.19	41.32	40.26	108.84	47.80	35.30	12	41.10
PUN.CHEM	1005.20	1034.20	1012.00	1061.90	1007.80	17.36	1664.95	875.90	20	1035.55
Punjab Na [2]	106.88	107.96	108.05	109.48	107.69	18982.67	135.15	98.50	7	107.90
PUNJABNSIND	24.02	24.01	24.40	24.70	23.85	1938.04	33.55	20.46	13	24.03
Puravankara [5]	209.18	213.73	211.95	216.10	211.95	94.00	306.00	160.00	72	213.50
PVP Ven	31.10	31.00	31.22	31.79	30.80	285.08	39.88	18.26	-	30.93
PVR Inox	943.50	943.80	945.00	963.00	942.00	251.65	1249.70	907.40	-	-
Q										
Quadrant Fut	342.25	379.90	348.00	386.85	340.00	3780.33	531.00	248.55	-	-
QUESS	244.02	245.55	247.29	248.89	243.00	489.34	319.15	166.05	16	245.60
R										
RACL Geartch	1277.40	1326.90	1310.00	1377.00	1310.00	52.03	1691.90	805.00	-	-
RadhikaJew	56.55	58.69	57.00	59.90	56.88	388.19	111.50	50.01	-	-
Radiant CMS	40.12	40.22	40.82	41.20	39.70	123.56	65.26	32.33	-	-
RadiKhait [2]	3541.70	3592.00	3575.00	3640.20	3560.20	300.88	3695.00	2504.00	78	3589.95
Raghav Prod.	1189.05	1199.90	1201.30	1219.00	1182.80	135.08	1219.00	561.30	-	-
Rail Tel	308.75	318.75	320.00	324.00	315.05	980.08	443.15	245.00	-	-
RAIN [2]	196.87	207.78	200.80	214.17	200.26	11862.05	214.00	99.85	-	207.70
Rainbow Ch.	1365.00	1418.60	1374.00	1425.00	1374.00	332.70	1645.70	1084.00	-	-
RAJ.SPG.	209.15	206.83	211.01	215.38	205.21	189.94	223.65	119.90	16	206.20
Rajoo Engine	54.44	55.03	55.70	56.69	54.75	400.03	145.88	46.00	-	-
Rajputa Sta	130.39	130.78	132.97	132.97	129.60	354.03	144.90	101.70	-	-
Rajratan Glo	459.20	455.85	465.00	468.95	453.65	63.17	540.00	305.55	-	-
Rallis India [1]	228.77	228.84	233.00	234.35	228.35	457.40	385.60	216.10	22	229.05
Ram Ratna Wr	379.20	380.20	388.60	391.80	379.00	100.44	785.95	268.00	-	-
Rama Phos.	121.35	126.03	122.95	130.00	122.95	95.11	217.19	103.50	-	-
Rama Stl [1]	5.22	5.24	5.28	5.44	5.24	13249.46	13.34	3.44	-	5.25
Ramco Systm	562.15	548.15	566.00	582.00	543.55	312.18	681.80	342.50	83	546.95
Ramco Cem [1]	880.60	911.25	887.00	920.00	880.00	262.46	1214.00	838.40	84	909.50
Ramco Inds. [1]	291.60	293.85	294.45	299.00	288.50	100.14	398.05	230.70	24	293.70
RAMKY INFRA	438.35	439.25	448.00	448.90	436.35	58.58	706.50	410.50	15	438.75
Rana Sugars	12.64	12.90	12.80	13.29	12.80	596.61	16.88	10.05	-	13.00
Rane Holdi	1450.00	1467.70	1465.00	1507.80	1458.70	9.16	1835.00	982.05	25	1470.75
RANE MADRAS	922.70	928.75	930.00	945.00	925.00	21.59	1054.55	612.50	22	926.30
Rashi Perip.	558.40	561.25	570.00	570.10	558.90	159.60	575.00	275.60	-	-
Rashtr.chem.	127.35	128.81	130.00	131.10	128.50	1819.71	164.40	106.10	18	128.90
RatanindiaEn	36.40	35.53	37.22	37.95	35.01	5680.59	69.70	24.40	-	-
Rategain Tr.	783.05	824.55	814.90	842.95	801.15	1130.32	842.95	417.60	-	-
Ratnamn [2]	2580.50	2588.60	2594.00	2630.10	2562.80	25.27	3342.35	1900.05	41	2591.25
Ratnaveer Pr	164.31	165.88	167.10	170.17	165.30	734.29	193.39	130.50	-	-
Ravindra Enr	136.00	146.94	138.50	149.62	137.25	1023.38	191.77	117.07	-	-
Raymond	580.70	591.90	588.00	614.95	585.10	1031.88	782.00	320.40	-	591.45
Raymond Life	794.75	807.10	799.90	822.00	799.90	273.27	1411.90	696.25	-	-

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
Thermax [2]	4726.30	4741.00	4821.00	4821.00	4665.70	277.05	5069.00	2744.20	98	4740.55
Thirumalai [1]	171.75	175.27	172.15	179.61	172.15	287.59	328.70	158.40	-	175.25
Thomas Co [1]	109.78	108.55	111.90	113.00	107.25	2365.33	188.45	86.15	44	108.75
Thomas Scot	255.65	272.20	261.00	277.30	260.00	72.57	NA	NA	206	-
Thyrocare Te	528.90	535.60	540.00	553.70	529.70	385.97	578.05	316.76	58	535.65
TILAKNAG IND	434.90	435.75	440.10	445.70	433.10	637.96	550.00	335.40	43	435.95
TIME TEC [1]	169.48	177.33	175.00	179.85	174.00	3847.20	248.95	154.00	40	177.10
TIMEX GROUP	493.75	496.45	498.70	507.00	486.10	596.13	507.00	312.00	-	-
TIMKEN (I)	3530.20	3520.60	3560.00	3581.20	3505.00	28.84	3775.00	2832.10	66	3515.40
Tinna Rubber	853.65	865.85	858.00	885.20	858.00	49.50	1068.60	527.45	-	-
Tips Music	640.25	640.10	654.90	661.95	638.25	151.53	726.75	481.15	-	-

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
DSPAMC - DSPPVBKETF	27.90	28.10	49.20	31.88	24.02	-
DSPAMC - DSPQ50ETF	242.86	246.32	8.66	264.64	209.98	-
DSPAMC - DSPSENXETF	77.38	78.43	6.66	88.20	73.27	-
DSPAMC - DSPSILVETF	231.31	241.01	277.32	390.00	101.80	-
DSPAMC - FLEXIADD	9.58	9.71	131.11	11.90	8.73	-
DSPAMC - NEXT50ADD	70.21	71.99	20.16	81.00	56.25	-
DSPAMC - SMALLADD	17.17	17.37	358.60	17.80	14.01	-
DSPAMC - TOP10ADD	87.13	88.01	127.00	103.43	83.05	-
DSPAMC-HEALTHADD	156.56	155.96	6.15	163.16	135.43	-
DSPBRAMLiqu	1000.00	1000.00	286.89	1025.00	997.55	-
EDELAMC - EBANKNIFTY	56.97	57.50	2.81	69.39	50.05	-

Exchange Traded Funds

Company	Pr Cl	NSE Cl	Vol	52 WH	52 WL	BSE Cl
TATAAML-NPBET	285.48	287.22	2.52	307.00	246.26	-
TataAMLSilv	23.34	24.23	62944.39	35.10	10.11	-
TATAAML-TNIDETF	79.59	80.62	41.01	103.26	74.50	-
UnionAMCGold	144.20	147.45	13.26	177.00	90.00	-
UTIAMC-BANKBETA	58.83	58.91	1497.49	73.70	51.30	-
UTIAMC-GILT10BETA	25.95	25.99	1.64	26.99	25.10	-
UTIAMC-GILT5BETA	65.60	65.97	1.29	66.43	61.51	-
UTIAMC-ITBETA	292.16	295.38	2.60	409.94	283.77	-
UTIAMC-SILVERBETA	231.78	241.15	669.67	379.66	102.55	-
UTIAMC-SNXT50BETA	90.11	91.32	5.56	102.25	77.87	-
UTIAMC-UTIGOLDBETA	124.05	126.15	310.17	149.35	79.10	-
WEALTH - TWCGOLDETF	147.23	149.67	21.64	187.98	123.31	-
ZerodAMC-Liq	114.51	114.53	24160.34	114.55	102.00	-
ZerodAMSML10	10.32	10.45	2331.18	11.74	8.50	-
ZerodhaA-Gol	23.20	23.60	8854.30	27.94	14.72	-
ZerodhAMCGil	30.07	30.09	78.80	30.94	28.71	-
ZerodhAMCSil	24.37	25.28	8086.23	38.01	10.23	-
ZerodhAM-Nif	9.42	9.52	1347.69	10.97	8.84	-

*: Closing price is the average of trade price(s) for the last half an hour;52-Week High/Low figures pertain to BSE.

Shares of face value other than ₹10 is indicated in brackets immediately following the name of the company.

Qty (No of shares traded) is denoted in thousands.

The PE(price-earnings multiple) of each stock is based on the latest declared earnings.

The PE computation takes into account the per share earnings of each company for the latest 12 months.

BSE Stocks

Company	Pr Cl	Cl
Sika Inter. [2]	896.70	898.20
Silver Touch [2]	198.95	208.00
Sirca Paint	418.80	419.75
SJS Enter	2112.95	2205.40
Tata Tech [2]	760.90	771.45
TataMot CV [2]	391.35	406.60
TBO Tek [1]	1361.20	1454.05
Techno Elec [2]	1038.95	1079.90
Vintage Coff.	159.35	155.40
VishalMega	119.70	120.60
Waaree Enr	3031.40	3052.00
Waaree Re. [2]	954.50	964.60

NSE Trade for Trade